Reflective Journal

Stage 3
Studio 4

Zhiyue
Ma

Reflective Journal — Contents

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Understanding The Studio Brief

1.1 The Studio Brief

CSM / BA (Hons) Architecture / Vertical Studio 4 / Year 2026/2027

BAArch

Vertical Studio 4

(re)productive housing

How can we reimaging urban housing to reconcile care and production?

Park City, DOGMA, 2016

CSM / BA (Hons) Architecture / Vertical Studio 4 / Year 2026/2027

Vertical Studio 4

(re)productive housing

↳ Studio Agendas

Studio 4 works at the intersection between architecture and urbanism, blurring the boundary between the two and working simultaneously at multiple scales. We understand the city as an ecosystem, a complex network between the built environment and the set of actors that inhabit it. Combining research and design, we explore ways in which architecture can act as a tool to make the built environment more inclusive and resilient for humans and non-humans alike.

↳ Methodology

Studio 4 will provide a framework of activities and methods - including lectures, workshops, tutorials, reviews, pin-ups, and field trips – for you to develop your proposal in several stages:

1. **Research & Analysis**
   In the first weeks, we will explore the context and relevant precedents in site visits and workshops. You will learn about exciting case studies and acquire key tools to engage with the complexities of the urban context through visual ethnography, diagrammatic analysis, site survey, models, and mapping
2. **Architectural Positioning**
   Based on your personal interests and the research conclusions, you will define your own position and brief to develop housing and community uses that support both domestic and productive activities.
3. **Design, experimentation, representation**
   From that point onwards, we will support you through a non-linear design process. In it, you will be encouraged to develop your design through activities of different nature and at various scales, including material experimentation, physical model making, and detailed inhabited drawings.

In every case, we will regard representation as a tool both for communication and for design.

Central Saint Martins

↳ Year theme

The housing crisis is forcing Londoners to live in smaller homes further away from their work and social networks. The prevailing response involves redeveloping existing parts of the city to build denser neighbourhoods comprised largely of standardised housing typologies. Meanwhile, existing homes are increasingly accommodating productive functions such as work from home and home-run enterprises. At the same time, the pressures that can make cities feel isolating and unaffordable, are also enabling the emergence of collective practices of care and fostering a greater sense of belonging.

In response to this context, we are going to investigate the role that collective housing, understood as a place of production (activities done in exchanged of money), social reproduction (activities to care for the community), and civic engagement can play in making our cities more inclusive and resilient.

Ethical Concerns
How can spatial design counter the worst effects of urban regeneration, supporting diverse types of residents, strengthening social bonds, and bringing back production into the city?

Climate Emergency Concerns
How can spatial design work productively with existing structures promoting circularity and reuse in urban redevelopment?

↳ Site

The Regis Road Industrial Area in Kentish Town, Camdem, will be our site of investigation. Seating between two railway lines and the neighbourhood's high street, this area is on the early stages of regeneration. As part of a broader CSM project to contribute ideas to the development, we will engage with local stakeholders and work critically with both the existing conditions of the site and the proposals to transform it.

Camdem Film Quarter Masterplan Vision, SPAARC, 2025

Studio 4 asks how urban housing can be reimagined to reconcile care and production. In response to London's housing crisis, changing patterns of work and the pressures of urban regeneration, the studio explores collective housing as a place for domestic life, paid work, community care and civic participation.

Using the Regis Road Industrial Area as its site, it asks students to develop a personal architectural position through research, experimentation and design, while critically considering social inclusion, existing structures and reuse.

1.2 My Initial Understanding

I understand the studio brief as a response to changes in how people live together in the city. As housing becomes smaller and people live further from their work and social networks, activities such as paid work and care are increasingly compressed into the home. The brief also raises a broader question: how can housing support a sense of belonging when everyday life and social relationships are becoming more fragmented?

support different forms of care and production, and enrich daily life

Simply placing people in a shared building does not necessarily create a community. I want to investigate which spaces, activities and forms of participation could allow relationships to develop over time.

This leads to a design question I will carry into the next stage of research: how might collective housing support a positive cycle in which residents can contribute to, benefit from and feel a sense of ownership over their shared environment? I will need to test what can be shared, what should remain private, and how these relationships could work at the scale of the home, the building and the surrounding neighbourhood.

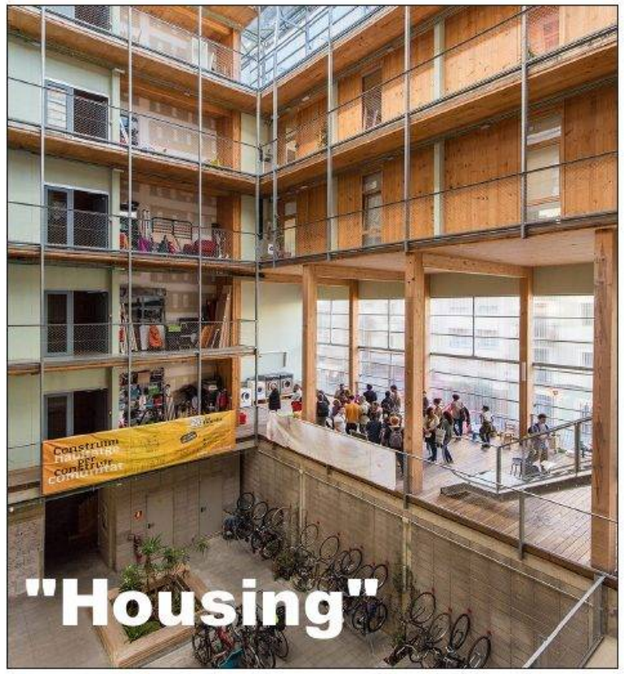
1.3 Four Core Keywords

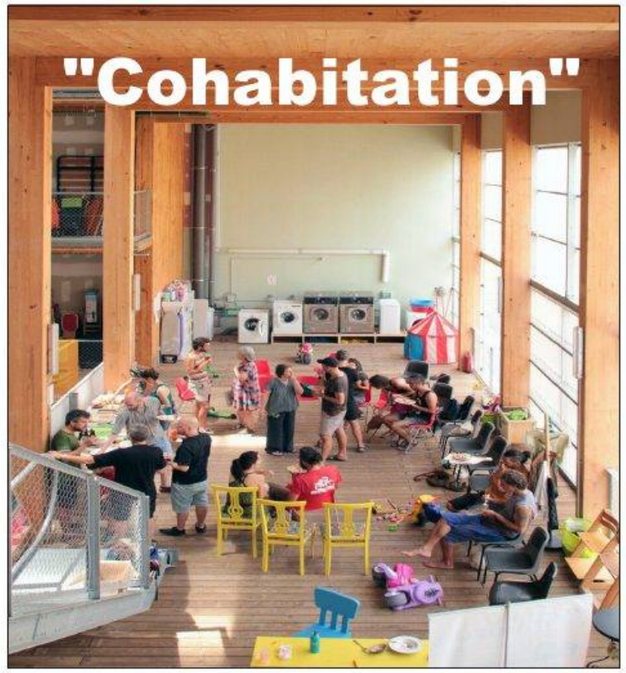
"Housing" :
Is the starting point of the brief, but its meaning extends beyond the individual dwelling. As people live in smaller homes and further from work and social networks, the relationship between private space, shared facilities and the surrounding neighbourhood becomes increasingly important. I want to understand housing as a framework for everyday life and social relationships, rather than only a collection of residential units.

"Care" :
Includes the everyday work that supports other people and sustains community life. It may take place through childcare, mutual help, shared meals or less visible acts of support. The spatial question is not simply where care happens, but who provides it, who can access it, and whether collective living can make this work more visible and more fairly shared.

"Production" :
Production refers to activities carried out in exchange for money, including working from home and small enterprises. The brief asks us to reconsider its relationship with housing and the city. I want to investigate what different forms of work need from space, how they can remain visible and viable within an urban neighbourhood, and where they may conflict with domestic life or care.

"Cohibitation" :
Cohabitation means more than occupying the same building. For me, it asks how people with different routines and needs can live alongside one another while retaining privacy and autonomy. Shared spaces may create opportunities to meet, but they do not automatically create trust or belonging. The design challenge is to understand what kinds of spaces and shared practices could allow relationships to develop





Together, these four keywords shift my initial understanding of the brief from a question of housing functions to a question of social relationships. Housing provides the setting; care and production shape everyday activities; cohabitation concerns how these activities and the people involved can live alongside one another. This leads to my initial question: can collective housing support a lasting sense of belonging, and what spatial and social conditions would make that possible? Through critical analysis of the site, relevant precedents and design experiments, I will test, deepen and, where necessary, revise this initial understanding as the project develops.

1.5 Case Studies and Analysis

1.5.1 La Borda, Barcelona

1. A different housing model:La Borda is owned by a housing cooperative. Residents have long-term rights to live in their homes, but cannot sell them for profit. This places the value of living in the building above its value as an investment.

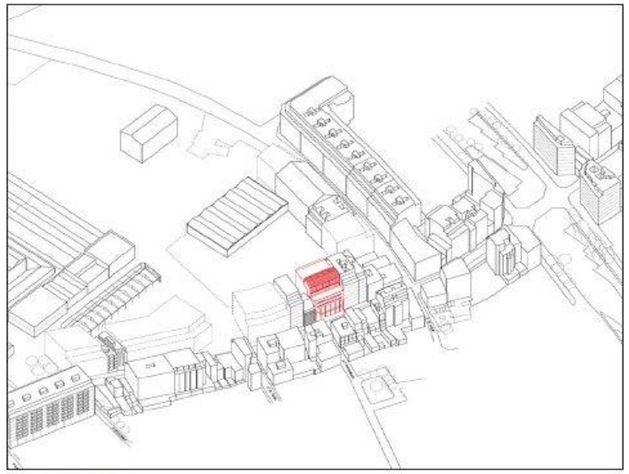
2. Residents as active participants:Future residents helped shape the project through working groups, workshops and collective decisions. Their participation did not end when construction was completed: they continue to manage shared spaces and organise community life.

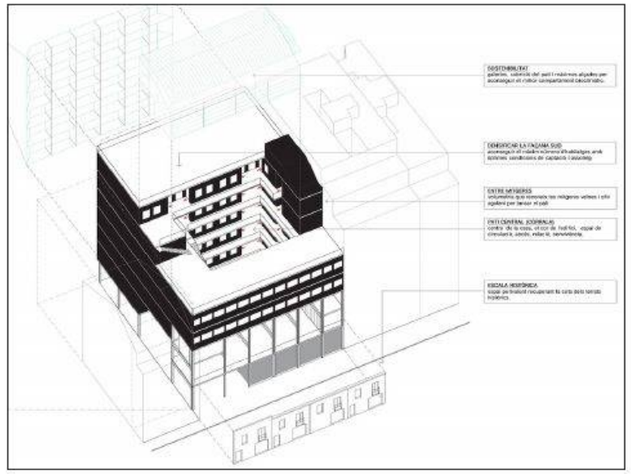
3. Shared space in everyday use:The central courtyard connects the homes with a shared kitchen, laundry and other communal facilities. Residents also arrange shared meals, divide cleaning tasks and provide mutual support. These routines give the spaces a purpose beyond occasional social events.

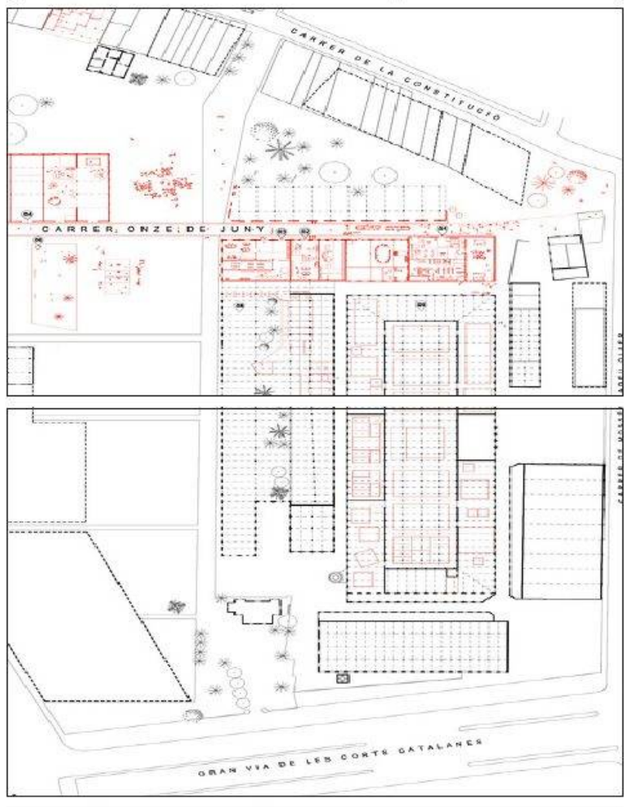
4. Housing that can change:The apartments use a modular structure intended to allow some homes to change in size as residents' needs evolve. This treats housing as a framework that can respond to different households over time.

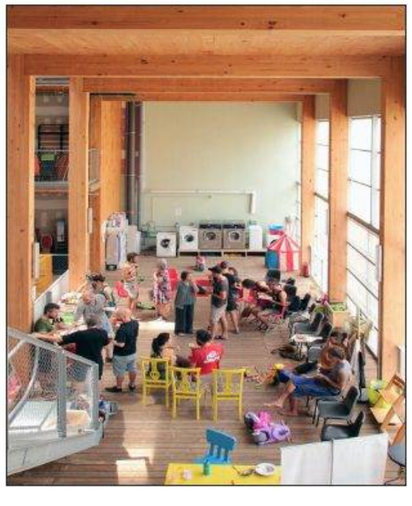
5. The conditions that made it possible:Barcelona City Council granted the cooperative a 75-year right to use public land, while residents and social finance helped fund the project. La Borda therefore depended on organisational and public support as well as architectural design.

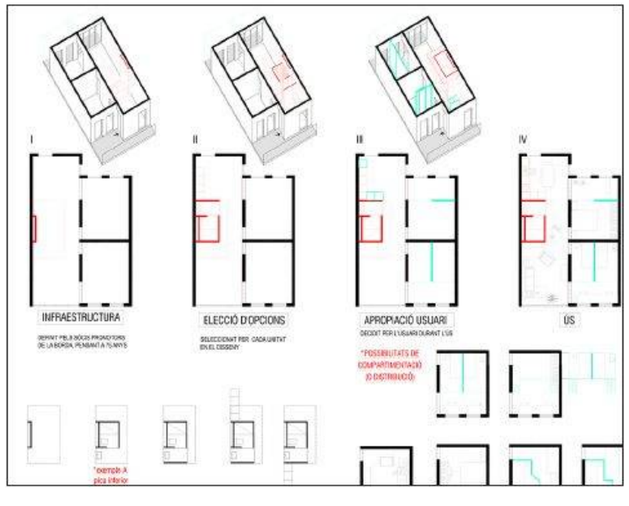
Reflection:What makes La Borda distinctive is the connection between ownership, resident participation, adaptable space and daily cooperation. Its sense of community is actively built and maintained; it is not produced by shared space alone.

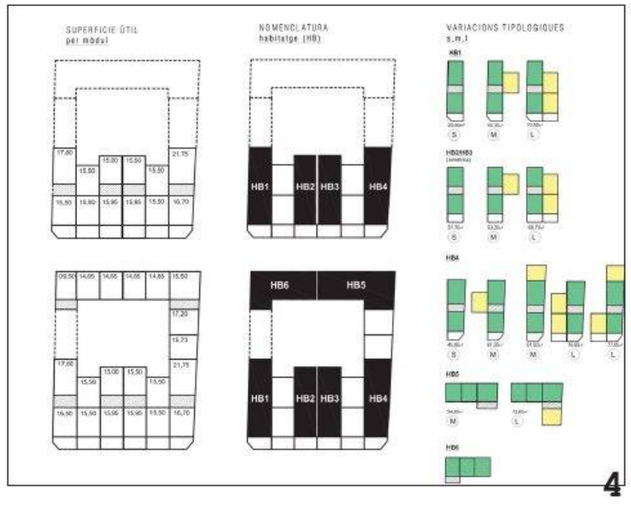


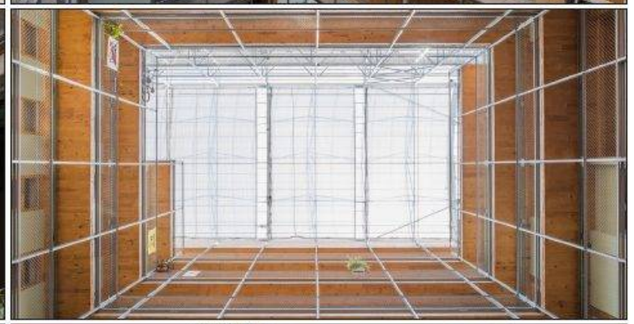


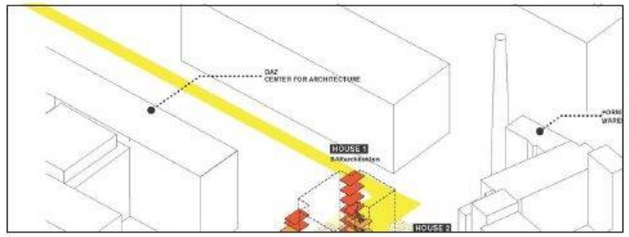


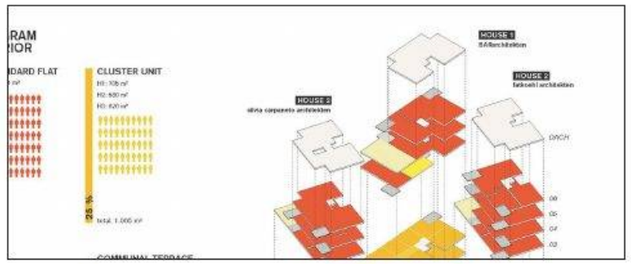


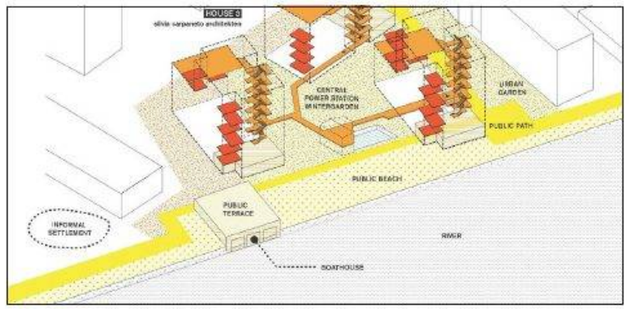


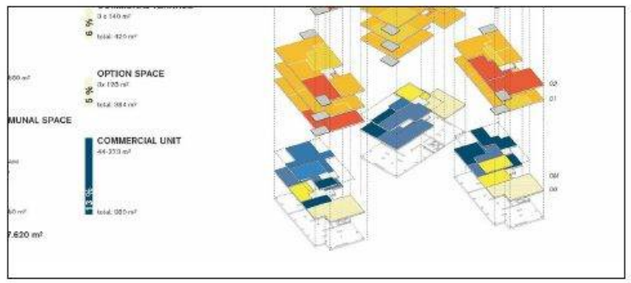












1.5.2 Spreefeld, Berlin

1. Open to the city: Spreefeld is made up of three housing buildings beside the river. Its grounds and much of its ground floor are open to the public, connecting residents with the wider neighbourhood.

2. Living and working together: The lower floors include workshops, studios, a catering kitchen, a daycare centre and spaces for community activities. This gives work and public life a visible place within the housing project.

3. Different ways to live: Spreefeld offers both individual homes and larger shared apartments. Residents can choose different levels of privacy and collective living rather than follow one fixed housing model.

4. Space for future uses: Its Option Rooms were left open to different social and cultural activities. Their use can change as needs develop.

Reflection: While La Borda focuses strongly on cooperation within the residential community, Spreefeld explores how housing can also support work and welcome the surrounding city.

1.5.3 Kalkbreite, Zürich

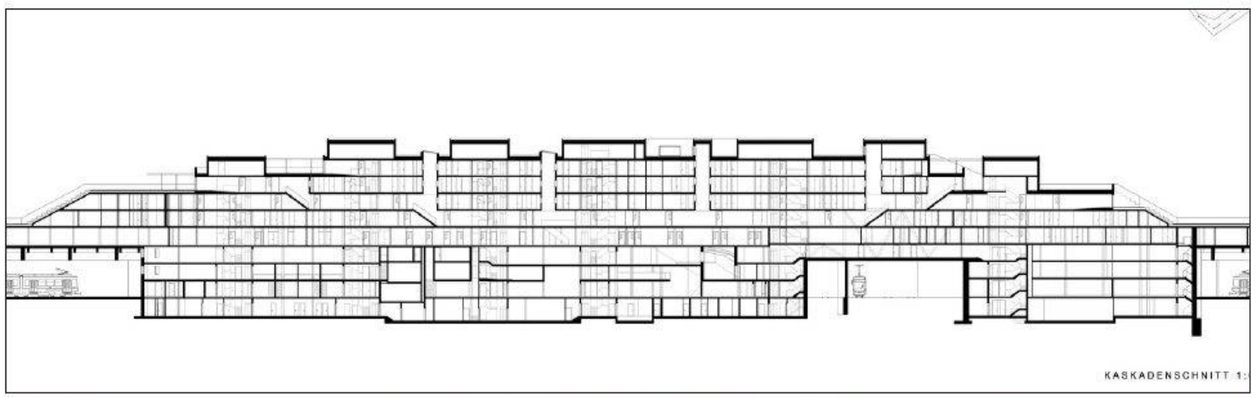
1. A small piece of the city: Kalkbreite combines housing with shops, workplaces, cultural spaces and a childcare centre in one large urban block. It brings different parts of everyday life close together.

2. Built around an existing use: The project was built over an operating tram depot. Covering the depot created an elevated courtyard that residents and the wider neighbourhood can use.

3. Different ways of living and working: Its housing includes shared clusters, family homes and apartments suited to working at home. Extra "joker rooms" can be added to a household when its needs change.

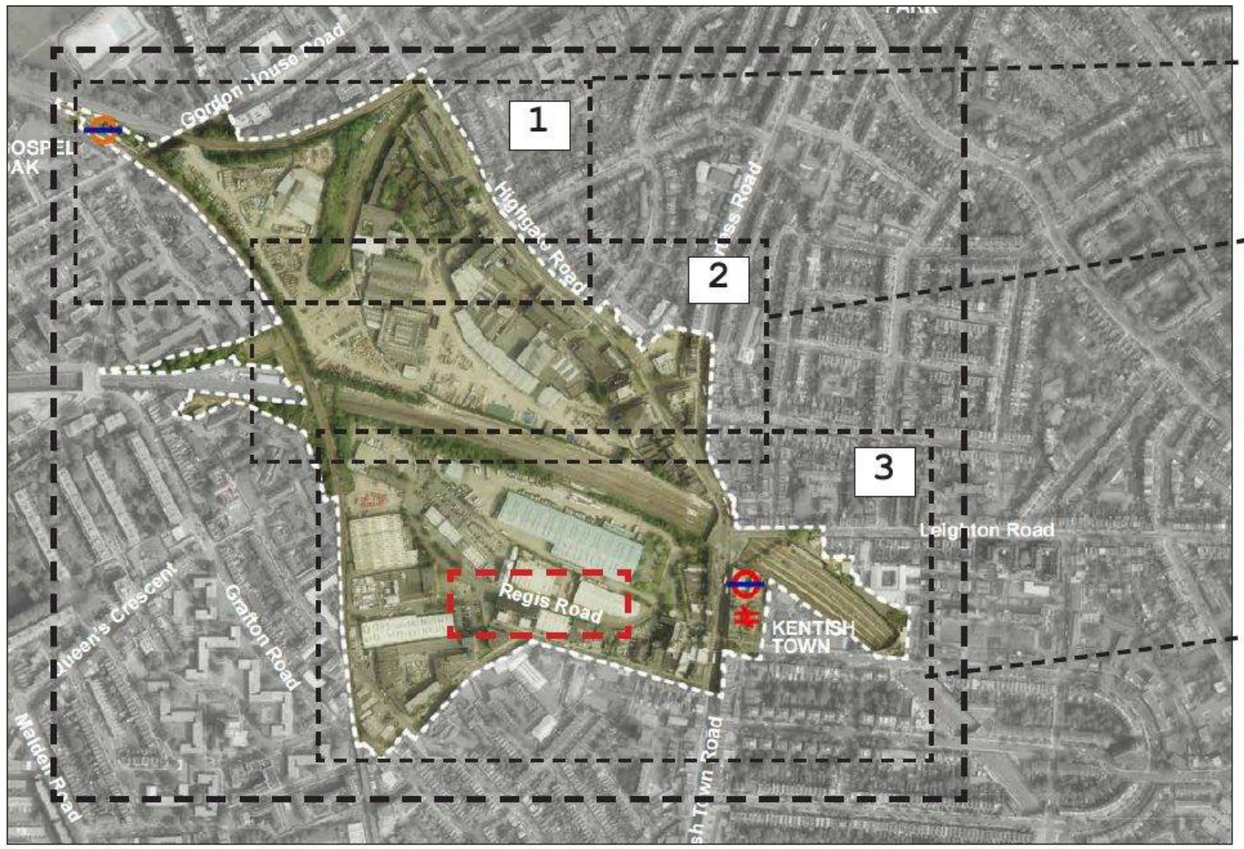
4. Connected shared spaces: A sequence of entrances, routes, terraces and the courtyard links private homes to communal and public areas. Collective life is organised throughout the building, not confined to one shared room.

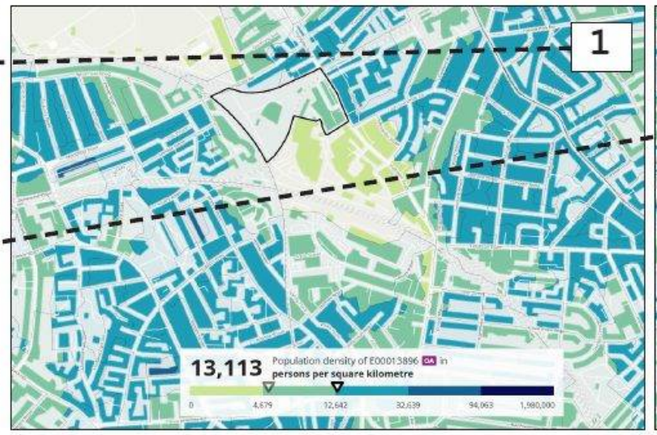
Reflection: Kalkbreite's strength is the way it combines housing and paid work within an active part of the city, while offering different

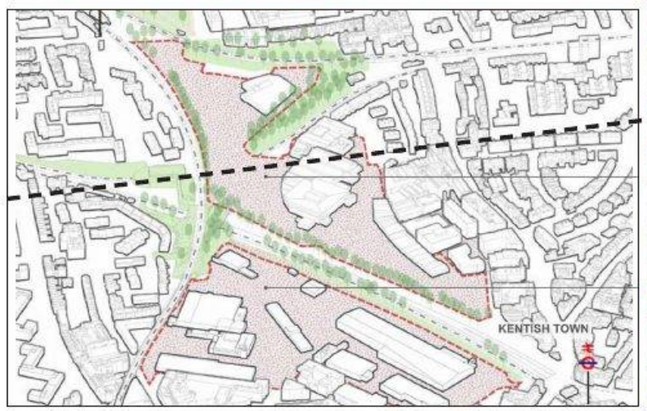


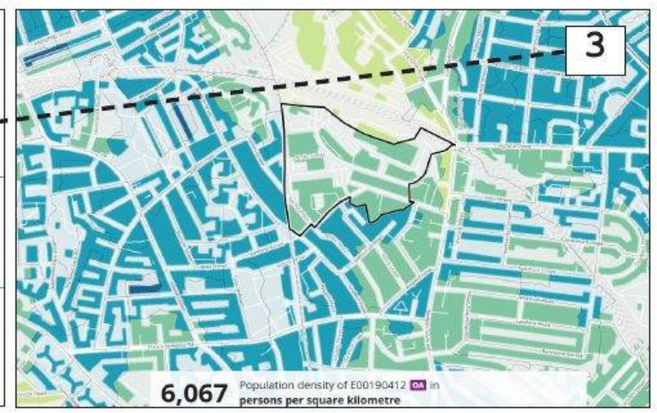
Context of the Design Proposal

2.1 Contextual Research and Analysis



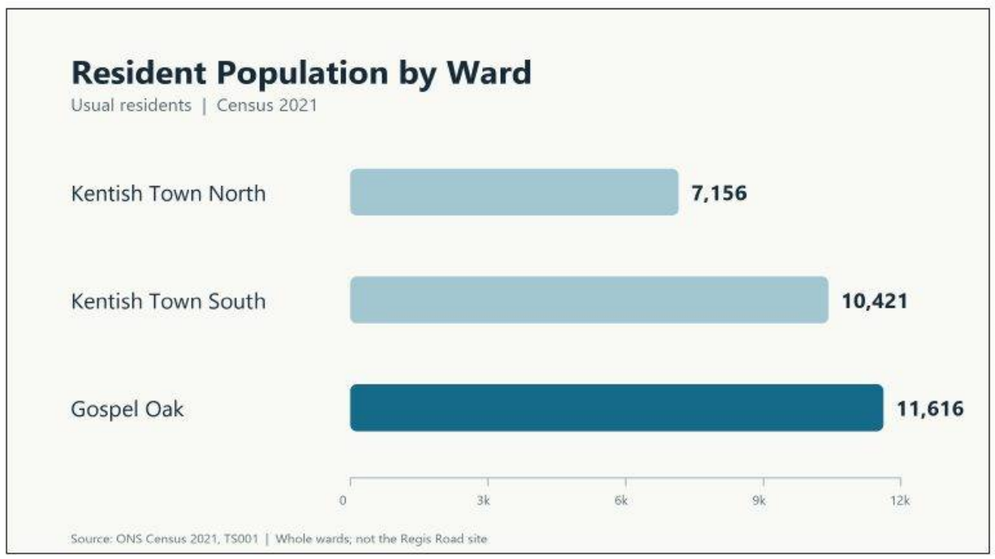






Initial reflection

The site should be understood in relation to people already living around it, rather than as an isolated area available for new housing. The next stage of analysis should examine where residential density is concentrated at a smaller geographical scale and how existing routes or barriers affect access between those residents and Regis Road.



Source: Census 2021, ONS population and population density datasets. Figures represent whole wards, not the Regis Road site. Density figures are rounded to the nearest whole person. Population data · Density data

2.1.1 Demographics

(1)Population, Distribution & Density

Research question: How is the resident population distributed around Regis Road, and what does this reveal about the site's relationship with neighbouring communities?

Analysis: Regis Road sits between established residential neighbourhoods, while railway lines define much of its northern and western edges. Camden describes the Regis Road Growth Area as approximately 7.5 hectares of predominantly industrial and warehouse land. The surrounding wards therefore provide a useful demographic context, but their figures must not be treated as the population of the site itself. (Camden, Kentish Town Planning Framework, 2020, pp. 19–20)

The 2021 Census records the largest population and highest average population density of the three surrounding wards in Gospel Oak. Kentish Town South has substantially more residents than Kentish Town North, although their average densities are similar. Population totals alone therefore do not explain how intensively land is inhabited. A small-area density map is needed to examine variation within the wards and around the site. (ONS, Population Density: Census 2021)

(2)Age Structure

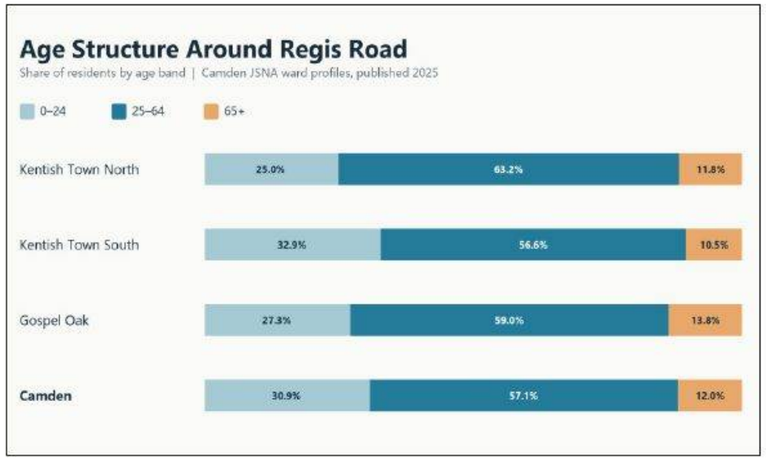
Research question: How do age profiles differ between the neighbourhoods surrounding Regis Road?

Analysis

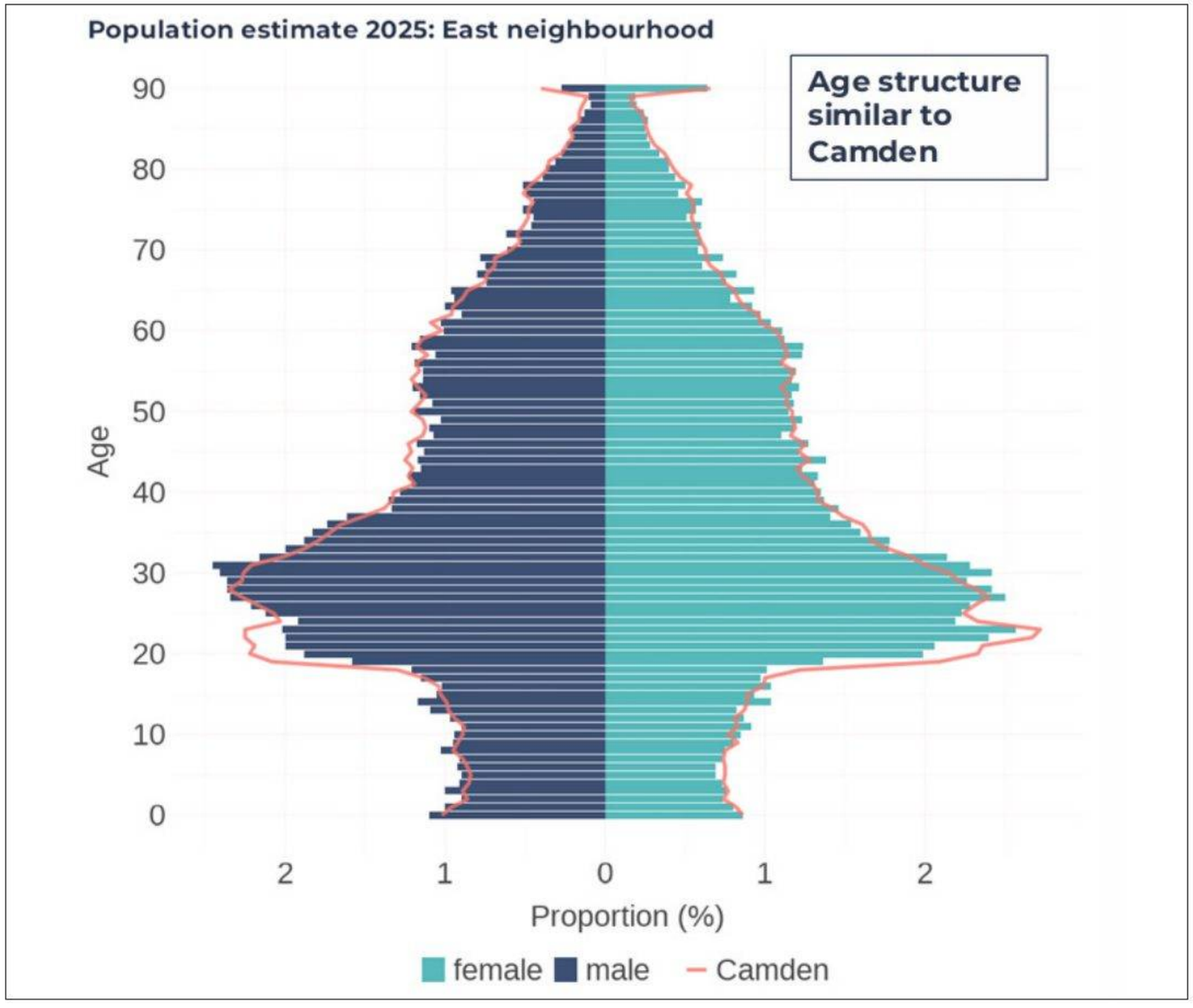
The age profile changes noticeably across the wards surrounding Regis Road. Kentish Town South's share of residents aged 0-24 is 7.91 percentage points higher** than Kentish Town North's. Kentish Town North, meanwhile, has the largest share aged 25-64. Gospel Oak has the largest share aged 65 and over. This suggests that the site sits between communities with different age structures, rather than serving one uniform group of residents.For the housing proposal, the question is how shared spaces could support different patterns of use over time. A communal room might need to accommodate quiet daytime activities as well as gatherings at other hours; routes and thresholds should also be considered from the perspective of people with different levels of mobility. These are questions to test through further research, not design requirements proven by the age figures alone.

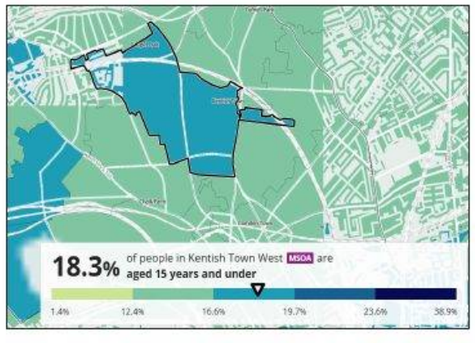
The data has limits. The 0-24 group combines children and young adults, while age 65+ does not indicate whether someone needs care. The next stage of research should examine household composition and everyday activity before deciding which spaces or services the project should provide.

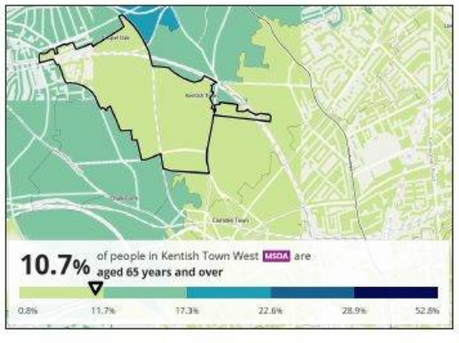
Initial reflection: The broad 0-24 category includes both children and young adults;it cannot tell us which facilities they need. Similarly, the proportion aged 65+ does not directly measure care needs. The differences between nearby wards instead prompt a design question: how might housing, circulation and shared spaces accommodate people at different stages of life, while allowing residents to choose how much they participate in collective life?



Source: Camden JSNA ward profiles, published 2025. The 25-64 figures calculated by subtracting the published 0-24 and 65+ shares from 100%. These are ward-level figures not describe residents of the site







CHILDREN · AGED 0–15(18.3%)
Where younger residents are concentrated
RESIDENTS · AGED 16–64(70.9%)
Distribution of the broad middle age group
OLDER RESIDENTS · AGED 65+(10.7%)
Where older residents are concentrated

Source: ONS Census 2021 age maps. Percentages refer to the area selected on the maps, not to the Regis Road site. Totals may differ from 100% due to rounding

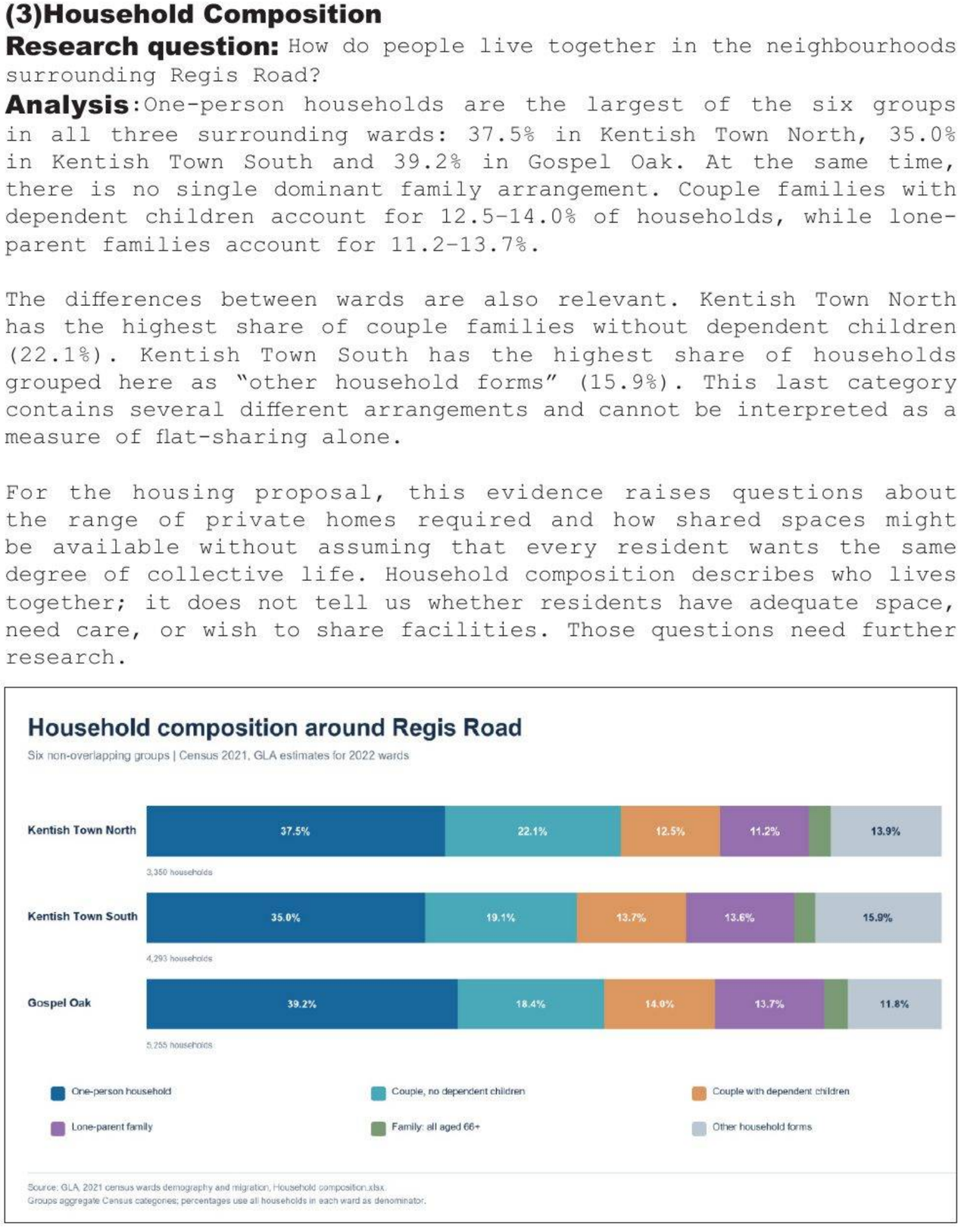
(3)Household Composition

Research question: How do people live together in the neighbourhoods surrounding Regis Road?

Analysis:One-person households are the largest of the six groups in all three surrounding wards: 37.5% in Kentish Town North, 35.0% in Kentish Town South and 39.2% in Gospel Oak. At the same time, there is no single dominant family arrangement. Couple families with dependent children account for 12.5–14.0% of households, while lone-parent families account for 11.2–13.7%.

The differences between wards are also relevant. Kentish Town North has the highest share of couple families without dependent children (22.1%). Kentish Town South has the highest share of households grouped here as "other household forms" (15.9%). This last category contains several different arrangements and cannot be interpreted as a measure of flat-sharing alone.

For the housing proposal, this evidence raises questions about the range of private homes required and how shared spaces might be available without assuming that every resident wants the same degree of collective life. Household composition describes who lives together; it does not tell us whether residents have adequate space, need care, or wish to share facilities. Those questions need further research.



Source: Greater London Authority, Census 2021 ward estimates, "Household composition.xlsx". Percentages are calculated from the number of households in each ward. The six visual groups combine the more detailed Census categories; diagrams are illustrative rather than exhaustive.

Household group	Kentish Town North	Kentish Town South	Gospel Oak
One-person household	37.5%	35.0%	39.2%
Couple, no dependent children	22.1%	19.1%	18.4%
Couple with dependent children	12.5%	13.7%	14.0%
Lone-parent family	11.2%	13.6%	13.7%
Single family, all aged 66+	2.7%	2.7%	3.0%
Other household forms	13.9%	15.9%	11.8%
Total households	**3,350**	**4,293**	**5,255**

(4)Housing Circumstances

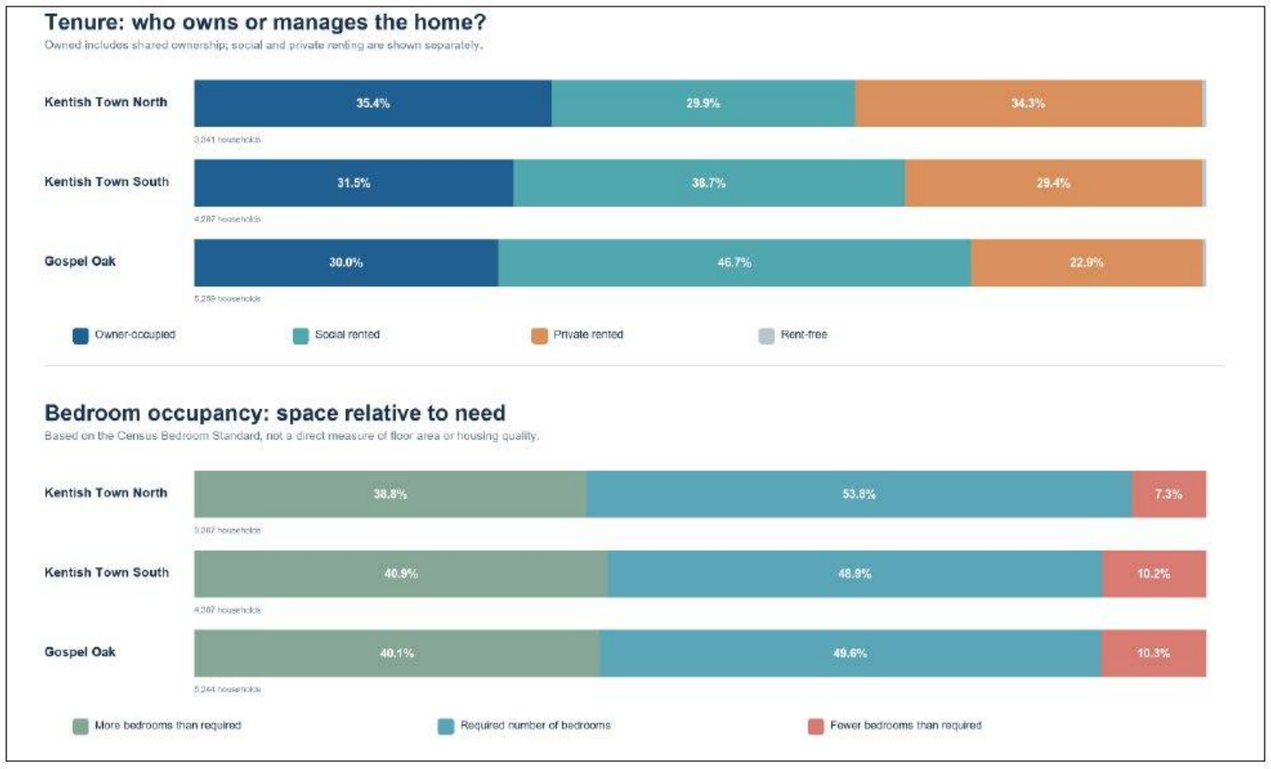
Research question: How do tenure and bedroom availability differ across the neighbourhoods surrounding Regis Road?

Analysis:Housing tenure varies considerably between the three wards. Social renting accounts for 46.7% of households in Gospel Oak, compared with 29.9% in Kentish Town North. Private renting shows the opposite pattern: 34.3% in Kentish Town North and 22.9% in Gospel Oak. These differences suggest that a single account of "local housing" would conceal distinct housing circumstances around the site.

Bedroom occupancy adds another question. Under the Census Bedroom

Standard, 10.2% of households in Kentish Town South and 10.3% in Gospel Oak have fewer bedrooms than required, compared with 7.3% in Kentish Town North. At the same time, around 39–41% of households in each ward have more bedrooms than the standard requires. A spare bedroom in one home cannot simply be treated as available space for another household.

The physical housing stock also differs: purpose-built flats make up 58.1% of households' accommodation in Gospel Oak, while flats in converted or shared houses account for 43.0% in Kentish Town North. These separate statistics do not show which tenure or household types occupy each building type.



Source: Greater London Authority, Census 2021 ward estimates: "tenure - households.xlsx", "occupancy rating - bedrooms.xlsx" and "accommodation type. xlsx". Each percentage uses the total in its own source table; household totals vary slightly between tables. The bedroom rating compares available bedrooms with the number required under the Census Bedroom Standard. These are ward-level figures, not measurements of homes on the Regis Road site.

(5)Migration & Cultural Background

Research question: :What do residents' places of birth, ethnic identities and languages reveal about the communities surrounding Regis Road?

Analysis:In the 2021 Census, 33.9% of Kentish Town North residents were born outside the UK. The proportion was higher in Kentish Town South (38.5%) and Gospel Oak (38.5%). These residents came from several broad regions, including the European Union, Africa, and the Middle East and Asia. The area therefore cannot be described through a single migrant background.

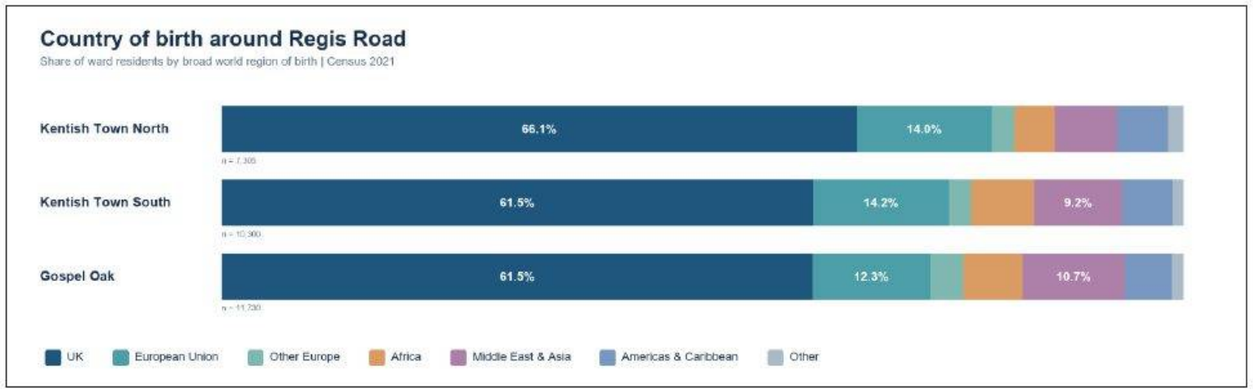
Ethnic identity adds a different perspective. Residents identified across all five broad Census ethnic groups, with Kentish Town South and Gospel Oak showing different proportions from Kentish Town North. Country of birth and ethnic identity measure different things: a UK-born resident may identify with a minority ethnic group, while people born in the same region may have very different identities and experiences.

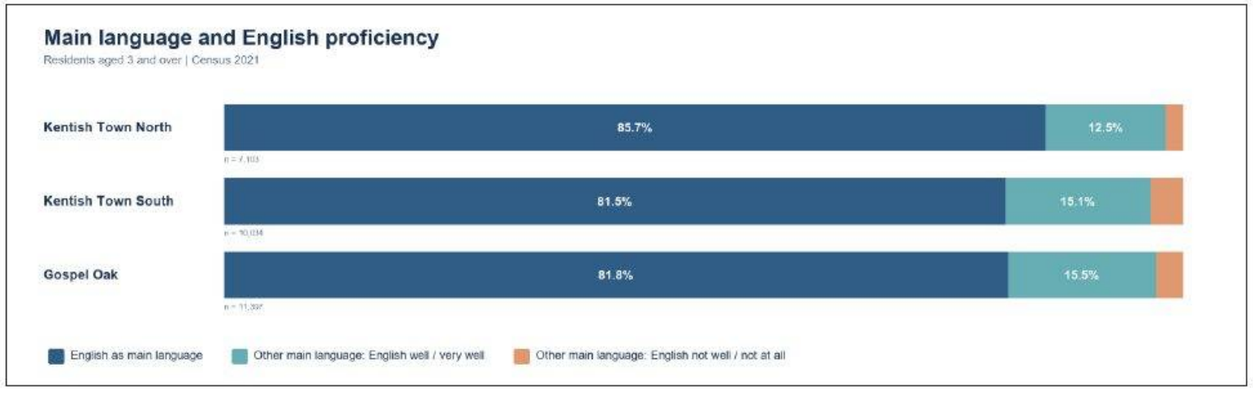
Language offers a further distinction. A main language other than English was reported by 14.3% of residents aged three and over in Kentish Town North, 18.5% in Kentish Town South and 18.2% in Gospel-

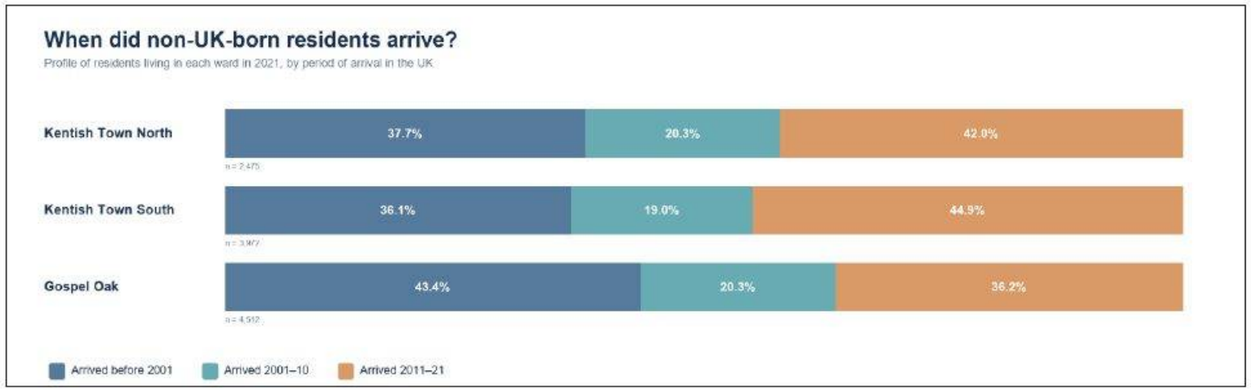
-Oak.Most people in this category reported speaking English well or very well. Multilingualism should therefore not be treated automatically as a communication barrier.

Initial reflection: These figures suggest a neighbourhood shaped by multiple histories of settlement, but they do not tell us how people meet, share space or build a sense of belonging. The next stage of research should compare the Census evidence with observations of local shops, community organisations, public spaces and residents' own accounts. This would help test whether cultural diversity is visible in everyday life and whether it has any specific implications for the housing proposal.

Data note: Figures describe the three surrounding wards, not the Regis Road site itself. All figures on this page use the GLA's Census 2021 estimates for 2022 ward boundaries.







(6)Change Over Time

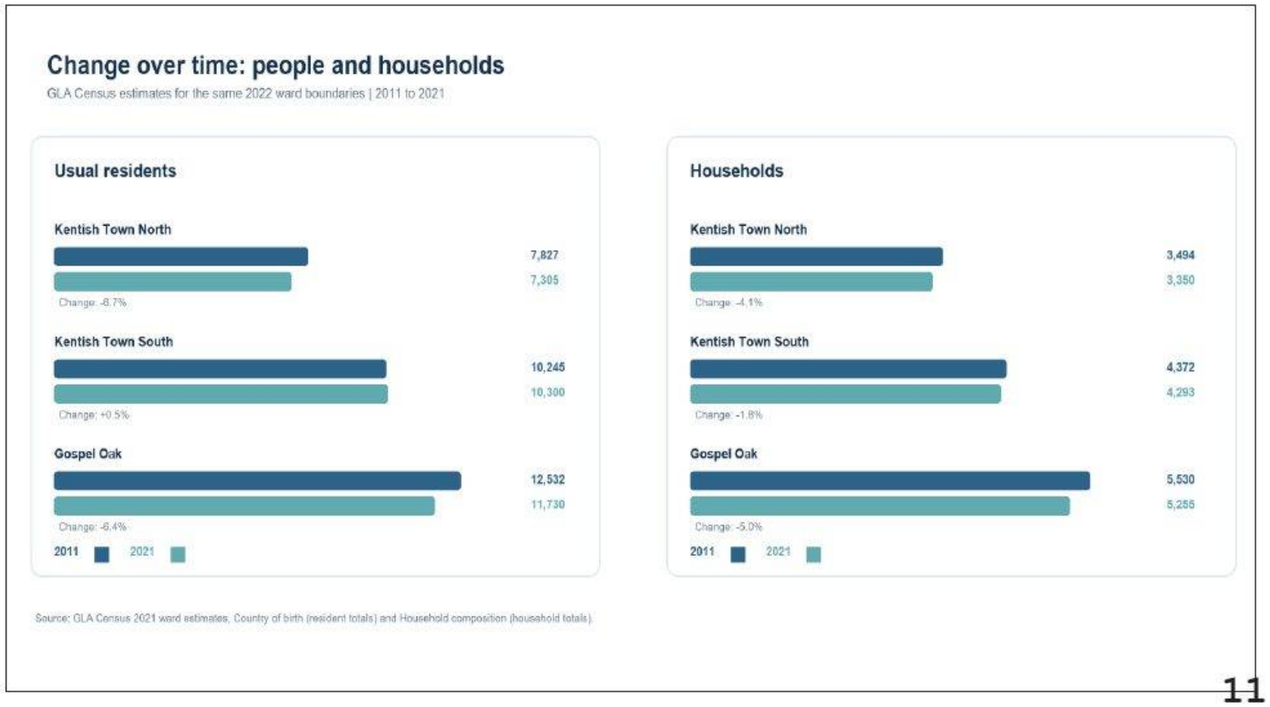
Research question: How did the population and household structure of the wards around Regis Road change between 2011 and 2021?

Analysis: The three wards did not follow the same pattern. The number of usual residents fell by 6.7% in Kentish Town North and 6.4% in Gospel Oak, while Kentish Town South remained broadly stable (+0.5%). Household numbers fell in all three wards. Population change therefore cannot be described as one uniform trend across the area.

The proportion of residents born outside the UK rose most noticeably in Kentish Town South, from 34.4% to 38.5%. It also rose in Gospel Oak, from 36.4% to 38.5%, while Kentish Town North changed only slightly. In contrast, the proportion of one-person households remained relatively stable across the three wards. A changing population does not necessarily mean an equally large change in household form.

Initial reflection: These comparisons raise questions about who has been able to remain in the area, who has moved in, and how existing housing accommodates changing lives. The Census figures cannot identify the causes of these changes or establish that residents were displaced. Further research into housing costs, tenure, redevelopment and residents' experiences is needed before drawing conclusions for the design proposal.

Data note: :The figures compare GLA estimates for the same 2022 ward boundaries. They describe two Census snapshots, not a continuous record of change. The 2021 Census was taken during the COVID-19 pandemic, which should be considered when interpreting local population figures.



2.1.2 History

(1)From Landscape to Railway Land

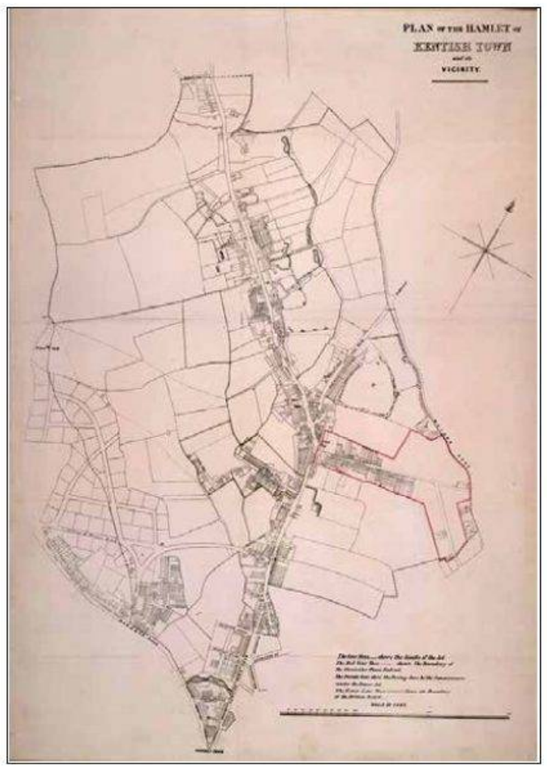
Research question: How did the arrival of the railways change the landscape and spatial structure around today's Regis Road?

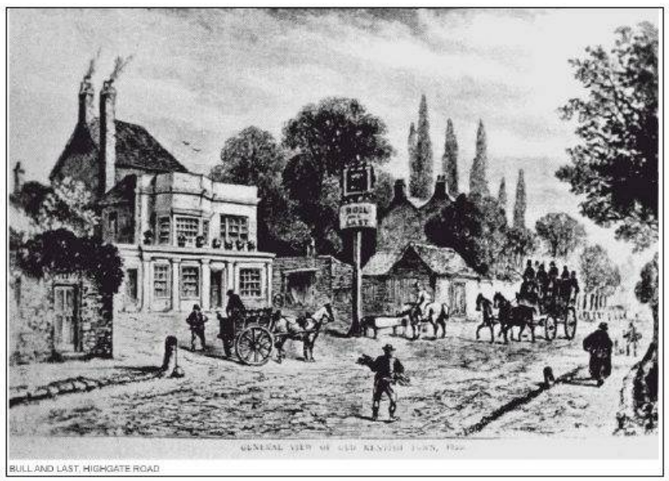
Map reading: Before the railways, Kentish Town developed along the road to Highgate, following the course of the River Fleet. Marshland and orchards formed part of the surrounding landscape. The 1823 map presents a settlement organised primarily around this route, before large railway sites occupied the area.

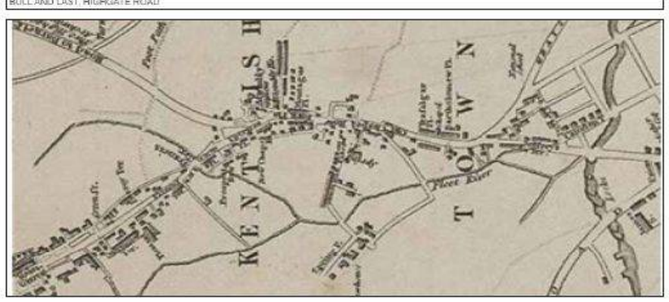
By 1869, railway lines crossed the study area and land around Holmes Road had begun to serve railway operations. This was more than a change in transport: tracks, viaducts and operational land introduced a different scale of plot alongside the growing residential streets.

Spatial analysis: The two maps show a shift from a landscape structured by a road and watercourse to one also structured by railway corridors and large infrastructure plots. The railways created connections across London while dividing movement at the local scale. This contrast helps explain why the land around Regis Road differs from the finer street pattern of Kentish Town.

Initial reflection: The historical maps identify a possible origin of today's large plots and restricted connections, but they do not prove that every present boundary dates from the railway period. I need to compare them with later maps and a site walk to establish which traces remain visible, accessible or in use.




BULL AND LAST, HIGHGATE ROAD



1.2.3

History of the area

The historical development of the framework area has been shaped by three key periods: pre-railway, as a location of significant railway infrastructure and as an industrial area.

Pre-19th Century

Prior to the introduction of the railways in Kentish Town the area was characterised by marshland and orchards. The area was part of a rural settlement to the north of London with a linear street pattern alongside the road to Highgate following the course of the River Fleet.

19th Century

Within a period of 25 years, from the mid 1840s to 1870, Kentish Town was transformed from a small village on the edge of London to suburban growth area with significant new rail infrastructure. The North London Line was built on a large brick viaduct above the southern end of Kentish Town in 1850; The Hampstead Junction Railway, connecting Kentish Town to Gospel Oak, was constructed in the 1860s. The Midland Railway swallowed up all of the remaining unbuilt land between Holmes Road and Highgate Road for sidings, workshops and train sheds.

A large coal depot was established in Holmes Road. Kentish Town and Camden Town became the main centre for piano making, with dozens of factories in the area.

John Sainsbury moved his business from Drury Lane to Queens Crescent in 1872 and set up one of the first Sainsbury's stores on the street.

20th Century

By the early twentieth century, the rail sidings began to retract. The Kentish Town Forum was constructed in 1934, originally as an Art Deco cinema and later as the a live music venue. It has hosted many famous acts including Van Morrison, David Bowie, James Brown, and Nina Simone.

A combination of overcrowding and severe bomb damage during the blitz led to the Council building significant number of new homes to the west of the framework area around Gospel Oak.

It wasn't until the 1980s that the new businesses and industry moved into Regis Road and formed the Kentish Town Business Park. Murphy established its headquarters to the north of the Midland Railway behind Highgate Road in 1984 and still remains there today.

© 2007 - 51A Models of Hull Collection (Alan Whitehead
LMS Patriot 4-6-0 No 5958 (later 5513) at Kentish Town - c. 193

21

1200

13th century The early settlement of Kentish Town established around the High Street and followed the course of the River Fleet. The road was an important route and various inns served travellers between London and the north.

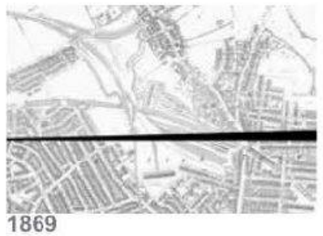
THE CASTLE TAVERN

BULL AND LAST, HIGHGATE ROAD

18th Century The pollution of the Fleet River became an increasing problem and the river was gradually covered over. It still flows under the area today.

1800

1823



1869

1840s-1870 Kentish Town was transformed from a rural settlement to a London suburb and a significant amount of railway infrastructure developed in the area.

1860 The construction of the Hampstead Junction Railway connecting Kentish Town to Gospel Oak. The Midland Railway swallowed up all of the unbuilt land between Holmes Road and Highgate Road for sidings, workshops and train sheds.

1864 The Harrison Estate was bought for goods, coal station, carriage sidings and engine sheds.

1880s A large coal depot was established in Holmes Road. Kentish Town and Camden Town became the main centre for piano making, with dozens of factories in the area.

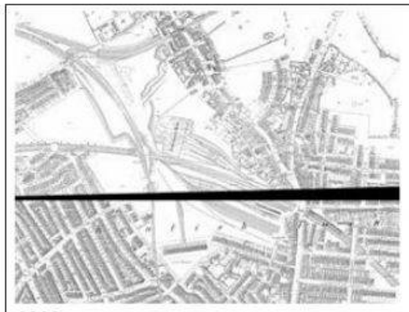
1900

1934 The Forum built and used as a cinema.

1972 Kentish Town City Farm established

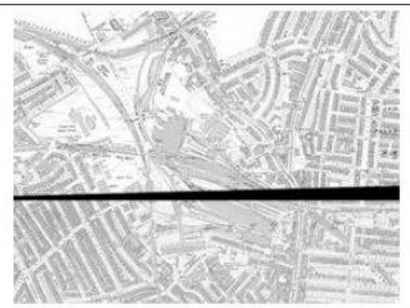
1980s Kentish Town Business Park established on Regis Road and Murphy located their headquarters to the rear of Highgate Road.

2018



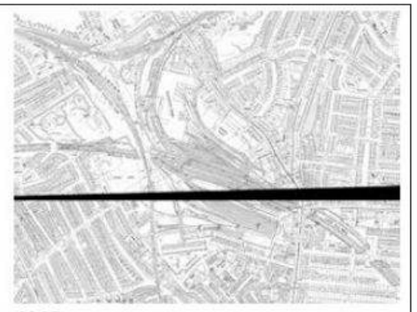
1869

The map shows the introduction of the North London Line, the Midland Mainline and the Hampstead Junction Railway criss-crossing the site. A large coal depot was established in Holmes Road. The suburban growth in the surrounding areas of Gospel Oak and Kentish Town is visible on the map.



1896

In the 1880s Kentish Town West and Gospel Oak stations were opened. The sidings either side of the Midland Mainline increased during the 19th Century as well as the amount of large warehouses that serviced the railways. Significant residential growth to the north and east of Kentish Town is visible in the map.



1915

The area to the north of the Midland Mainline became even more dominated by rail sidings in the early 20th Century, as locamotive sheds were constructed across the site. The Northern Line was opened in 1907. Kentish Town Road became an important shopping centre.

1952

In the first half of the 20th century parts of the district became run down and the Council cleared the first set of dilapidated properties in the early 1930s. During the London Blitz twenty-one high explosive bombs fell on Kentish Town creating the need for more rebuilding.

1963

By 1963 the rail sidings have reduced across the area, though many of the rail related buildings such as the locomotive sheds remain. Significant change has taken place in Gospel Oak, to the west of Kentish Town. The new West Kentish Town estate is visible to the south of Queen's Crescent.

1971

By 1971 the area, with the exception of Regis Road, looks similar to how it looks today. Regis Road industrial estate and the Murphy's occupation of the site to the north of the Midland Mainline took place in the 1980s.

Source: London Borough of Camden, Kentish Town Planning Framework: Draft Site Analysis, 2018, pp. 22-25.?Source:London Borough of Camden, Kentish Town Planning Framework, 2020, pp. 21-22.?Source: London Borough of Camden, Kentish Town Planning Framework: Draft Site Analysis, 2018, pp. 22-23.

(2)Railway and Industrial Production

Research question: How did railway operations and manufacturing shape the productive landscape around Kentish Town?

Historical evidence: Railway land supported more than the movement of trains. In 1864, land near Kentish Town Road was acquired for goods and coal facilities, carriage sidings and engine sheds. The Midland Railway subsequently occupied land between Holmes Road and Highgate Road with sidings, workshops and train sheds. A large coal depot was established on Holmes Road.

The 1896 map shows the expansion of sidings and railway-related warehouses. By 1915, land north of the Midland Mainline had become

-more intensively occupied by sidings and locomotive sheds. Beyond the railway sites, the wider Kentish Town and Camden Town area also supported manufacturing, particularly piano making.

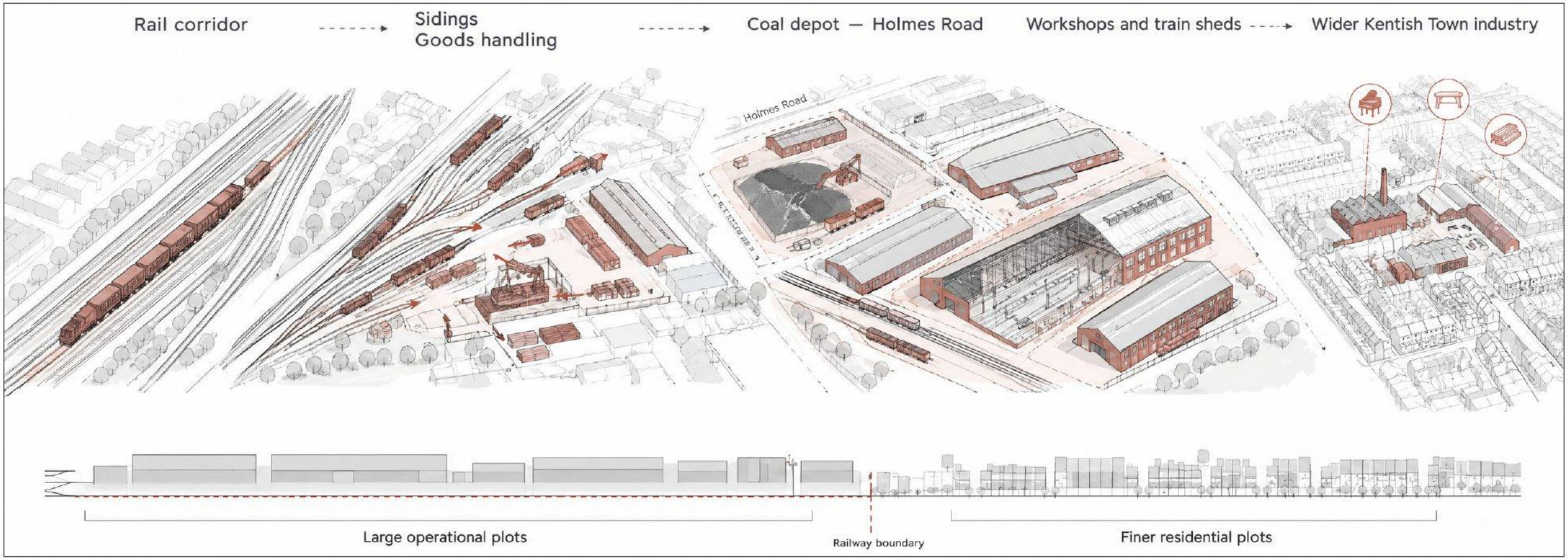
Spatial analysis: Production took several spatial forms: extensive land for storing and moving goods, large buildings for railway work, and factories within the surrounding streets. These activities operated at a different scale from nearby housing and helped establish the large plots and infrastructure edges visible in later maps. The factories mentioned above belonged to the wider district; the maps do not establish that they occupied the present Regis Road site.

Initial reflection: The area's industrial history was a working system, rather than simply a collection of historic buildings. My next step is to distinguish the structures and routes that survive today from activities that have disappeared, and to examine whether current businesses still depend on the area's productive character.

Fig. 1. Kentish Town Locomotive Sheds and surroundings, aerial photograph, August 1926. Source: Britain from Above, EPW016656.

Fig. 2. Steam trains inside the Kentish Town train sheds. Source: Mary Evans Picture Library / Pharcide, via Prints Online.
Fig. 3. Remains of the Midland Railway coal drops, Holmes Road, January 1986. Source: Greater London Industrial Archaeology Society, "Midland Railway coal drops, Holmes Road, Kentish Town," supplement to GLIAS Newsletter 105, August 1986.

Fig. 4 Kentish Town Station, 1938 Fig. 5 Kentish Town locomotive sheds Fig. 6 Winsor & Newton paint box, 1832 Fig. 7 VIEW OF KENTISH TOWN STATION Source: Camden Council, Draft Site Analysis (2018), pp. 26-27.



(3)Housing and Post-war Reconstruction

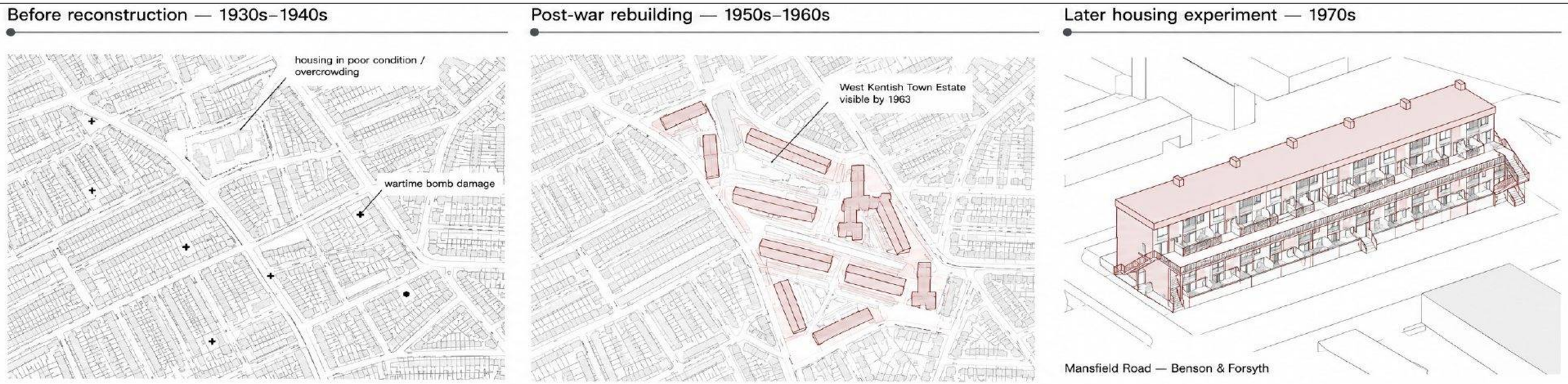
Research question: How did post-war housing reshape the neighbourhood west of Regis Road?

Historical evidence: Overcrowding, poor housing conditions and wartime bomb damage created pressure for rebuilding in Kentish Town. New council housing was developed around Gospel Oak, west of the study area, although Camden records that post-war rebuilding was gradual. By 1963, the West Kentish Town Estate was visible on historical maps. Camden Council, Draft Site Analysis (2018), pp. 22–23, 28–29

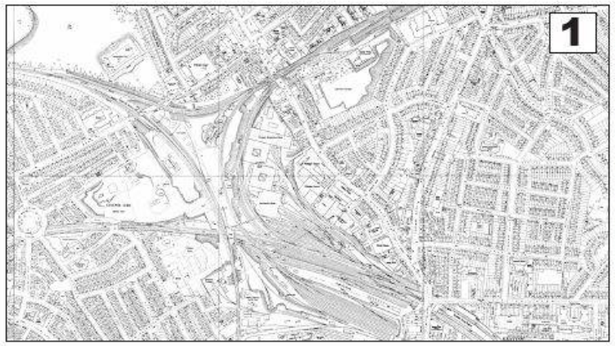
Spatial analysis: This rebuilding changed the residential pattern around the industrial land. In parts of Gospel Oak, larger housing schemes replaced sections of the older street layout, producing a more varied pattern than the Victorian terraces elsewhere in Kentish Town. Mansfield Road, designed by Camden architects Benson and Forsyth, is a later example of this housing experimentation west of Regis Road. Its repeated homes, shared access and planted thresholds offer a useful comparison with the large working plots nearby. Camden Council, Kentish Town Planning Framework (2020), pp. 22–24

Initial reflection: Housing and industry have developed beside one another, but they follow different patterns of access and land use. This history prompts me to examine how a new housing proposal could connect to existing neighbourhoods while accommodating work and the movement it requires.

Figure 1 — Barrington Court: early council housing, 1950s
Figure 2 — Hawkridge House: high-rise housing, 1960s
Figure 3 — Waxham and Ludham: mixed-height housing, 1970s
Figure 4 — Dunboyne Road Estate: low-rise, high-density housing, 1970s



Analytical diagram of post-war housing west of Regis Road. Based on Camden Council (2018, 2020).



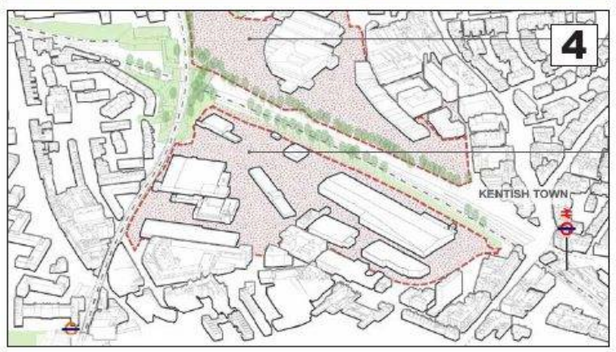


Fig. 1. Regis Road before the industrial estate, 1971.
Fig. 2. Regis Road industrial plots and railway edges.
Fig. 3. Industrial sheds and vehicle space on Regis Road.
Fig. 4. Railway boundaries and the Regis Road entrance.

(4)Regis Road Industrial Estate

Research question: How did Regis Road become an industrial estate, and how does its layout shape access today?

Historical evidence: A 1971 map shows the area before the present industrial estate was built. During the 1980s, new businesses and industries moved into Regis Road, forming Kentish Town Business Park. The estate therefore represents a later phase of industrial development than the railway sidings and coal depots discussed earlier. Camden Council, Draft Site Analysis (2018), pp. 22–23, 28–29.

Spatial analysis: The estate contains low-rise industrial sheds, large yards and surface parking. Railway lines enclose its northern and western edges, while access is concentrated at the Regis Road junction with Kentish Town Road. These large plots and limited entrances make the working area relatively hidden from the surrounding neighbourhood. Camden Council, Kentish Town Planning Framework (2020), pp. 21–22.

Initial reflection: The yards and vehicle access support the businesses operating here, but the railway boundaries and single main entrance also limit connections across the area. This raises a question for the project: how can future changes retain space for work while improving access between Regis Road and its neighbours?

2.1.3 Mobility Networks
(1)Public Transport and Arrival

Research question: How can people reach the Regis Road area, and where do these networks meet the site?

Map reading:

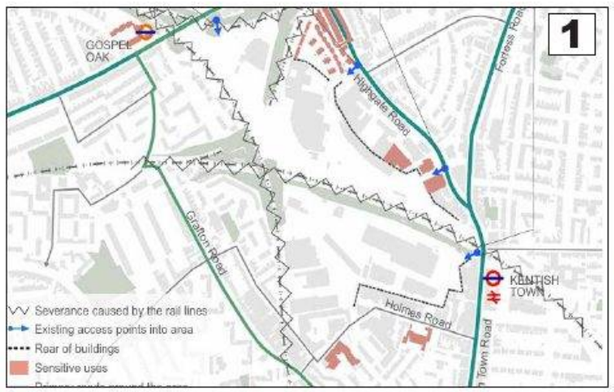
Road network (Fig. 1): Kentish Town Road, Highgate Road and Prince of Wales Road connect the area to surrounding neighbourhoods. Vehicles enter the industrial estate from the junction of Regis Road and Kentish Town Road.

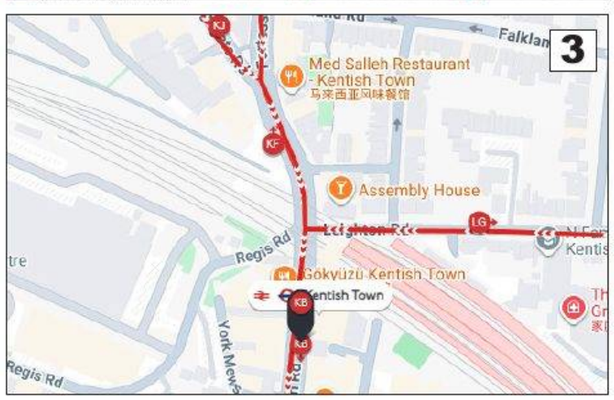
Underground (Fig. 2): Kentish Town station is on the Northern line. It is also served by Thameslink, making the eastern side of the site a rail arrival point.

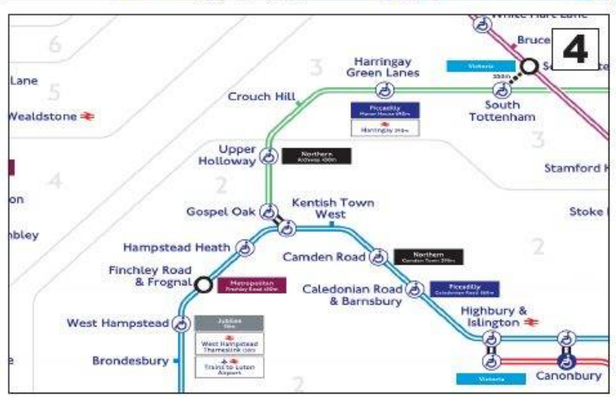
Buses (Fig. 3): Bus routes run along Kentish Town Road, with stops around Kentish Town station. They provide local connections beyond the rail network.

Overground (Fig. 4): Kentish Town West and Gospel Oak are on the Mildmay line. They offer arrival points to the west and north-west of the study area.

Initial reflection: The site is surrounded by several transport choices, but these do not provide equally direct access into Regis Road. The relationship between each stop and the site entrance needs to be tested by walking the routes.







1.2.7

Movement and transport context

A number of constraints and priorities have been identified through the Council's area-wide and transport analysis, and the Kentish Town Future Context Report (July 2019) provided by Transport for London. This area scores 'very high' or 'high' priority against a number of outcome indicators of the Mayor's Transport Strategy as shown below. *Active, green, safe, inclusive* and *quality* are therefore priorities for development in this area.

PRIORITY

VERY HIGH

Green: Very high levels of air pollution particularly on Kentish Town High Street

Inclusive: There is a lack of step free access in this area

HIGH

Active: Pedestrian and cycling densities high to the east but low to the west

Safe: Number of serious accidents surrounding Kentish Town tube station

Quality: Bus loading very high

Connected: Kentish Town Underground at capacity at peak hours

MEDIUM

Efficient: High vehicle congestion in the area – contributing towards worsening pollution levels

VERY LOW

Sustainable: Very well connected by bus, tube and rail links. Very high PTAL levels

Kentish Town Future Context Report, TfL, July 2019

Public transport

The area is extremely well served by public transport, but during peak hours there is limited capacity at Kentish Town Underground station. Crowding on Northern Line trains at Tufnell Park and Kentish Town stations is at the highest level across the network. There is some spare capacity at Gospel Oak and Kentish Town West overground stations and the Kentish Town Thameslink station, where trains to St Pancras International take four minutes. The area is also very well served by bus routes giving the site a very high accessibility rating.

Severance

Much of the framework area is isolated from surrounding areas as a result of the rail infrastructure. Previous access points such as at Arctic Street have also been closed off resulting in no through routes across both Murphy's Yard and the Regis Road area, severing areas to the east and west.

Cycling and walking

Pedestrian and cycle infrastructure in the area is limited despite high demand. Pedestrian access from Kentish Town towards Hampstead Heath is restricted to main roads, and much of the area is severed by the railway infrastructure.

Vehicle usage

The highway network surrounding the development is highly congested, with delays amongst the highest in London on Gordon House Road, Highgate Road, Kentish Town Road and Prince of Wales Road. High vehicle usage and congestion, despite being very accessible via public transport, has caused some of the highest levels of air pollution in London. The number of serious accidents around the station has been identified as a high priority issue in Kentish Town.

Access

Regis Road is the sole point of access into the Regis Road area. Pedestrian movement is prioritised, putting a limit on the junction's capacity to accommodate more vehicular traffic. Murphy's Yard has three access points although there are number of constraints, as highlighted opposite, together with the presence of sensitive uses close to, and sharing these access points. These include social-rented housing and community uses including primary schools, the church, and the Greenwood Centre, which provides services and accommodation for disabled users make access into the site a challenge for heavy goods vehicles.

Constrained access points:

Gordon House Road

- Poor visibility
- High volumes of slow moving traffic in peak hours
- Two well-used pedestrian crossings
- Local weight restriction

Sanderson Close

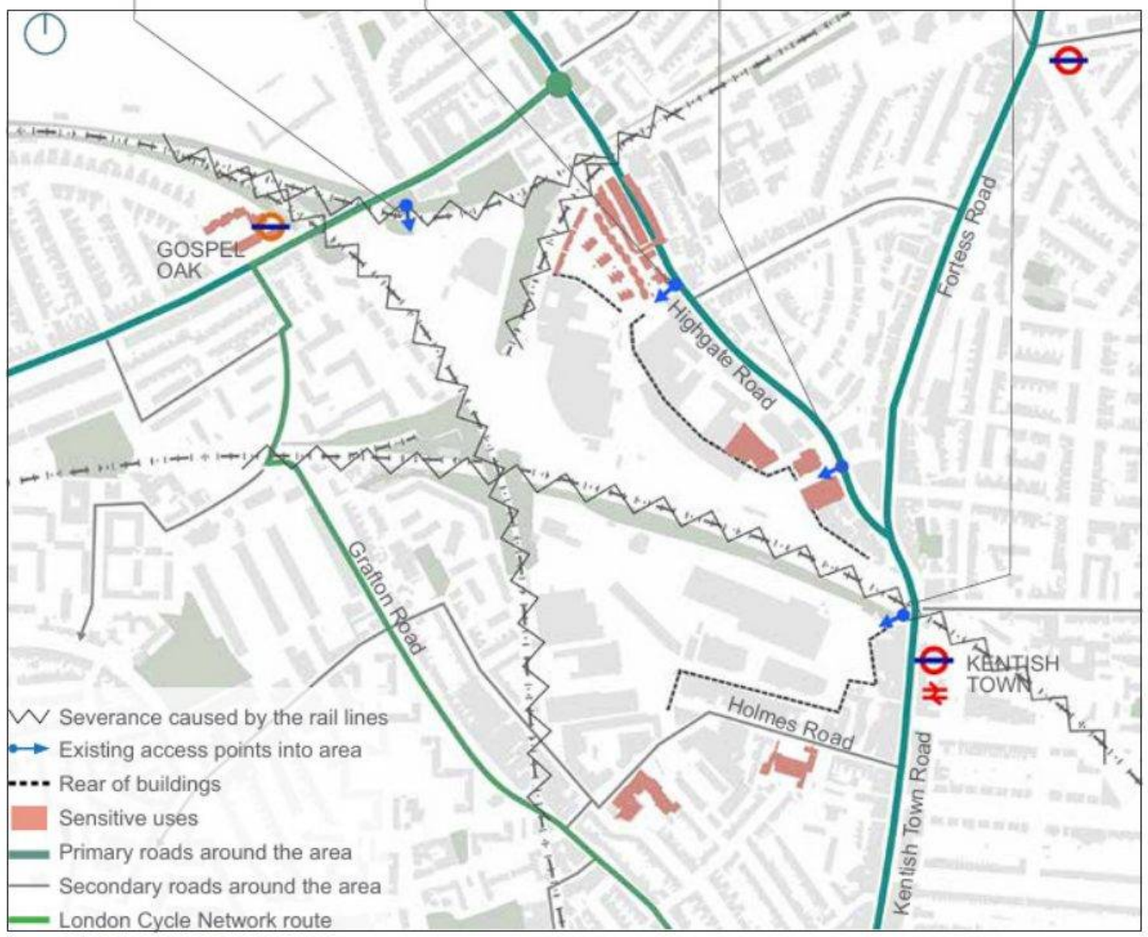
- Principal point of access into Murphy
- HGVs cross the centre line and disrupt traffic
- Not suitable for articulated lorries

Greenwood Place

- Very narrow road width
- Tight corners
- Articulated lorries cannot access site using this junction

Regis Road

- Sole access into Regis Road site
- At capacity at peak hours
- Peak hour queuing north and southbound
- High volumes of pedestrian movement



(2)Street and Vehicle Network

Research question: How do the surrounding roads carry vehicles into the Regis Road industrial area, and where does movement become constrained?

Map reading:

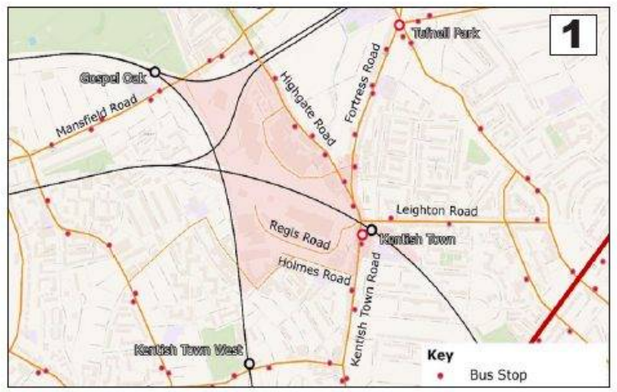
Road structure (Fig. 1): Kentish Town Road provides the main north-south vehicle connection. Highgate Road and Gordon House Road distribute traffic across the wider area, while smaller streets serve the adjoining neighbourhoods.

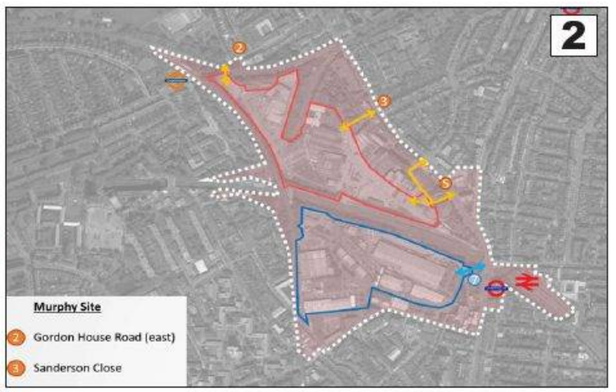
Industrial access (Fig. 2): Regis Road is the only existing vehicle entrance to its large commercial area. Cars, delivery vans and heavy goods vehicles therefore share one access point.

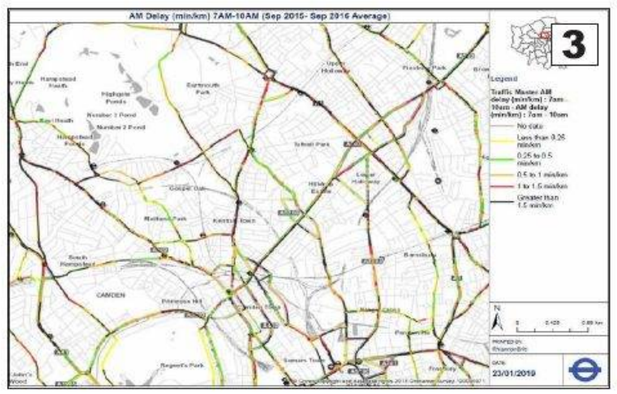
Vehicle delay (Fig. 3): TfL's morning peak map identifies delay on Kentish Town Road, Highgate Road and Gordon House Road. This places the industrial entrance beside an already busy road network.

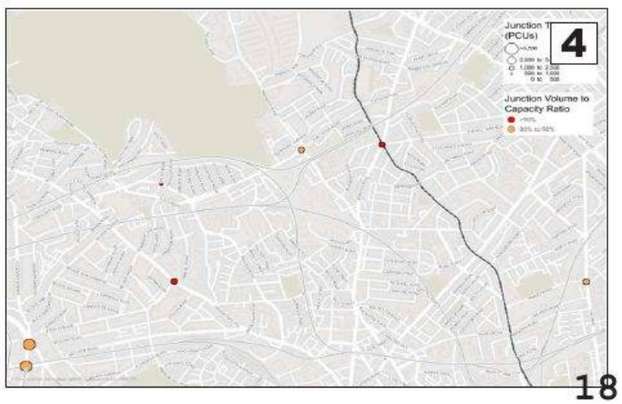
Junction pressure (Fig. 4): The Regis Road junction and nearby main road junctions form important pinch points. Vehicle access must also accommodate the many people crossing near Kentish Town station.

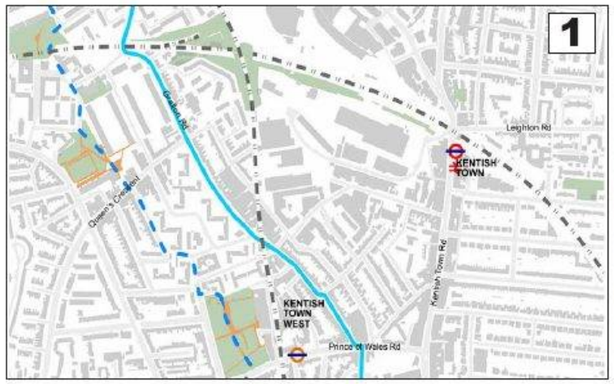
Initial reflection: The issue is not simply the number of roads, but the concentration of vehicle movements at a few entrances and junctions. Any proposal should test servicing access alongside safer pedestrian movement.

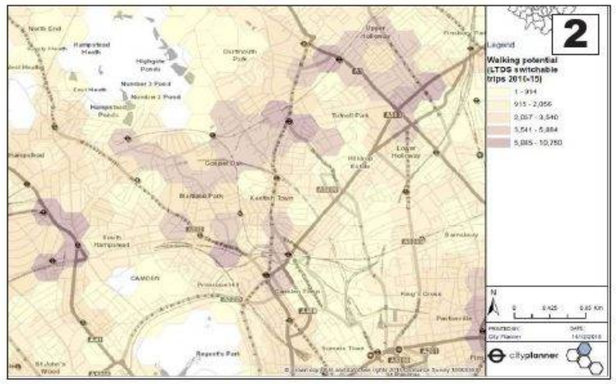


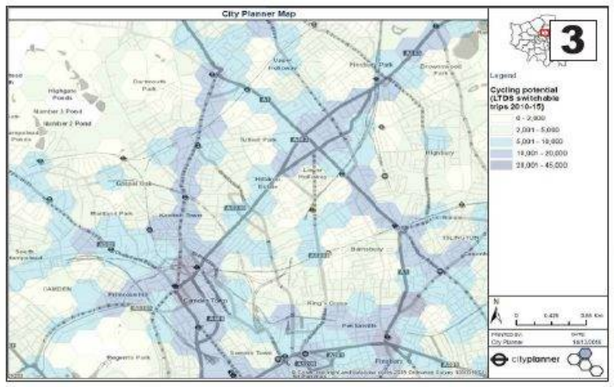


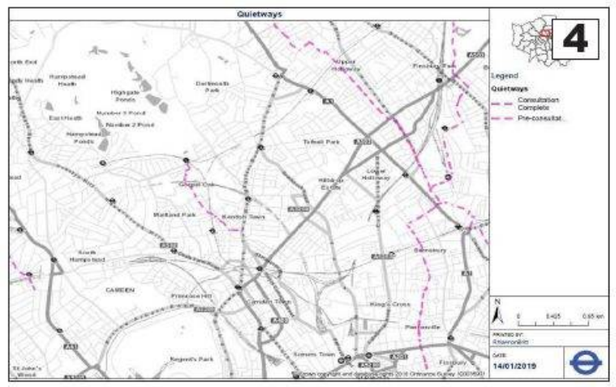












(3)Walking and Cycling Routes

Research question: Where do people walk and cycle around Regis Road, and how well do these routes connect to the site?

Map reading:

Mapped routes (Fig. 1): The 2018 route map shows a signed cycle connection through quieter streets via Grafton Road. Railway land limits the number of routes crossing the area.

Walking activity (Fig. 2): TfL's pedestrian density map shows more walking around Kentish Town and Kentish Town West stations than around Gospel Oak. This highlights the importance of routes from the stations to the site.

Cycling activity (Fig. 3): Modelled morning cycle flows are strongest around Kentish Town Road. A busy cycling corridor passes close to Regis Road, but the map does not show an equally direct route through the industrial area.

Cycling potential (Fig. 4): TfL identifies further potential for cycling on Kentish Town Road and Fortess Road. This represents trips that could reasonably be cycled, rather than trips already made by bicycle.

Initial reflection: The surrounding streets support walking and cycling, but the railway and limited access points interrupt direct journeys across the site. The next step is to test these gaps and crossings on foot.

(4)Barriers and Access Points

Research question: Which physical barriers limit movement across Regis Road, and where can people enter the area?

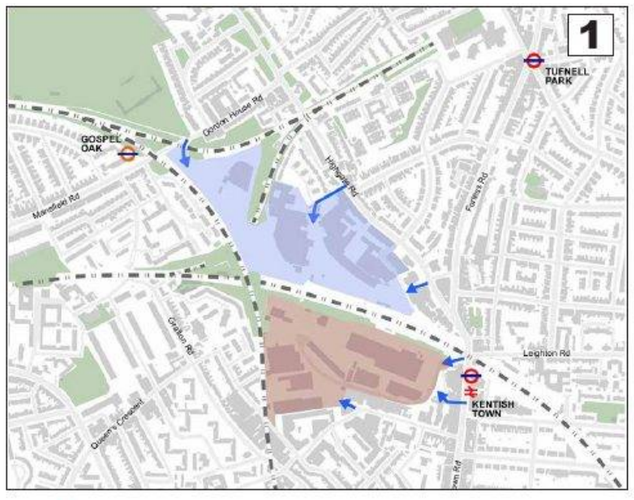
Map reading:

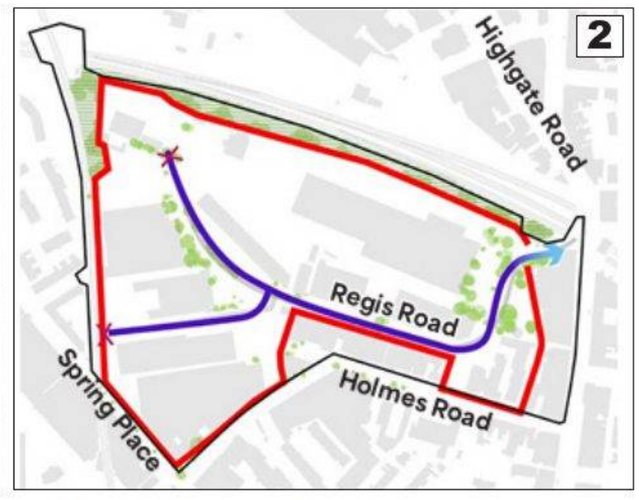
Railway barrier (Fig. 1): Railway land separates the industrial area from neighbourhoods to the west. The wider access map shows that entry points are concentrated on the eastern side.

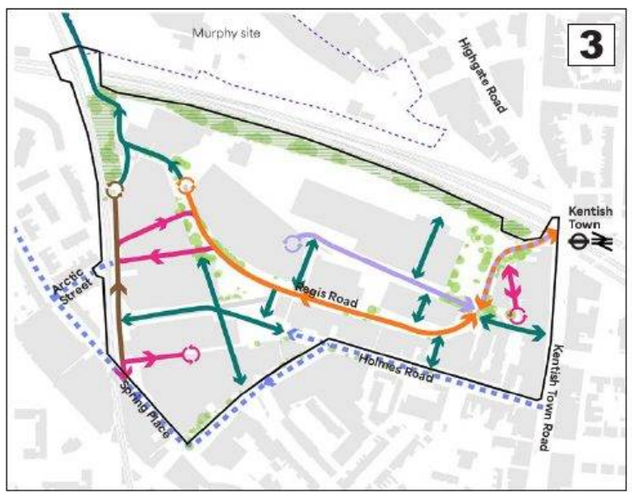
Existing access (Fig. 2): The more detailed Regis Road map marks the current entrance, dead ends and streets with no site entry. A nearby street does not necessarily provide a route into or across the site.

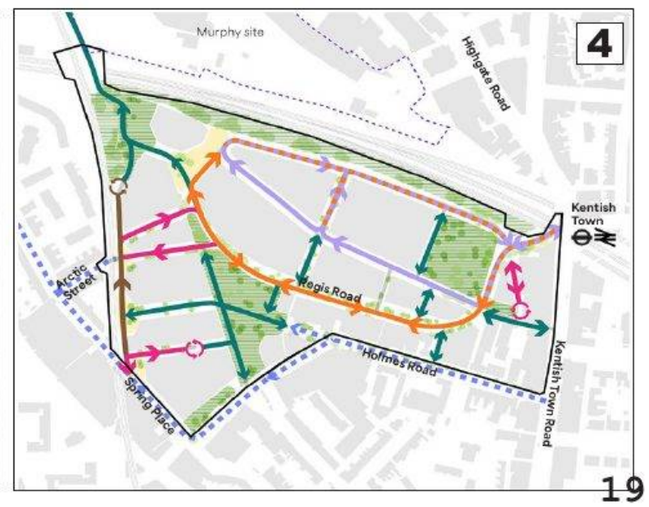
Proposed connections (Figs. 3-4): Camden's guidance shows additional routes required as different land parcels are redeveloped. These diagrams describe future connections; they should not be read as existing paths.

Initial reflection: The barrier is created by both the railway and the limited number of usable entrances. A site visit should check where routes end, how entrances are controlled and which proposed links would make the greatest difference to walking journeys.









2.1.4 Community Networks and Voices

(1)Daily Activity

Research question: Where are everyday destinations around Regis Road, and when are they available to local people?

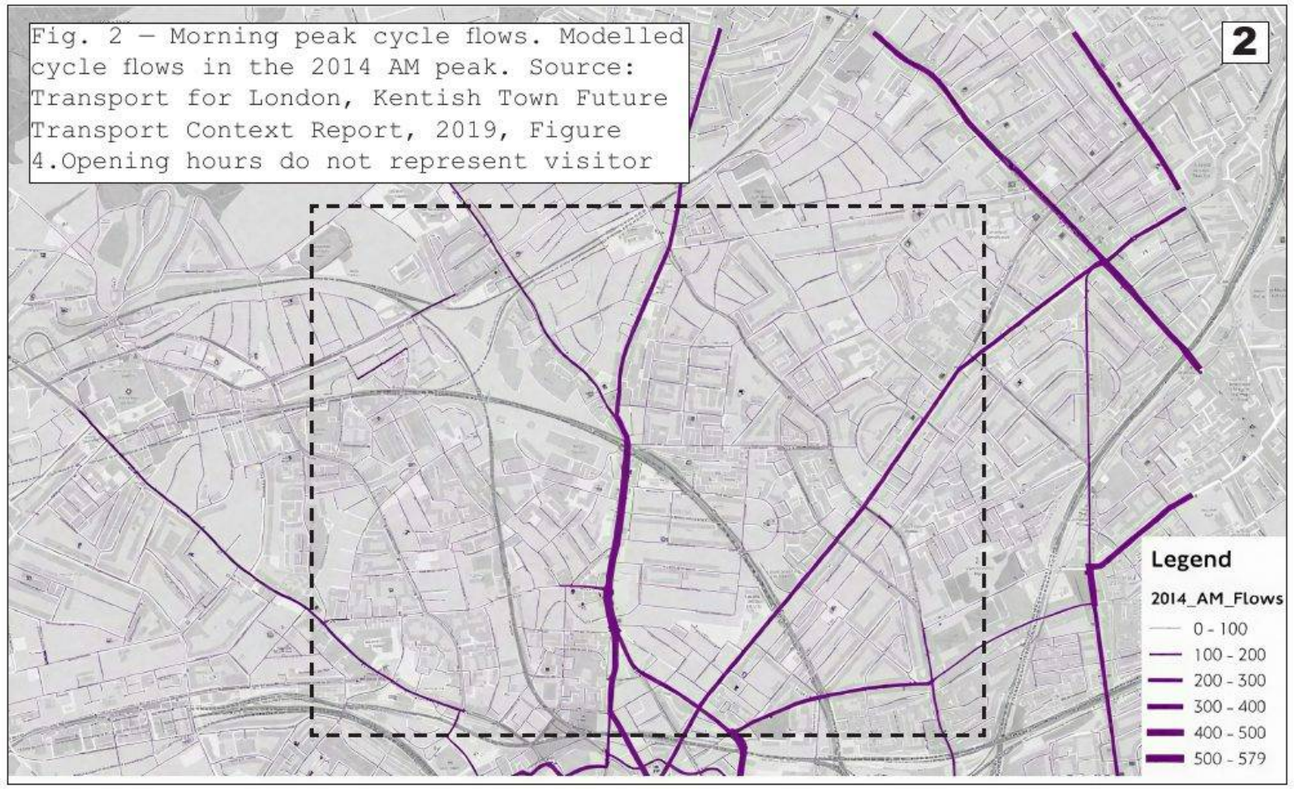
Analysis: Daily activity is distributed unevenly across the area. Kentish Town Road is an important pedestrian corridor, while Kentish Town and Kentish Town West stations are concentrations of walking activity. To the west, Queen's Crescent Market brings an additional pattern of shopping and social activity on Thursdays and Saturdays. Other community destinations, including Kentish Town City Farm and Kentish Town Community Centre, support learning, care and social contact during the day.

Regis Road also has a public daily function: residents use its reuse and recycling centre between 09:00 and 16:00. However, the wider business park has limited access points and does not provide a direct route across the area. The contrast is therefore spatial as well as temporal: several nearby destinations invite public use, while movement through Regis Road remains restricted.

Key finding: The neighbourhood's daily life depends on different groups—commuters, workers, shoppers, families and people using local services—but their activities do not all meet in one connected public space.differs from the finer street pattern of Kentish Town.

Evidence limit: The maps show wider pedestrian patterns, and the timetable shows published opening hours. Neither measures the number of people using Regis Road at each time of day. On-site observation would be needed to test those patterns.

Fig. 1 — Daily activity timetable. Published opening hours of four selected local destinations. Source: Camden Council, Camden Cindex and Kentish Town Community Centre; compiled 8 October 2026. Opening hours do not represent



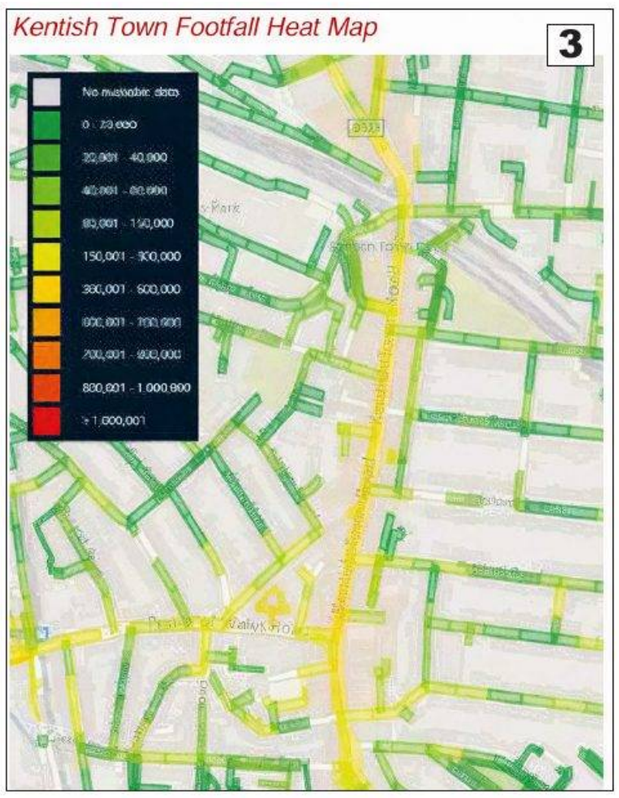


Fig. 3 — Kentish Town footfall heat map. Pedestrian activity is concentrated along Kentish Town Road. Source: Datscha, reproduced in London Borough of Camden, Camden Retail & Leisure Study, Volume C, p. 135.

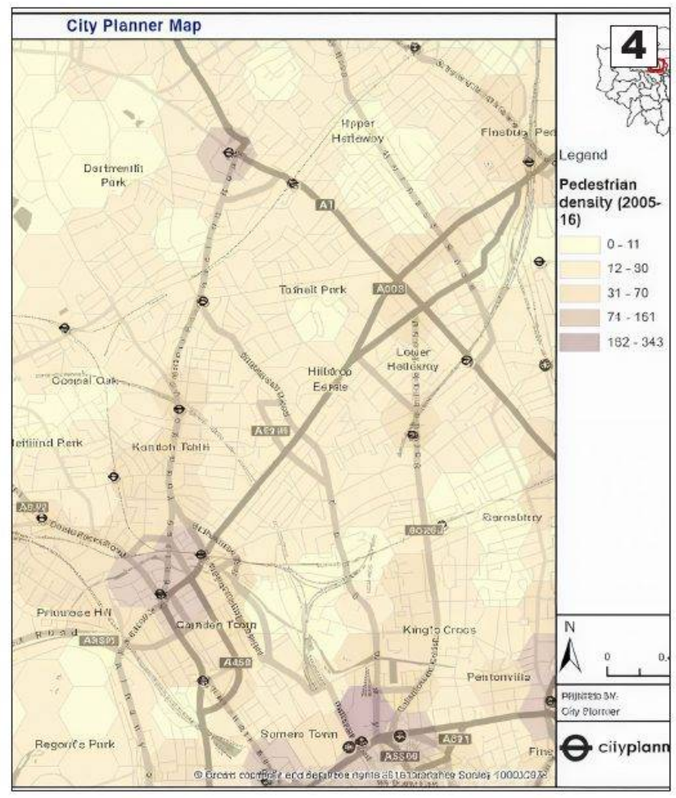


Fig. 4 — Daily activity timetable. Published opening hours of four selected local destinations. Source: Camden Council, Camden Cindex and Kentish Town Community Centre; compiled 8 October 2026.

(2)Community Facilities and Networks

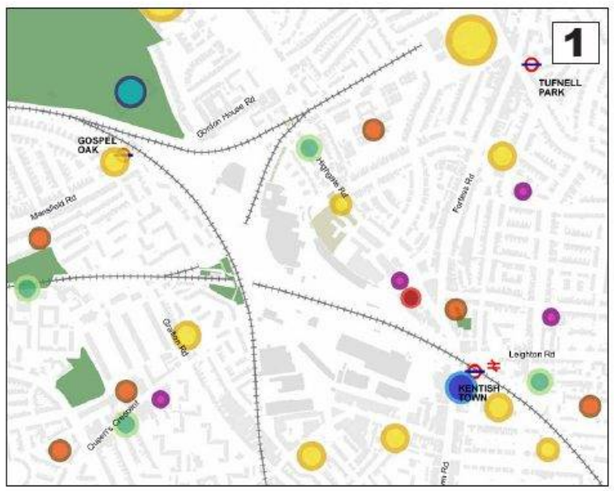
Research question: How do facilities around Regis Road connect residents to learning, care and support?

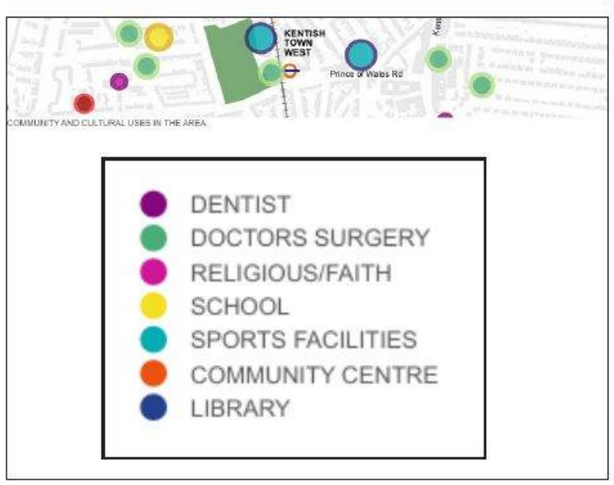
Map reading: Camden's community facilities map shows schools, community centres, libraries, health and sports facilities across Kentish Town and Gospel Oak. It establishes where services are located, but does not show who uses them.

Service networks: Kentish Town City Farm connects school groups, families and volunteers through nature based activities. Kentish Town Community Centre provides a community space and food bank; the food bank receives referrals from schools, support workers and voluntary organisations. QCCA provides services for young people, preschool children and older residents across several sites.

Key finding: Community support is spread across several organisations and places. Access to these existing networks matters as much as the provision of a new facility.

Evidence limit: Published descriptions show service pathways, but do not establish how many Regis Road residents use them or whether these three organisations work directly together.





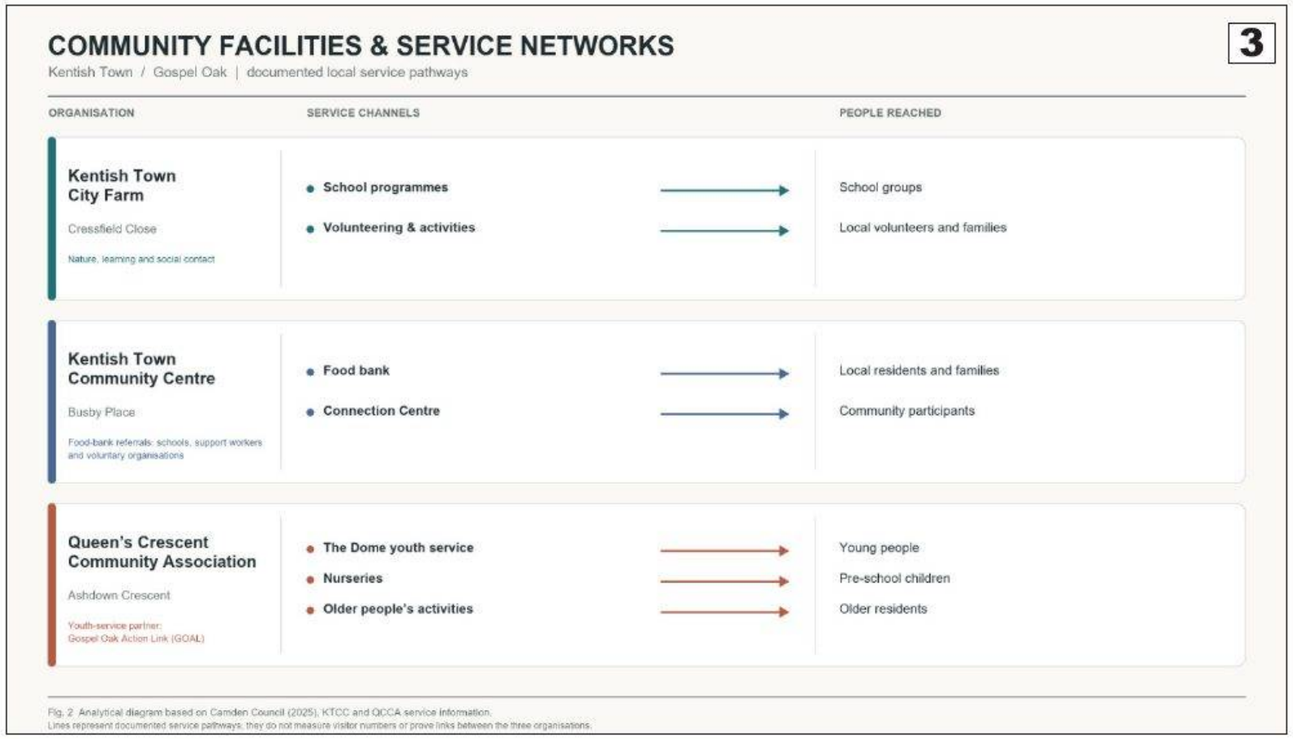


Fig. 1 — Community facilities. Camden's map shows the distribution of schools, health services, libraries and community centres around Kentish Town and Gospel Oak.

Fig. 2 — Local community anchors.Photographs of Kentish Town City Farm and QCCA show the people and activities supported by these two organisations.

Fig. 3 — Service pathways. Analytical diagram showing how the City Farm, Kentish Town Community Centre and QCCA connect services with different groups of residents. Based on Camden Council (2025) and the organisations' service information.

Fig. 4 — Community partners and missions.The table records organisations' stated interest in Camden's four programme themes. Its dots do not indicate direct partnerships.

(3)Local Voices and Priorities

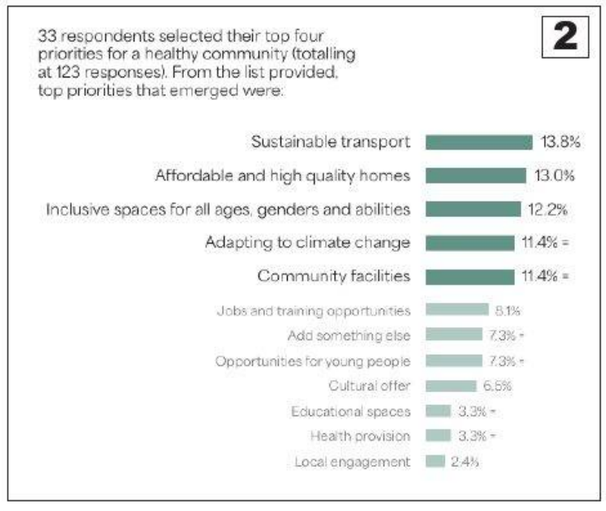
Research question: What do local people want future change around Regis Road to provide or protect?

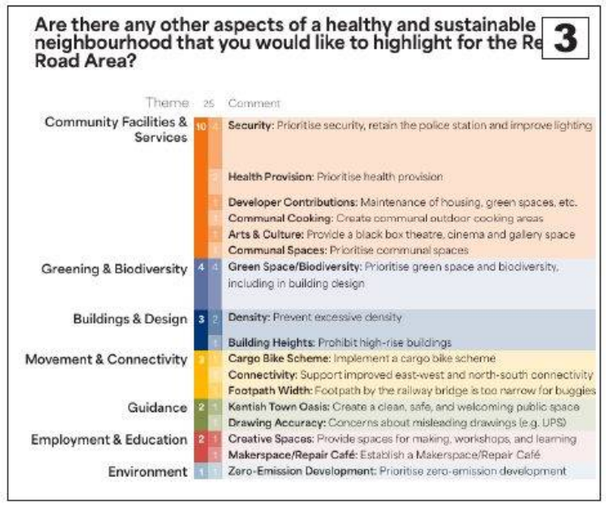
Earlier priorities: In Camden's 2018 engagement, respondents supported local shops, access to jobs and apprenticeships, school capacity, and cultural facilities. Comments also called for spaces specifically for young people.

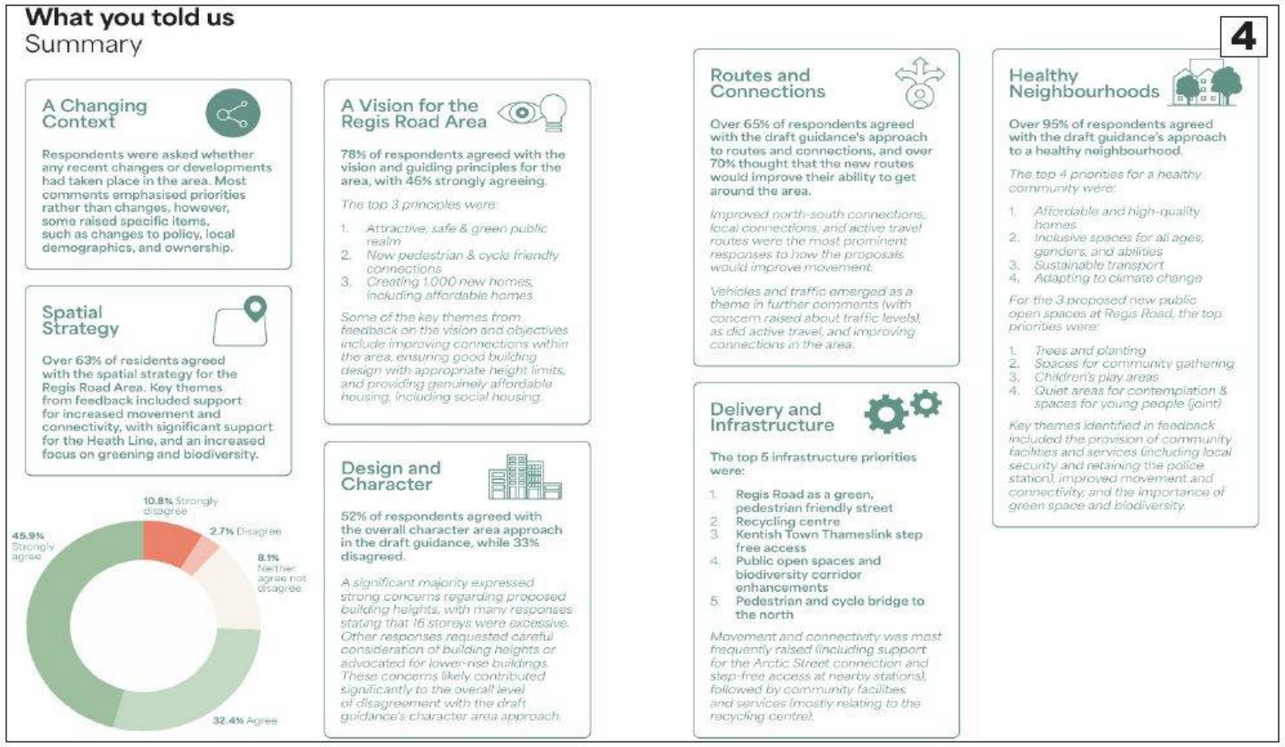
Recent priorities: In the 2024 Regis Road consultation, people prioritised inclusive green spaces for gathering, play and quieter activities. Responses also raised the future of the recycling centre and police presence. These concerns show that new public space and existing everyday services both matter.

Initial reflection: A proposal should provide places where different groups can meet while protecting access to services people already rely on.

Evidence limit: Consultation participants chose to respond; their views should not be treated as a complete account of all local residents' needs.







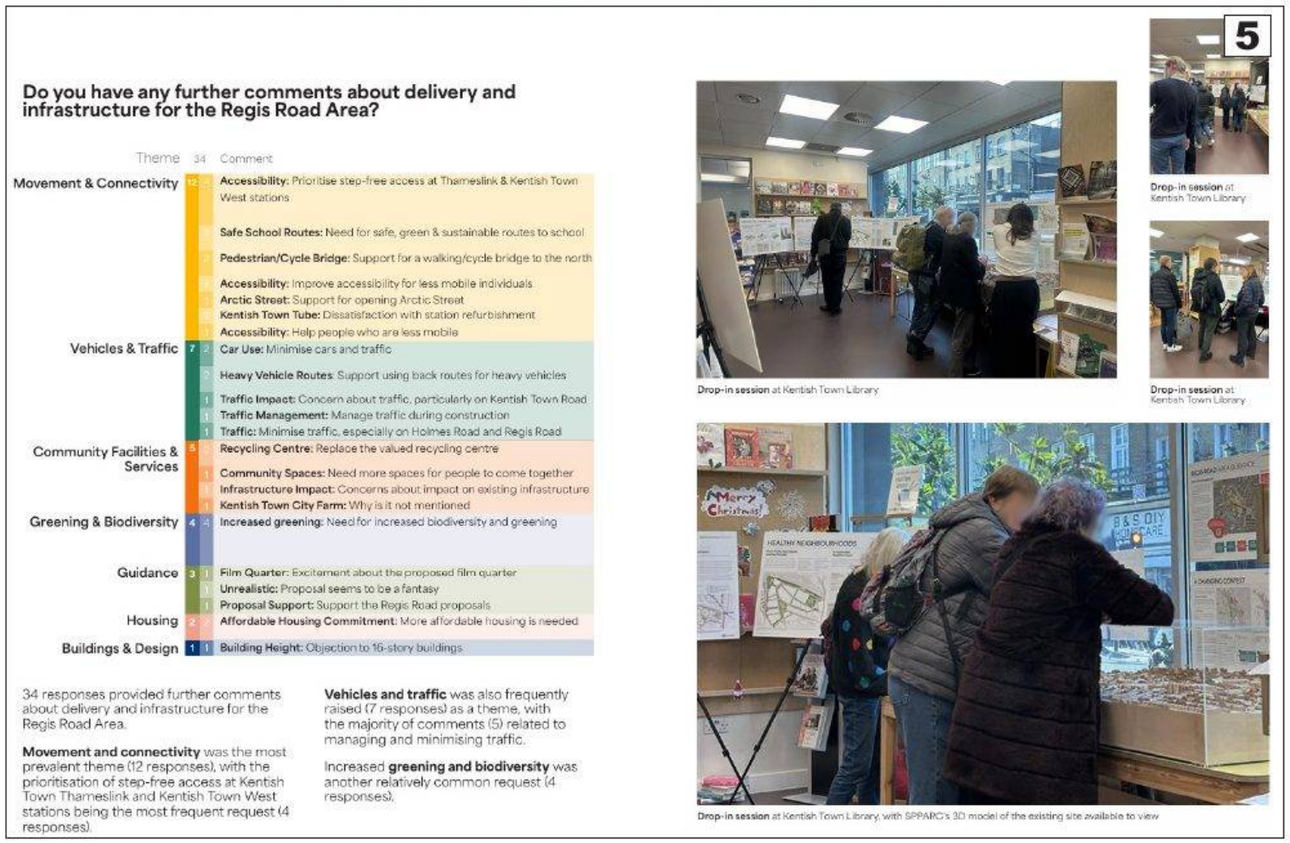


Fig. 1 — Community and cultural priorities. Camden public engagement, 2018.
Fig. 2 — Healthy neighbourhood priorities. Regis Road consultation, 2024.
Fig. 3 — Additional community suggestions. Regis Road consultation, 2024.
Fig. 4 — Consultation feedback summary. Camden Council, 2024.
Fig. 5 — Public consultation at Kentish Town Library. Camden Council, 2024.

2.1.5 Local Economy

(1)Employment and Business Mix

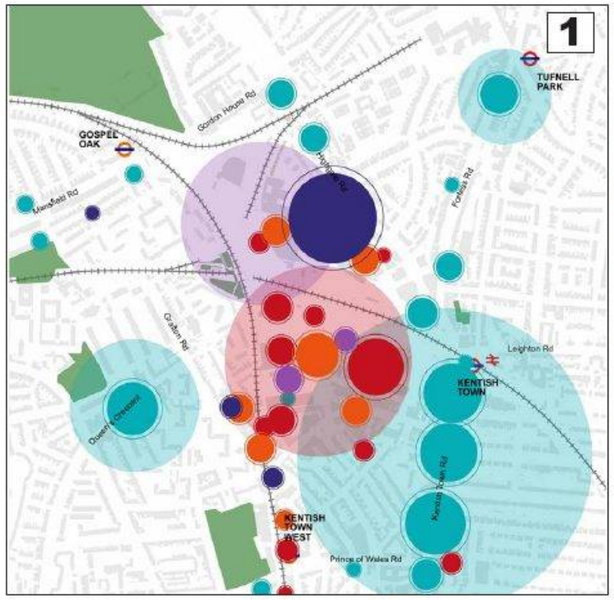
Research question: What kinds of businesses and jobs has Regis Road supported?

Map reading: Camden's business map places industrial and employment uses at Regis Road, with a digital and creative cluster around Highgate Road.

Data analysis: A 2015 study recorded 20 business units and 38,200 m² of employment space at Regis Road. Warehousing and distribution occupied 68% of that space; industrial uses and yards occupied 25%; offices occupied 7%. The study estimated approximately 981 jobs rather than counting employees directly.

Initial reflection: Much of the area's economic activity takes place in warehouses and workspaces that are less visible from surrounding streets.

Evidence limit: These figures describe a 2015 baseline, not the current number of businesses or jobs.



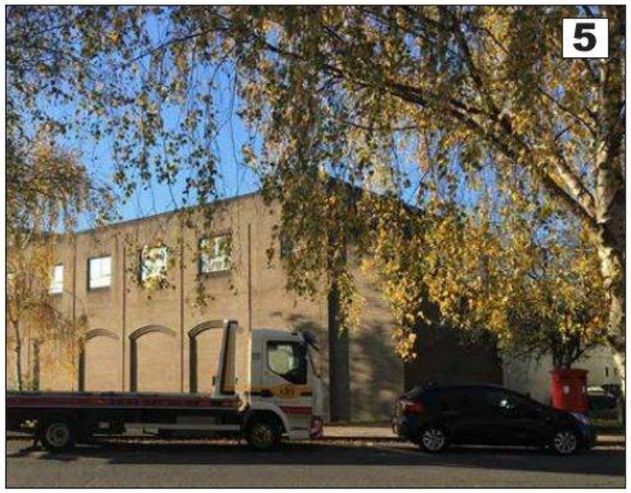


Fig. 1 — Business clusters around Regis Road. Camden Council, 2018.
Fig. 2 — Camden Recycling Centre, Regis Road. Camden Council, 2018.
Fig. 3 — Employment floorspace by activity. Based on AECOM / GL Hearn, 2015.
Fig. 4 — UPS depot, Regis Road. Camden Council, 2018.
Fig. 5 — Fairfax Meadow, Regis Road. Camden Council, 2018.

(2)Industrial Operations

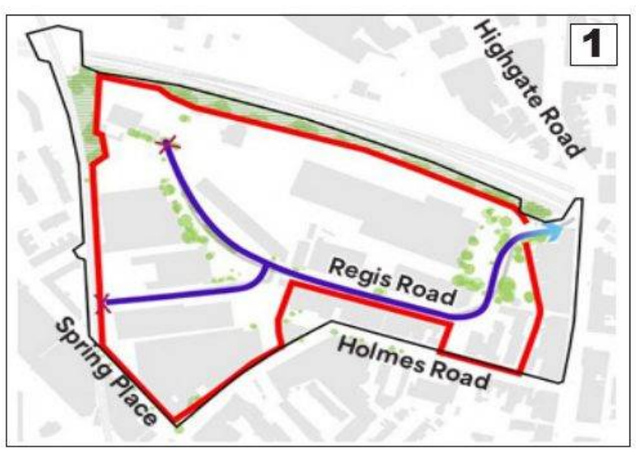
Research question: What space and access do industrial activities at Regis Road require?

Operational evidence: The 2015 study records 24-hour access, vehicle circulation and off-street loading for the UPS and Royal Mail depots. Building supplies needed a storage yard, while the recycling centre needed space to store and process materials.

Spatial analysis: These activities depend on the space around buildings as well as the buildings themselves. Loading areas, yards and vehicle routes are part of the working landscape.

Initial reflection: Future changes to Regis Road should accommodate servicing while making public routes safer. Camden's 2025 guidance proposes designated service roads for larger vehicles.

Evidence limit: The business requirements were recorded in 2015; the 2025 routes are proposals, not completed changes.



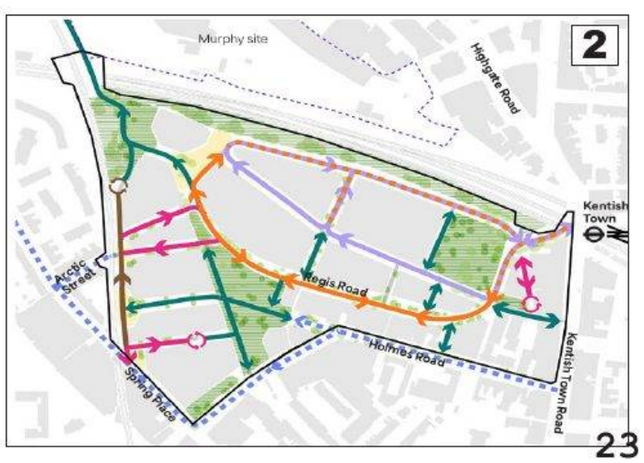


Figure 5.1: Examples of Business Typologies

3

1. Small Office Type Space

2. Large Office Type Space

3. Workshop Type Space

4. Small Industrial / Warehouse Type Space

5. Large Industrial / Warehouse Type Space

6. Yard / Open Storage Type Space

Table 5.2: Compatibility of Business Typologies with Mixed Use Redevelopment

4

Business Unit	Business Name	Operational Requirements	Environmental Considerations	Compatibility with Mixed Use Development		
				Multi-block	Block	Building
1	UPS	24h access and regular servicing Requires off street loading / unloading Circulation space and regular access for HGV vehicles.	Potential adverse noise considerations due to 24hr operational working			
2	Asphaltic	Circulation space and regular access for HGV vehicles Large yard type space for the storage of materials Requires off street loading / unloading	Minimal environmental considerations			
3	Royal Mail	24h access and regular servicing Circulation space and regular access for HGV vehicles Requires off street loading / unloading	Potential adverse noise considerations due to 24hr operational working			
4	Fairfax Meadow	Circulation and regular access for HGV vehicles Requires off street loading / unloading	Potential adverse noise considerations from large numbers of vehicle movements			
5	Spire BMW	Likely to require off street loading / unloading Circulation space for car storage and movements	Likely to be adverse noise considerations during regular working hours			
6	EKO	On street loading / unloading likely to be adequate	Minimal environmental considerations			
7	Caravelle Direct	No direct operational requirements	Minimal environmental considerations			
8	Wren&Co	No direct operational requirements	Minimal environmental considerations			
9	Plumb Inn	Likely to require off street loading / unloading	Potential for small scale adverse noise considerations from deliveries and vehicle movements.			

HOW INDUSTRIAL SPACE WORKS

5

Regis Road operational requirements recorded in 2015

ACTIVITY	SPACE AND ACCESS	POTENTIAL DESIGN INTERFACE
Parcel + mail UPS / Royal Mail	24-hour access · HGV circulation Off-street loading and unloading	Noise from round-the-clock operations
Building supplies Asphaltic Roofing	Large material-storage yard HGV access · off-street loading	Space for vehicles and materials
Food distribution Fairfax Meadow	Regular HGV access and circulation Off-street loading and unloading	Noise from frequent vehicle movements
Reuse + recycling Camden Recycling Centre	Large yard for storing and processing waste materials	Possible noise, visual and air-quality effects

Fig. 1 — Existing access to Regis Road.
Fig. 2 — Proposed routes and servicing access.
Fig. 3 — Six business space types at Regis Road.
Fig. 4 — Industrial operations and mixed-use compatibility.
Fig. 5 — Space and access needs of key industrial activities.

(3)Local Shops and Everyday Economy

Research question: How do nearby shops and markets meet everyday needs around Regis Road?

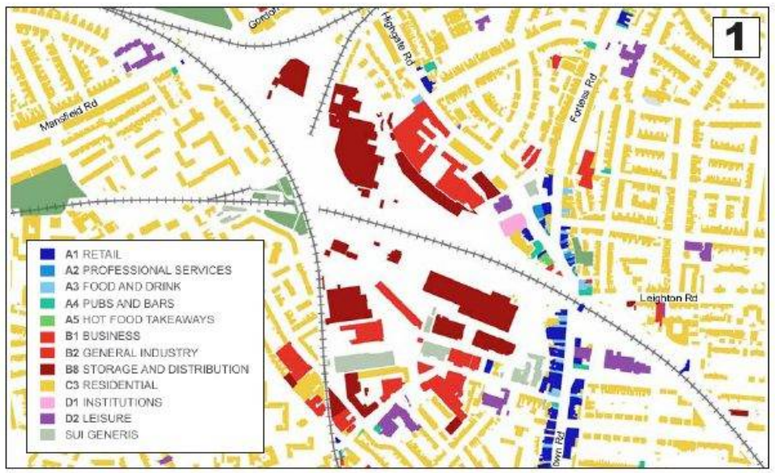
Map reading: Camden's maps place Regis Road beside Kentish Town town centre, with Queen's Crescent and Mansfield Road among the nearby neighbourhood centres. Retail and food uses are found mainly along these surrounding streets.

Market evidence: Queen's Crescent has permanent shops and cafés as well as a street market. In Camden's 2023 study, 16 of its 95 available market pitches were occupied, indicating unused trading capacity at that time.

Recent change: Improvements completed in 2025 added planting, seating, lighting and electrical supply for market traders.

Initial reflection: Future routes and ground-floor uses at Regis Road could support visits to existing shops and the market.

Evidence limit: Current pitch occupancy, local spending and the number of Regis Road workers using these businesses have not been established.



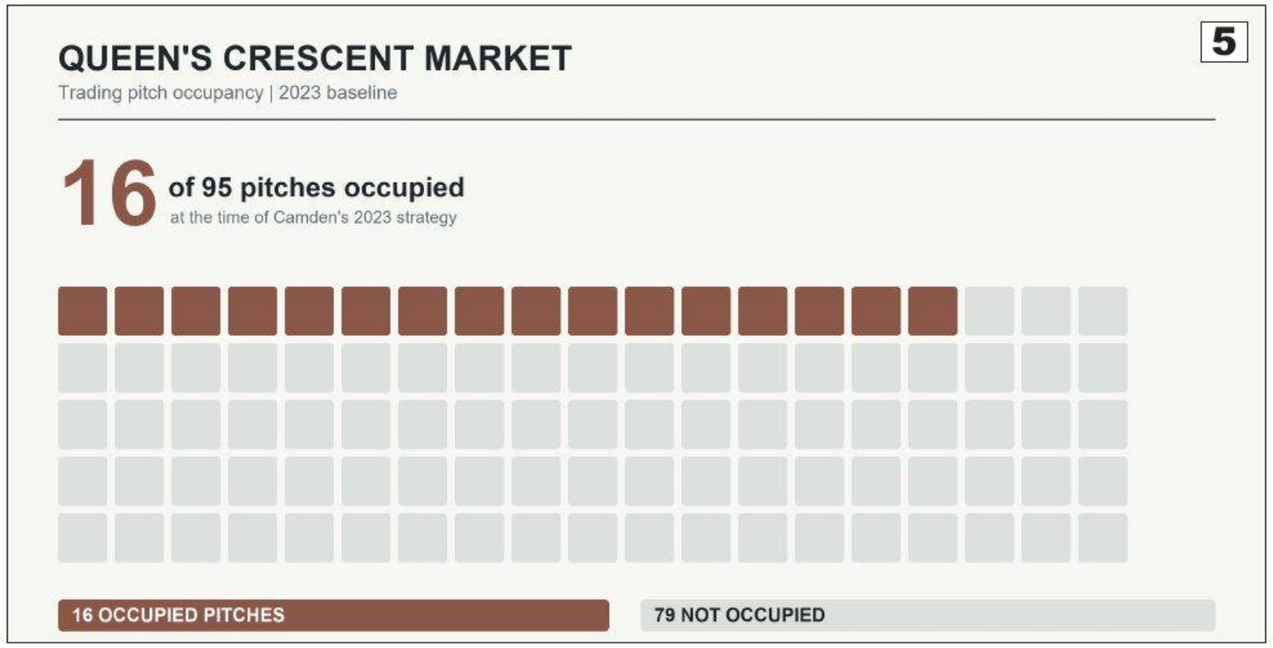


Fig. 1 — Land use around Regis Road.
Fig. 2 — Nearby town and neighbourhood centres.
Fig. 3 — Trading at Queen's Crescent Market.
Fig. 4 — Queen's Crescent after street improvements.
Fig. 5 — Market pitch occupancy, 2023.

(4)Economic Change and Local Benefit

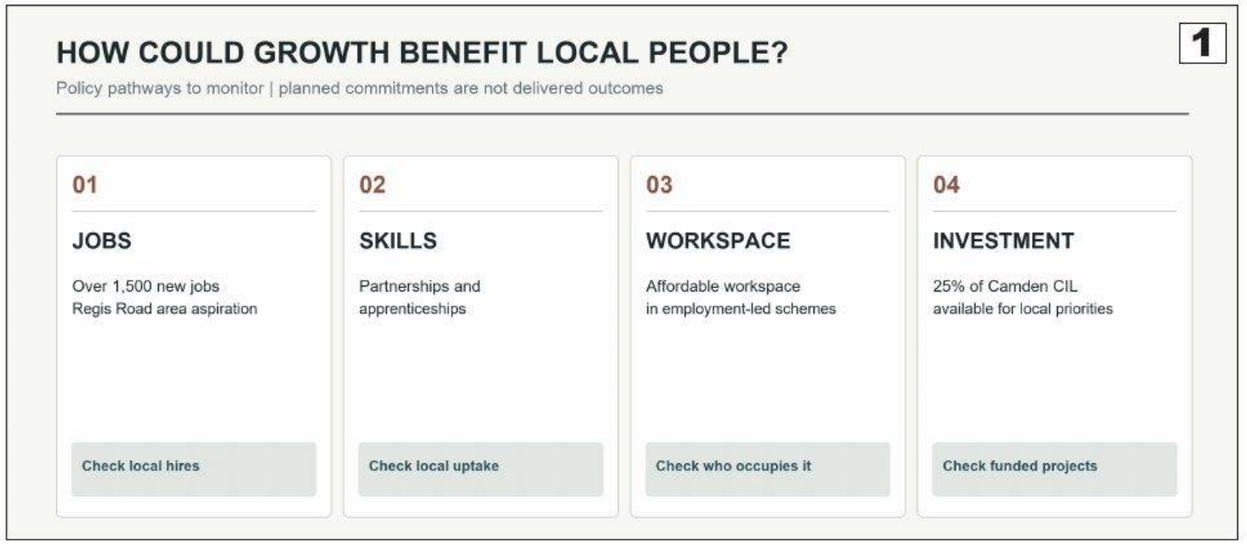
Research question: How might redevelopment change the economy of Regis Road, and who would benefit locally?

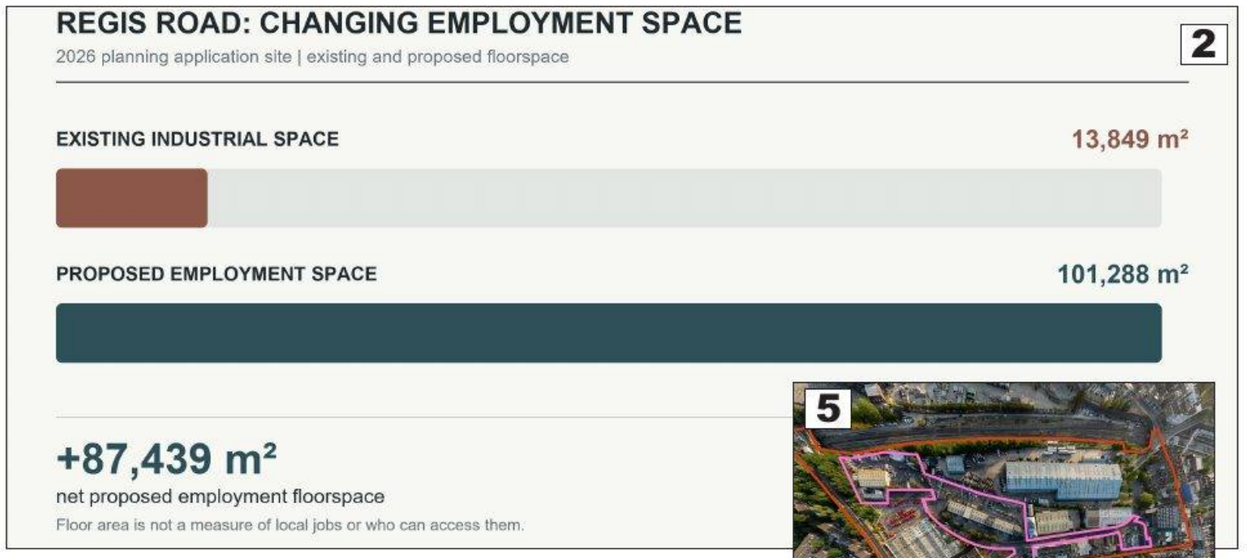
Evidence of change: A 2026 planning report compares 13,849 m² of existing industrial floorspace on the application site with 101,288 m² of proposed employment space, mainly film studios. Most existing industrial uses would not be re-provided, apart from the recycling centre.

Local benefits: Camden's area guidance aims for over 1,500 new jobs across Regis Road. It also identifies apprenticeships, local partnerships and affordable workspace as ways to connect growth with local people and businesses.

Initial reflection: More employment space could bring new opportunities, but its value to the neighbourhood depends on local hiring, access to training and workspace that local businesses can afford.

Evidence limit: These are plans and targets. The number of local people employed or trained, and the effect on existing businesses, cannot yet be measured.





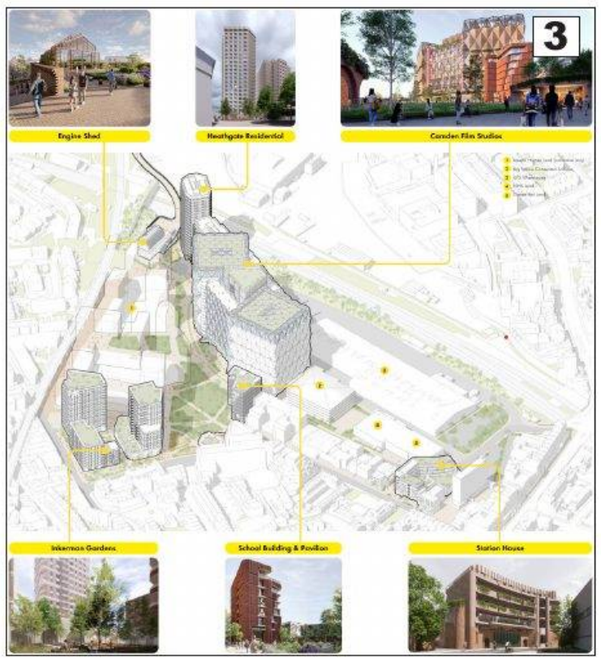


Fig. 1 — Proposed pathways to local economic benefit.
Fig. 2 — Existing and proposed employment floorspace.
Fig. 3 — Camden Film Quarter illustrative masterplan.
Fig. 4 — Proposed London Screen Academy, visualisation.
Fig. 5 — Existing industrial site and development boundary.

2.1.6 Local Culture and Events

(1)Employment and Business Mix

Research question: Which cultural places shape the identity of Kentish Town around Regis Road?

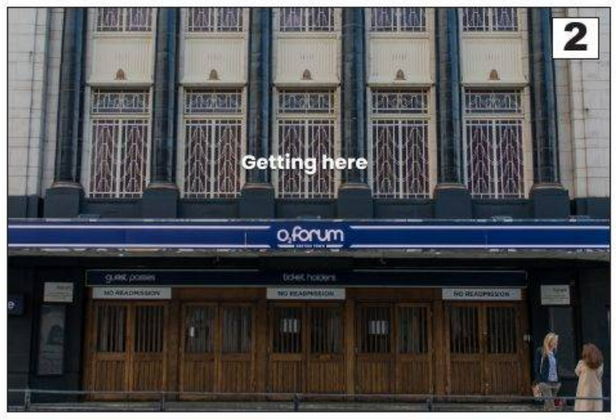
Place reading: Camden's planning material identifies the O2 Forum and smaller arts venues as part of Kentish Town's cultural character. Today, the Lion & Unicorn Theatre and Torriano Meeting House also provide spaces for theatre, poetry and grassroots arts.

Spatial analysis: These places are spread across the high street and nearby residential streets, while Regis Road is largely an industrial estate. Cultural identity therefore extends beyond the development boundary. Camden also identifies the area's industrial heritage as something future development could reveal.

Initial reflection: New cultural space at Regis Road should connect with established local venues and make room for small-scale, community-led activity.

Evidence limit: A list of venues does not show who attends, how often they visit or whether activities are affordable to local residents.

Fig. 1 — Lion & Unicorn Theatre.
Fig. 2 — O2 Forum Kentish Town.
Fig. 3 — Torriano Meeting House.
Fig. 4 — Neighbourhood map displayed at Torriano.
Fig. 5 — Community arts gathering at Torriano.
Fig. 6 — Camden's 2018 Community and Culture planning board.



(2)Events and Public Space

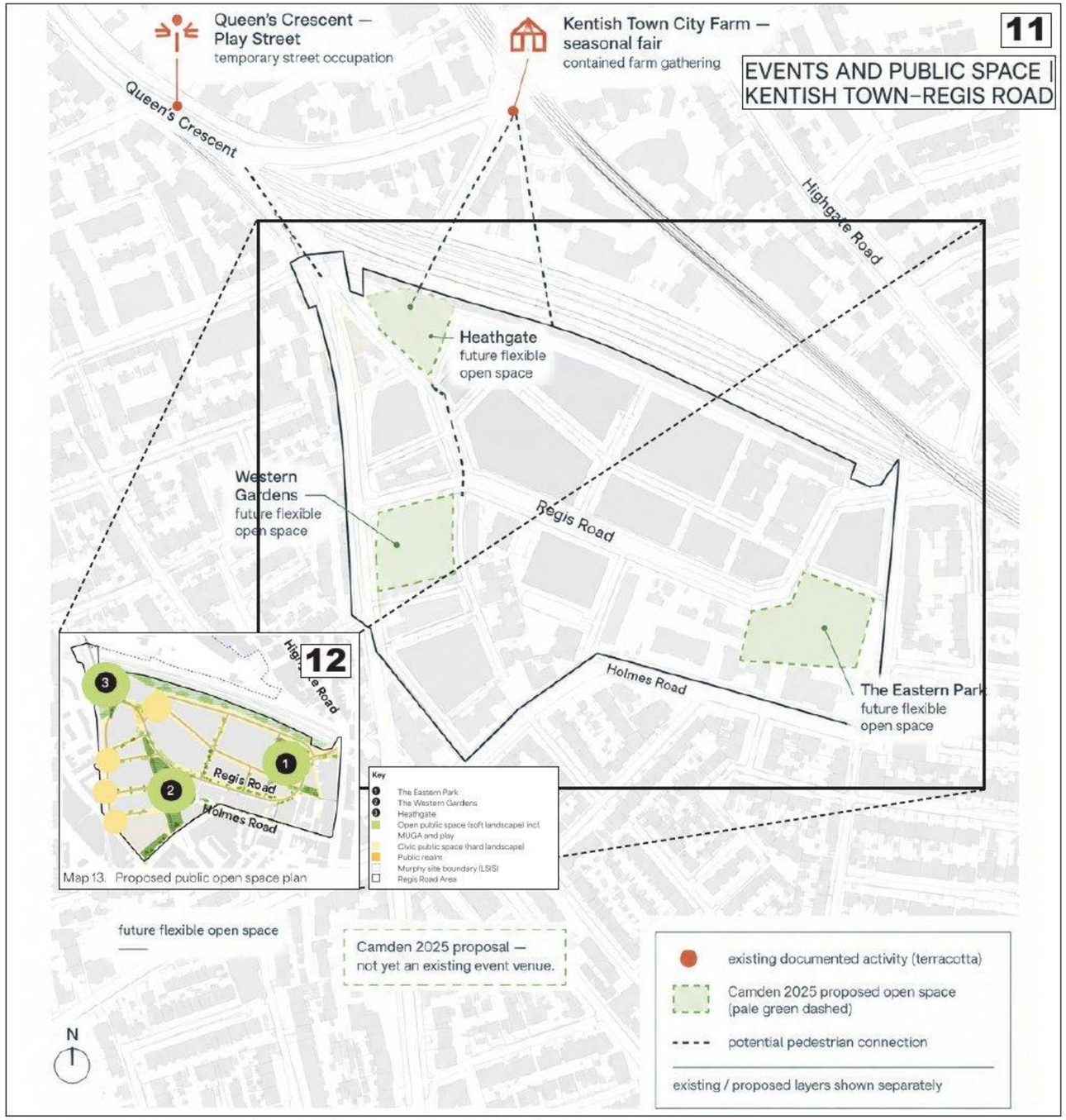
Research question: How do local events use public space, and where could Regis Road support future activities?

Event evidence: Queen's Crescent has hosted temporary Play Street activities, including games, music and crafts. Kentish Town City Farm recorded more than 2,700 visitors across its May Day and Christmas Fair celebrations in 2023-24.

Spatial analysis: These examples use different spaces: a street can temporarily become a shared public area, while the farm provides a contained setting for seasonal gatherings. Camden's Regis Road guidance proposes three new public open spaces designed for activities across different age groups. These are planned spaces, not existing event venues.

Initial reflection: Future spaces should be flexible enough for small local events while retaining clear walking routes, seating and quieter areas for everyday use.

Evidence limit: The event records do not measure demand at Regis Road. The proposed open spaces have not yet demonstrated how they will be used.needs.



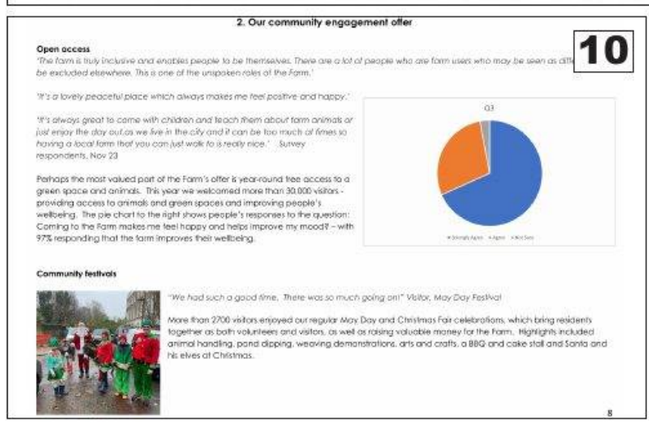


Fig. 1 — Children's crafts.
Fig. 2 — Play Street art.
Fig. 3 — Queen's Crescent Market.
Fig. 4 — Street painting.
Fig. 5 — Community meal.
Fig. 6 — Bicycle repair.
Fig. 7 — Street stalls.
Fig. 8 — Book swap.
Fig. 9 — Community discussion.
Fig. 10 — City Farm festivals.
Fig. 11 — Event-space analysis.
Fig. 12 — Camden's proposed open-space plan.

(3)Participation and Cultural Access

Research question: Who can enter, participate in and organise cultural activities around Regis Road?

Access evidence: Kentish Town City Farm offers free entry, wheelchair access and an accessible toilet. O2 Forum provides wheelchair spaces and a free companion ticket, although spaces are limited and upper levels have no lift. Torriano Meeting House can be hired for small community events, but hire charges and a toilet reached by steps limit access.

Spatial analysis: Proximity to a cultural venue does not guarantee participation. Admission cost, physical access and the ability to control a space shape different levels of involvement, from visiting to organising an event.

Initial reflection: Future spaces at Regis Road should support affordable entry, accessible facilities and opportunities for residents of different ages to run their own activities.

Evidence limit: Venue policies describe available facilities; they do not show who actually attends or what unmet local demand exists.

Fig. 1 — City Farm Pet Club programme.
Fig. 2 — Children meeting farm animals.
Fig. 3 — Visitor with a goat at the City Farm.
Fig. 4 — Gardening activity at the City Farm.
Fig. 5 — O2 Forum performance space.
Fig. 6 — O2 Forum concert audience.
Fig. 7 — Art therapy and sharing-circle listings.
Fig. 8 — Community meeting and art listings.
Fig. 9 — Storytelling and folk-music listings.
Fig. 10 — Cultural access comparison diagram.

(4)Cultural Change and Future Provision

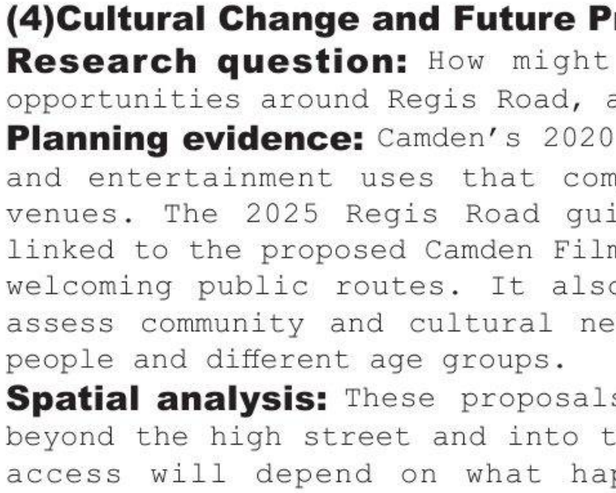
Research question: How might redevelopment change cultural opportunities around Regis Road, and who will benefit?

Planning evidence: Camden's 2020 framework calls for new cultural and entertainment uses that complement Kentish Town's existing venues. The 2025 Regis Road guidance illustrates creative uses linked to the proposed Camden Film Quarter, makers' spaces and more welcoming public routes. It also requires major developments to assess community and cultural needs, particularly those of young people and different age groups.

Spatial analysis: These proposals could extend cultural activity beyond the high street and into the former industrial area. Public access will depend on what happens at ground level: visible entrances, usable community space and connections to surrounding streets matter as much as the presence of creative businesses.

Initial reflection: Future provision should give local residents opportunities to participate and organise activities, alongside spaces for the creative industries.

Evidence limit: The plans are indicative. They do not establish which cultural facilities will be delivered, how they will be managed or whether local residents will be able to afford them.



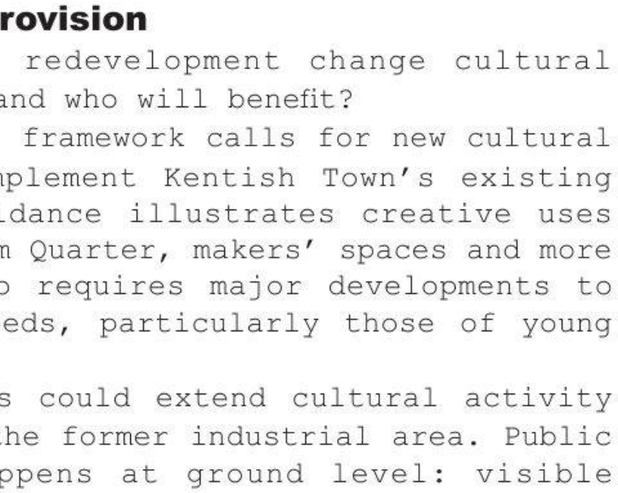


Fig. 1 — Indicative land-use areas, showing how industrial, residential and mixed uses could be arranged across Regis Road. Camden Council (2020).

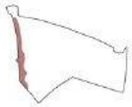
Fig. 2 — Illustrative character areas, identifying the different roles proposed for streets and development areas. Camden Council (2025).

Fig. 3 — Makers Lane concept, with active railway arches and space for creative work along a new public route. Camden Council (2025).

Fig. 4 — Proposed Western Gardens and Holmes Road park, following the buried River Fleet.

3

Character Area 5
Makers Lane



A key principle of the KTPF, Makers Lane should be a welcoming and intimate route connecting Spring Place to the south with Arctic Street and Heathgate to the north, leading to a new crossing over the railway and towards the Murphy's site and Highgate Studios. It will unlock areas of Kentish Town's industrial past, with its character defined by creative uses and activity.

Key guidance for the area:

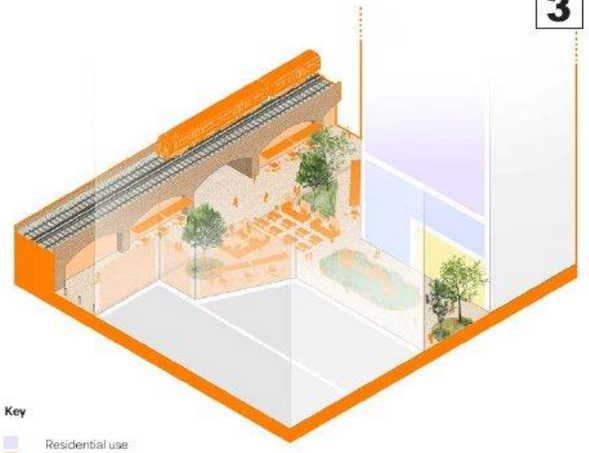
1. The industrial heritage assets of the area, such as railway arches, should be celebrated and brought to active uses, whilst new buildings facing the railway arches and the public realm should respond to this heritage context.

2. Welcoming active ground floor frontages should happen on both sides of the lane. Uses should include affordable workspaces, creative industries, and makers as well as small light industrial units.

3. The lane should have an intimate character along its length, with pockets of open spaces to dwell in and hubs of activity at key locations – for example, at the connection with Spring Place, Arctic Street, and the Kentish Town City Farm, as well as along new east-west connections.

4. Public realm and servicing should be carefully designed to ensure the lane has pedestrian and cycle priority whilst enabling servicing of the western part of the Regis Road Area – for example, with the management of service access, allowed at specific hours of the day only. An integrated servicing strategy should be developed.

6. Heathgate: Makers Lane will lead to 'Heathgate' at the north, a new green public open space that should make use of the arches, provide links to the Kentish Town City Farm, to Regis Road to the east, and to the north via a new pedestrian and cycling Heath Line Bridge across the railway, connecting to the wider KTPF and beyond.



Key
- Residential use
- Active frontages
- Community use
- Small format creative light industry use

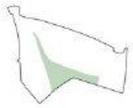
Concept axonometric of Makers Lane and its activated railway arches

Development along railway arches, Hawley Wharf

Active railway arches, Borough Yards

4

Character Area 4
The Western Gardens and Holmes Road



Ambitions for this area include an improved Holmes Road and a new green public open space at the west of the site to create an accessible park serving the existing and new communities of residents, workers and visitors, with its footprint following the deeply buried current of the River Fleet.

Key guidance for the area:

1. This key new green public open space will provide multi-functional amenities including a green semi-natural environment for residents and visitors to socialise and seek respite from the busy city environment, play provision for all ages, and enhanced biodiversity. Its design should use best practice so that it feels safe and pleasant, and be well overlooked by active frontages, including new buildings ending the Regis Road/ Holmes Road blocks. *See LBC Open Space guidance*

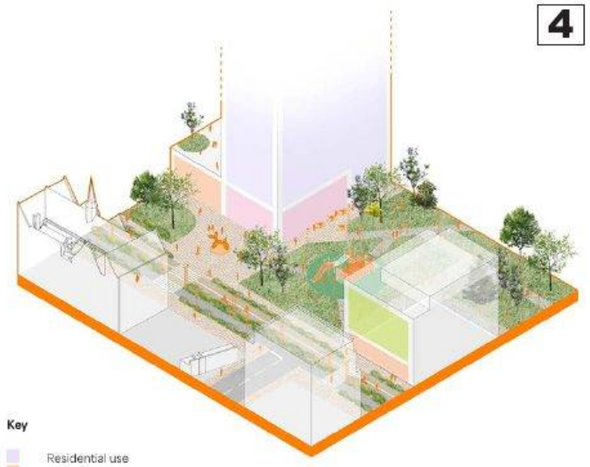
2. Stitching the new development into the existing context, views from and around the open space should be carefully considered and framed by high quality design; for example, enhancing the setting of the listed College on 87 Holmes Road through long views across the park. The open space should connect with the existing Inkerman Gardens to the south and pedestrian streets, including Holmes Road passage to the east and Makers Lane to the west.

3. The new link to Holmes Road and Cathcart Street will transform the existing passage at the east into a key green cycling and pedestrian route connecting to the new development. Improvements should include widening of the passage towards the new park to create space for active ground floor uses to spill out and dwell.

4. The ground floors of buildings around the new park should provide a sense of destination as well as amenity spaces for the local community. Mixed-uses, including retail, cafés, community uses could provide activation at key moments, such as on the corner of the Holmes Road passage, south corner of Inkerman Gardens and north west corner on Regis Road. Residential entrances should have a civic and generous character.

5. Improvements to buildings and the public realm along Holmes Road should create a welcoming setting and a better relationship with the Regis Road Area.

5. A varied townscape should be promoted across the whole Regis Road Area. In particular, the new housing-led development to the west of the gardens should be of varied heights, creating a neighbourly character, providing a good level of daylight and views to the sky and avoiding conspicuous large scale skyline ensembles. *See LB Camden Building Height Study*



Key
- Residential use
- Active frontages
- Mixed use
- Cultural facility use

Concept axonometric of the green public open space and its relationship to streets and buildings

Buildings fronting open space, Elephant Park

Public open space in Mayfield Park, Manchester

2.1.7 Nightlife

(1)Evening Activity and Land-use Pattern

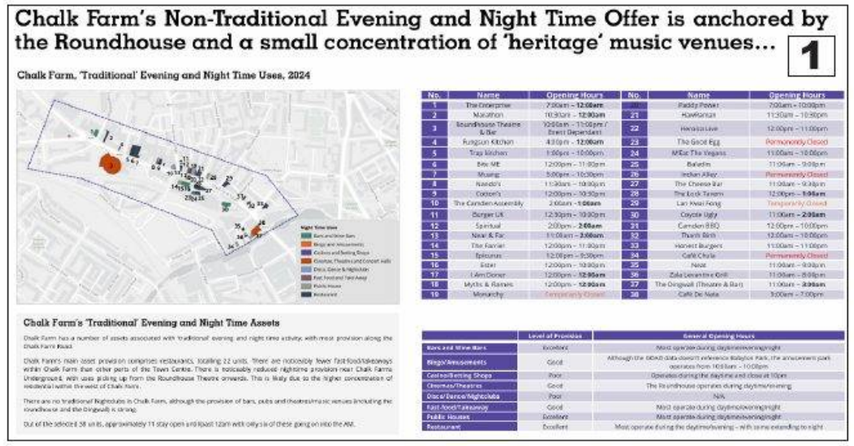
Research question: Where is nightlife concentrated across Camden Town, Chalk Farm and Kentish Town, and how does Regis Road relate to it?

Nightlife evidence: Camden's 2024 survey maps pubs, bars, restaurants and music venues along Camden High Street and Chalk Farm Road. Of the surveyed premises, approximately 20 of 40 in Camden High Street North and 11 of 38 in Chalk Farm were listed as open until or beyond midnight. Major music venues include the Roundhouse and Electric Ballroom, with O2 Forum forming another destination further north in Kentish Town.

Spatial analysis: Nightlife is concentrated around established streets and venues rather than spread evenly across the wider area. Camden's evening footfall map also shows stronger activity around Camden Town. Regis Road sits beyond this main cluster, so its connection to nightlife is primarily through surrounding streets and transport routes.

Initial reflection: Future development could introduce smaller evening uses that connect with this wider network, without assuming Regis Road needs to become another major bar or club strip.**Evidence limit:** The venue survey records listed opening hours, not actual visitor numbers. Its Camden Town maps also do not provide a detailed night-time audit of Regis Road.

Fig. 1 — Chalk Farm's evening venues and listed opening hours.
Fig. 2 — Camden High Street North's pubs, restaurants and music venues.
Fig. 3 — Evening footfall across Camden, 18:00-21:00.
Fig. 4 — Camden Town-Kentish Town nightlife network. Analytical diagram based on Camden Council's venue and footfall maps; people and activities are illustrative.



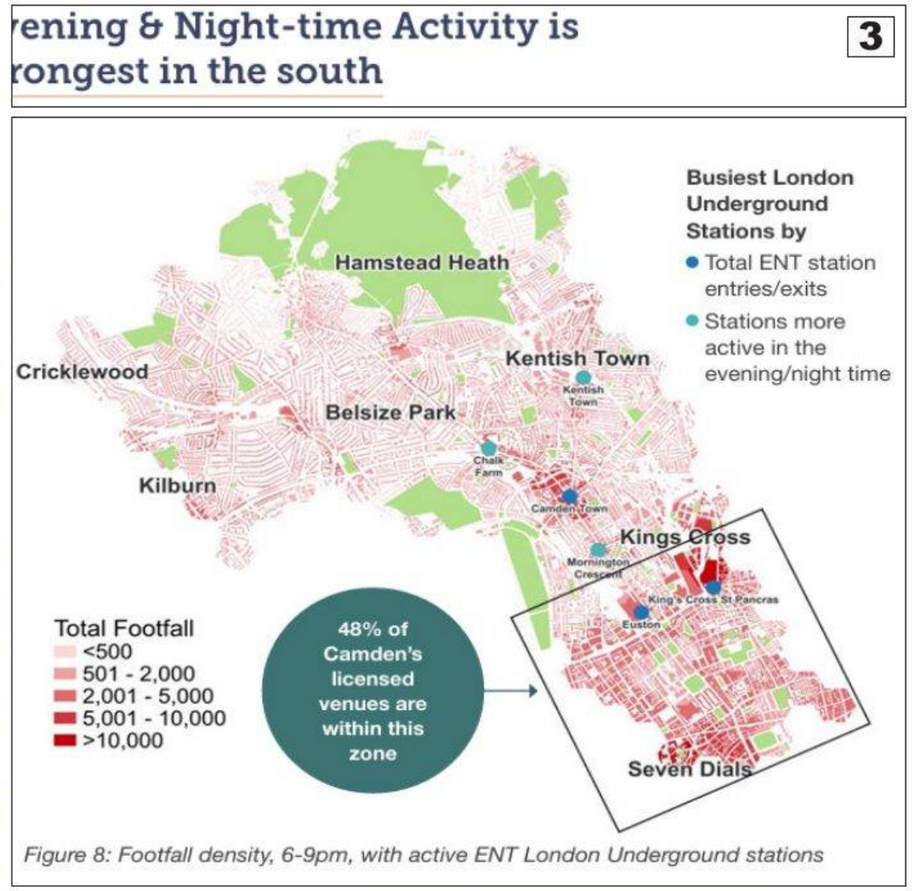
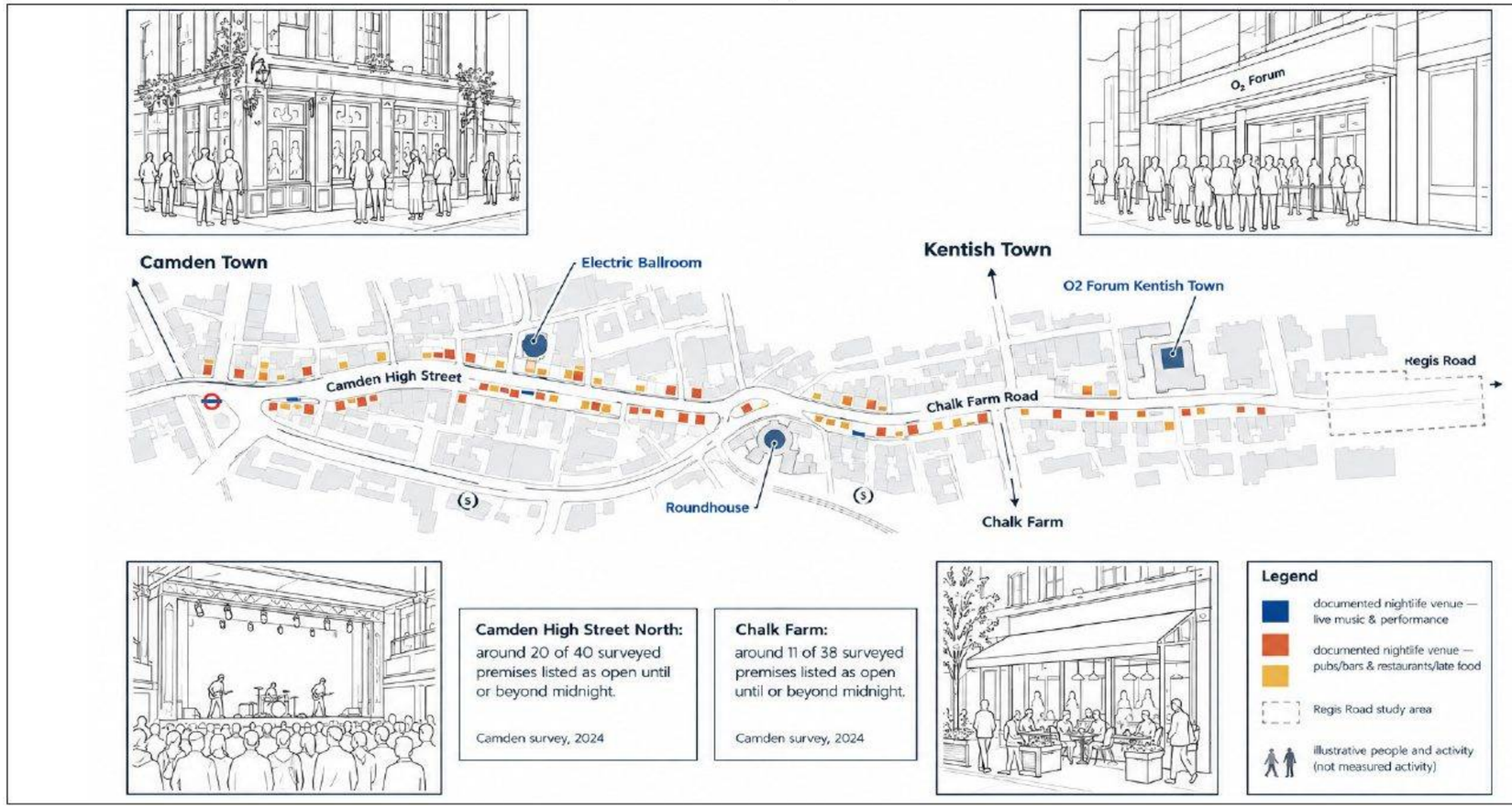


Figure 8: Footfall density, 6-9pm, with active ENT London Underground stations



(2)Night-time Routes, Safety and Inclusion

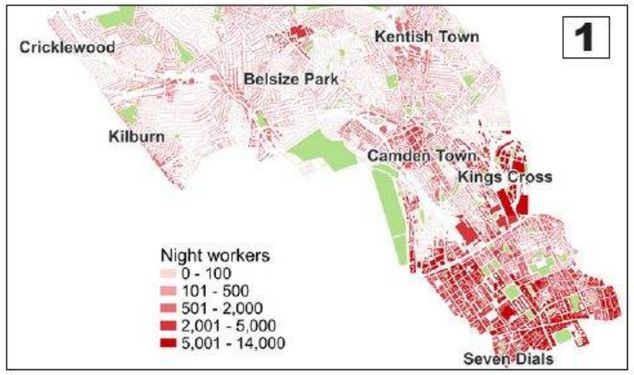
Research question: Can people travel safely and inclusively between Camden Town's night-time venues, transport stops and surrounding neighbourhoods?

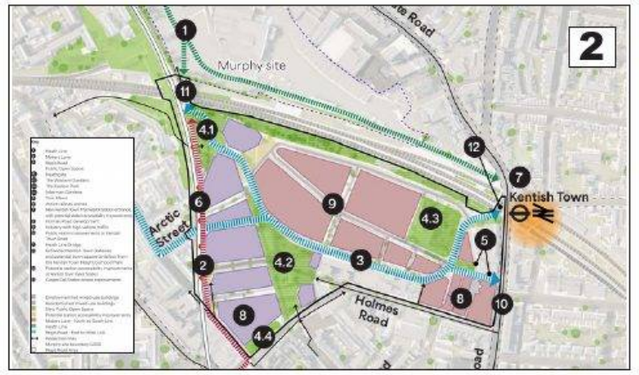
Safety evidence: In Camden's 2024 Women's Safety Survey, 72% of 272 respondents felt unsafe or very unsafe after dark. Respondents described choosing well-lit main roads, avoiding certain places or staying home. Camden provides a Safety Bus outside Camden Town station on Friday and Saturday nights, while local Safe Havens offer places to ask for help.

Spatial analysis: Night Tube services and support points help people leave the main nightlife area, but a transport connection does not make every walking route to it feel safe. Lighting, visibility, accessible paths and places to seek help matter along the entire journey, including the quieter approaches towards Kentish Town and Regis Road.

Initial reflection: Future routes should be easy to follow after dark, with clear sightlines, consistent lighting and accessible connections to staffed or active places.

Evidence limit: The survey covers self-selected respondents across Camden. It does not identify which streets near Regis Road feel unsafe; this needs an evening site visit.





(3)Night Work and Residential BalanceResearch question:

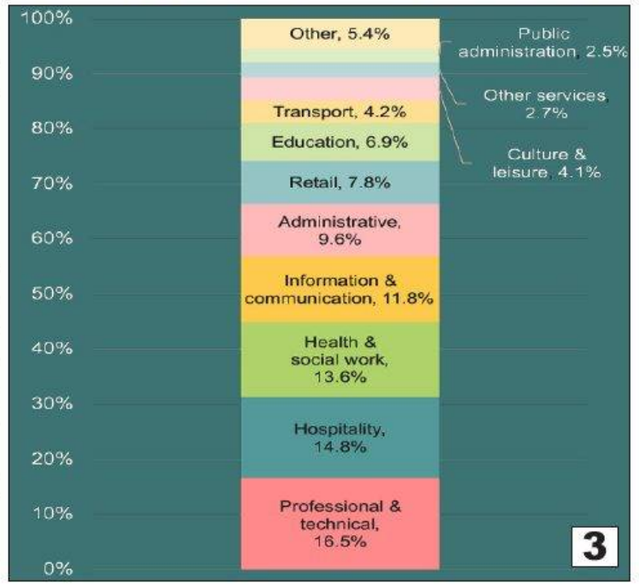
How can night-time employment and housing coexist around Regis Road?

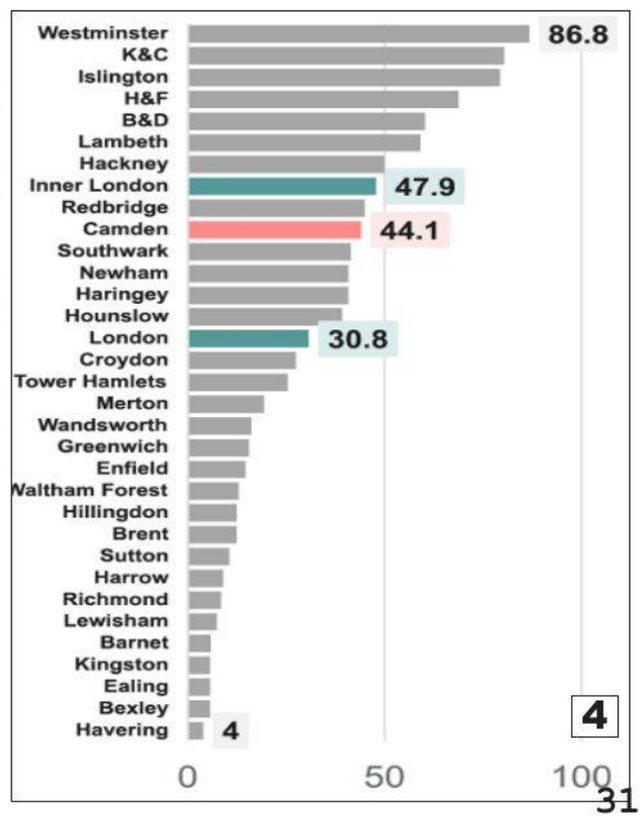
Employment evidence: Camden's 2020 framework calls for new cultural and entertainment uses that complement Kentish Town's existing venues. The 2025 Regis Road guidance illustrates creative uses linked to the proposed Camden Film Quarter, makers' spaces and more welcoming public routes. It also requires major developments to assess community and cultural needs, particularly those of young people and different age groups.

Local evidence: Camden's employment review describes Regis Road as a site with 24-hour working. It records residents' concerns about late-night moped noise and drivers visiting a delivery kitchen on the estate.

Spatial analysis: The potential conflict is most relevant where servicing routes meet residential streets. Camden's 2025 guidance proposes both employment space and new homes at Regis Road, making the layout of loading areas, routes and residential edges.

Initial reflection: New housing should be designed for the existing working environment, while businesses should manage vehicle movements and noise. Camden's Agent of Change guidance places responsibility for mitigating existing noise on new sensitive development.





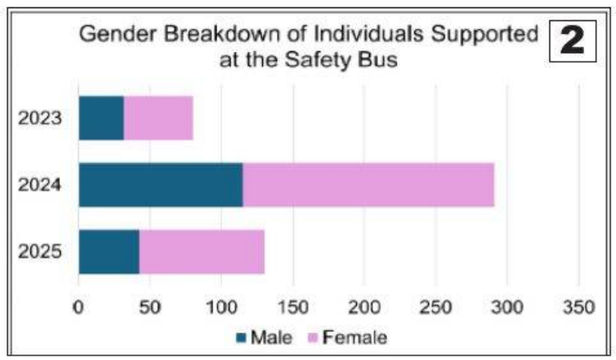


Fig. 1 — Camden Safety Bus at night.
Fig. 2 — People supported by the Safety Bus, 2023–2025.
Fig. 3 — Perceived safety when travelling by day and night.
Fig. 4 — Night Tube connections around Camden Town and Kentish Town.

Fig. 1 — Distribution of night workers in Camden, 2022.
Fig. 2 — Indicative employment and housing layout at Regis Road.
Fig. 3 — Night workers by employment sector, 2022.
Fig. 4 — Noise complaints per 1,000 residents, 2021.

2.1.8 Biodiversity

(1)Existing Habitats and Nature Sites

Research question: What habitats and protected nature sites already exist around Regis Road?

Ecological evidence: Camden's 2024 review identifies the 6.60-hectare Kentish Town City Farm, Gospel Oak Railsides and Mortimer Terrace Nature Reserve as one Site of Importance for Nature Conservation. Its recorded habitats include woodland, scrub, grassland, tall herbs and ponds.

Map reading: These habitats are concentrated beside the railway and at the city farm, close to the Regis Road industrial area. The farm is publicly accessible, while the railsides are not.

Spatial analysis: The railway edge supports a varied habitat mosaic despite its restricted access. Existing vegetation should be considered when planning changes to nearby plots and routes.

Initial reflection: New planting could strengthen this existing habitat network, but the designated sites should form the starting point for the design.

Initial reflection: The review describes the wider designated site. It does not provide a current, detailed habitat survey of every plot within Regis Road.

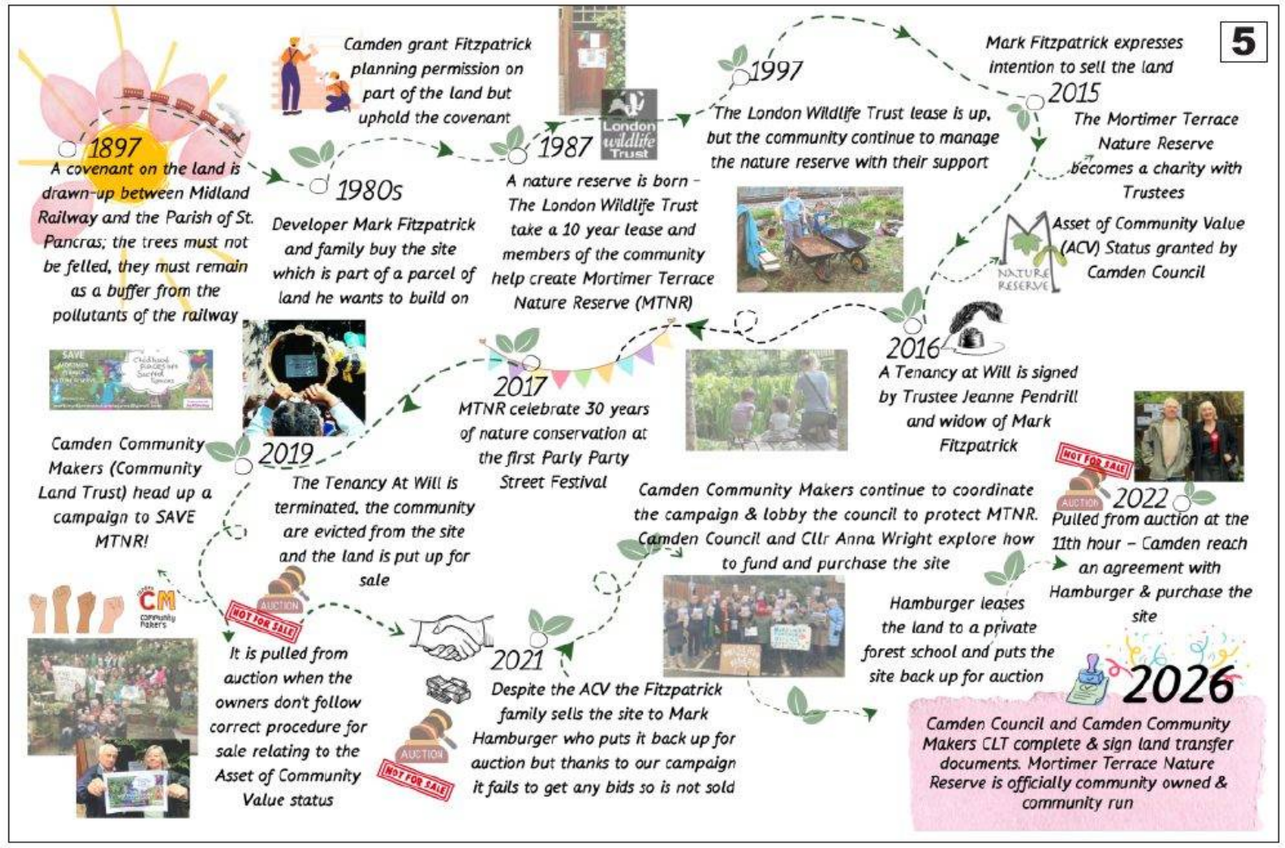


Fig. 1 — Kentish Town environmental assets and habitat corridors.
Fig. 2 — Community campaign to protect Mortimer Terrace Nature Reserve.
Fig. 3 — Children exploring the planted habitat at Kentish Town City Farm.
Fig. 4 — Community activity and displays about the local natural environment.
Fig. 5 — Timeline of Mortimer Terrace Nature Reserve.

(2)Ecological Corridors and Barriers

Research question: How are habitats connected around Regis Road, and where are the gaps?

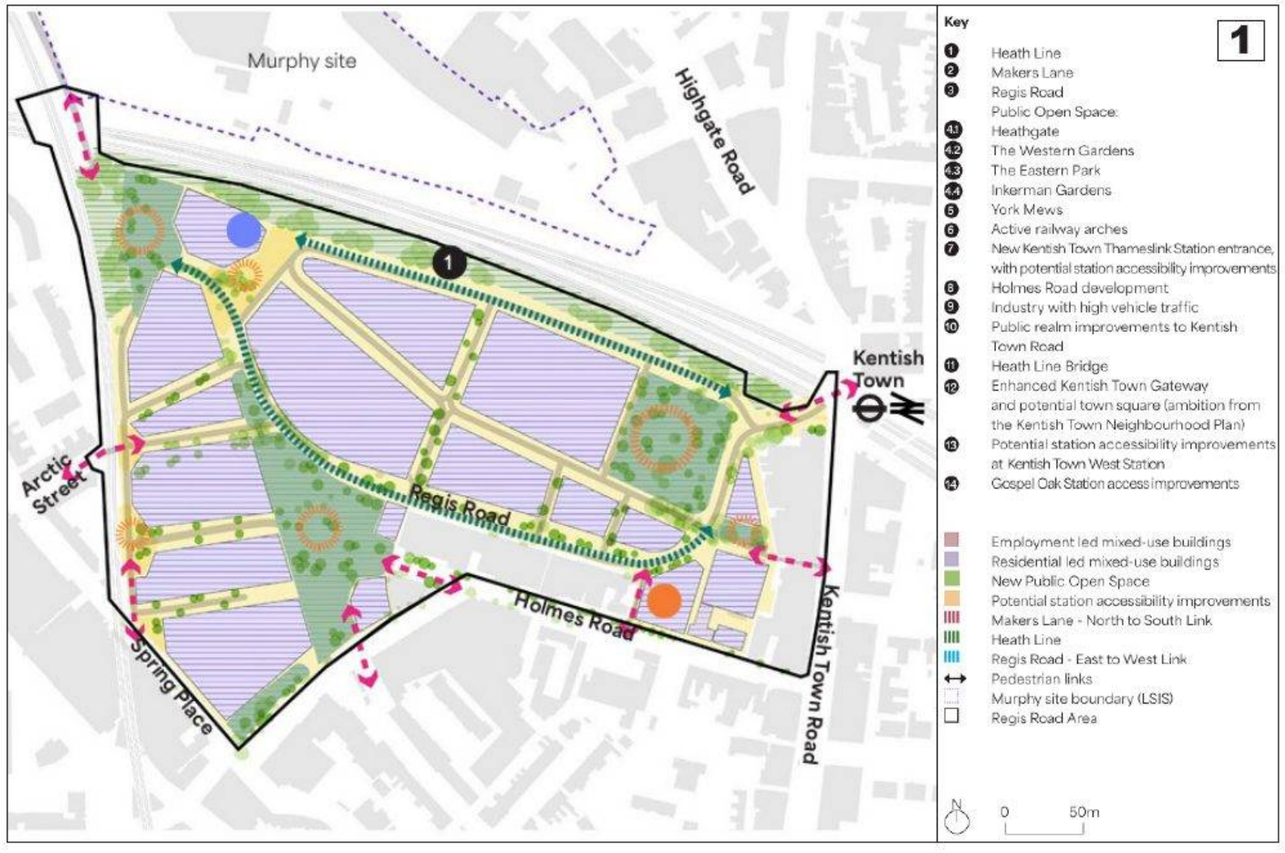
Map reading: Vegetated railway edges form an existing linear habitat near Kentish Town City Farm and Gospel Oak. Camden's corridor map places Regis Road between these nature sites and other green spaces to the south.

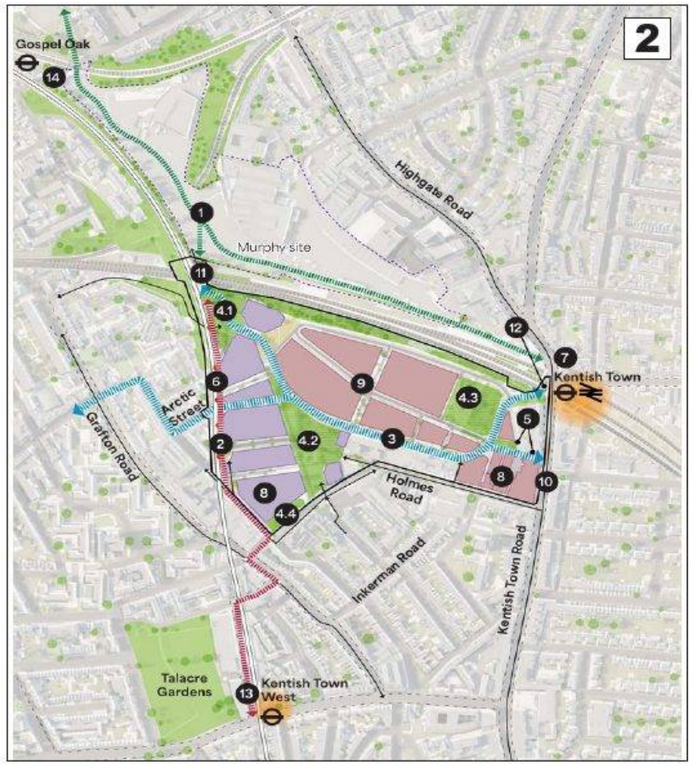
Planning evidence: Camden's 2025 guidance identifies wildlife corridors, existing designated habitat and proposed green links. Its sustainability plan shows how planting and open space could connect across the redevelopment area.

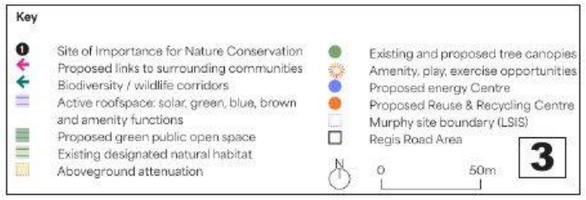
Spatial analysis: The railway edge may support movement along the tracks, while large built plots and hard surfaces interrupt planted routes across the area. These are different kinds of connection and should not be shown as one continuous existing corridor.

Initial reflection: A future route should link new planting to established habitat at the site edges, while limiting disturbance from lighting and activity.

Evidence limit: The maps identify habitat and proposed connections; they do not demonstrate which species currently move between them. A site-specific ecological survey is needed.







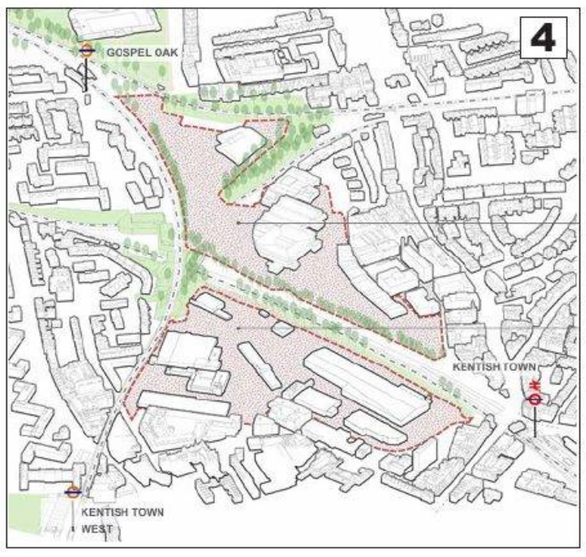


Fig. 1 — Indicative landscape and open-space strategy for Regis Road.
Fig. 2 — Proposed biodiversity and green-space connections.
Fig. 3 — Legend for the proposed connections in Fig. 2.
Fig. 4 — Railway-edge green corridor and surrounding development sites.

(3)Development Pressures and Biodiversity Opportunities

Research question: How could redevelopment affect existing habitats, and where could it create space for nature?

Development pressure: The Regis Road site lies beside a railway biodiversity corridor. New buildings and activity close to this edge could affect neighbouring habitats through shade, lighting and disturbance.

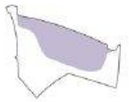
Planning evidence: Camden's 2025 guidance proposes new green spaces at Heathgate, Western Gardens and Eastern Park, together with planting along the railway edge. It calls for green links to nearby wildlife areas and for development to meet biodiversity requirements.

Spatial analysis: The northern edge is particularly important: it is where new buildings, public routes and existing habitat would meet. Green space here needs to work as habitat as well as public landscape.

Initial reflection: Protecting existing vegetation, providing a planted buffer and managing light at the railway edge should be tested early in the design.

Evidence limit: These drawings show planning intentions, not delivered habitats or measured ecological gains. Detailed surveys and the final design are needed to assess their effects.

Character Area 3
The Mixed-Use Neighbourhood



This area, between Regis Road to the south and the railway biodiversity corridor to the north, will enable the coexistence of large commercial uses, including creative uses such as the Camden Film Quarter, light industrial, and last mile delivery centres, with new homes, neighbouring residents and visitors, and a new public park.

Key guidance for the area:

1. Active and welcoming frontages should be provided on Regis Road, with sufficient ground floor spill-out space to dwell and generous welcoming uses, especially along the perimeter frontages. Visual transparency and public uses are particularly key for the Camden Film Quarter to ensure its integration into the neighbourhood.

2. Service roads should be located at the centre of the character area (within back-of-house) from the outset, ensuring Regis Road and the railway corridor are active safe routes for pedestrians and cyclists.

3. An enhanced tree lined green corridor should be created along the biodiversity corridor on the railway edge to the north to link Heathgate to the Eastern Park. Its width should enable green and safe cyclist and pedestrian routes, separated from servicing requirements.

4. The co-location of new homes with large commercial uses should create a strong sense of neighbourhood. Residential entrances should open directly onto streets, front doors and windows should provide passive surveillance, including along the biodiversity corridor, whilst servicing should be located within back-of-house yards, away from the streets. *See GLA on Industrial Intensification*

5. Large commercial buildings should provide **a varied skyline with high quality architectural design**. Variation in height and breaks in massing should create harmonious long views from key viewpoints, such as from Kentish Town Road Bridge and Hampstead Heath, as well as create pleasant, walkable streets with good views to the sky. Buildings should have **active and attractive frontages** at a scale comfortable for people using the streets. The cumulative impact of large floor plates and high buildings should be tested rigorously to avoid potential conspicuous large scale skyline ensembles, such as visually creating a continuous wall of height. *See LB Camden Building Height Study*

6. A new green public park to the east of this area should provide active play, space to linger, and nature-based greening, including the retention of existing trees. A biodiversity connection to the railway edge should enhance the biodiversity corridor. Servicing passing through Regis Road should be carefully designed to ensure the park is not negatively impacted (i.e. traffic calming, pedestrian priority crossings, etc).

7. Improved visibility and pedestrian connections from Kentish Town Road as well as from the extended York Mews should integrate the new area with the High Street.

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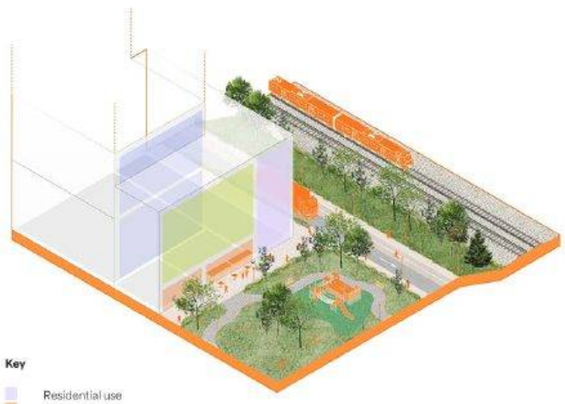


Concept axonometric illustrating the green corridor and diverse land use integration

Sustainable and community-focused workshops in Meridian Water

Stacked industrial co-location with residential uses *GLA Industrial Intensification and Co-Location Study*

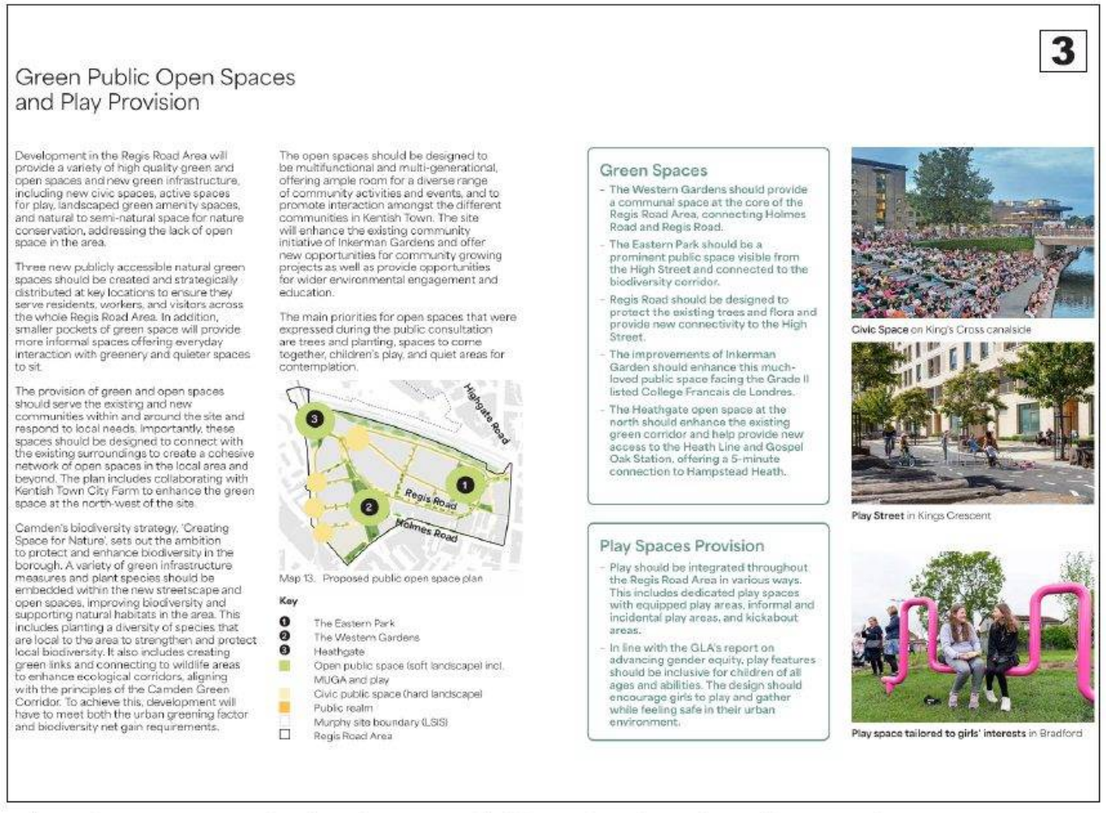


Fig. 1 — Proposed mixed-use neighbourhood and railway-edge green corridor.
Fig. 2 — Indicative landscape masterplan for Regis Road.
Fig. 3 — Proposed green public spaces and play provision.

2.1.9 Care and Intergenerational Support

(1)Everyday Care Needs

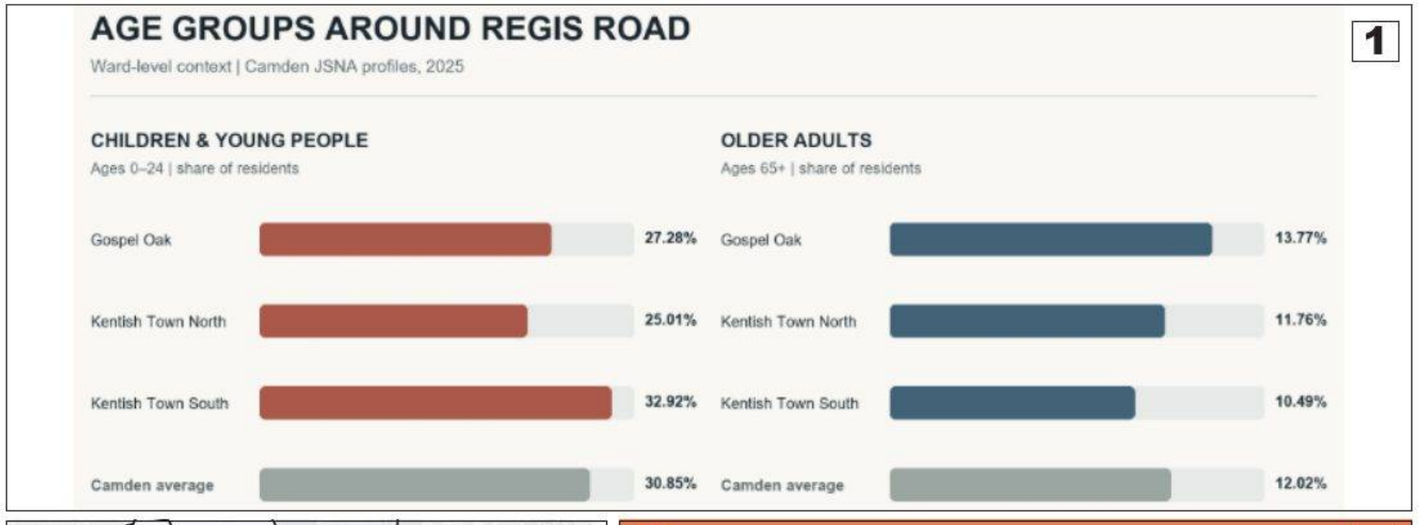
Research question: What everyday support do children, older residents and carers need around Regis Road?

Age evidence: The surrounding wards have different age profiles. Kentish Town South has a larger share of children and young people aged 0-24 than Camden overall, while Gospel Oak has a larger share of residents aged 65 and over.

Community evidence: In local engagement, residents asked for natural play areas, more seating for parents and older people, water fountains and toilets.

Spatial analysis: These requests suggest that care depends partly on the spaces between home and local destinations. A comfortable journey needs safe crossings, places to pause and facilities that people can use together.**Initial reflection:** Public routes and open spaces at Regis Road should support play, rest and accessible everyday journeys for different generations.

Evidence limit: Ward data does not describe the exact Regis Road population or measure individual care needs. Engagement comments identify priorities but do not show how many residents share each view.



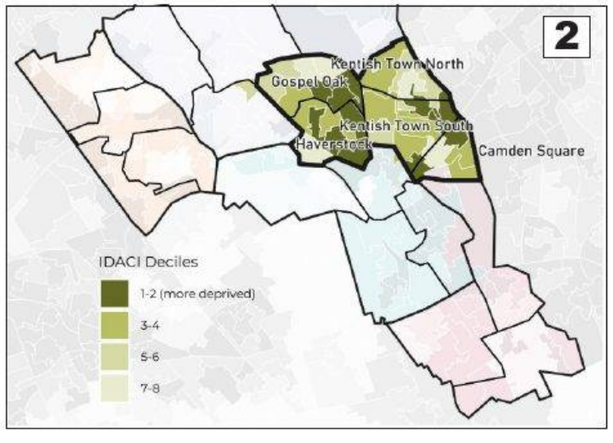


Fig. 1 — Age-group comparison across the wards surrounding Regis Road.
Fig. 2 — Income deprivation affecting children/older people in eastern Camden.
Fig. 3 — Residents' priorities for play, seating and everyday facilities.

(2)Care Services and Everyday Routes

Research question: How easily can people reach care and family services from the Regis Road area?

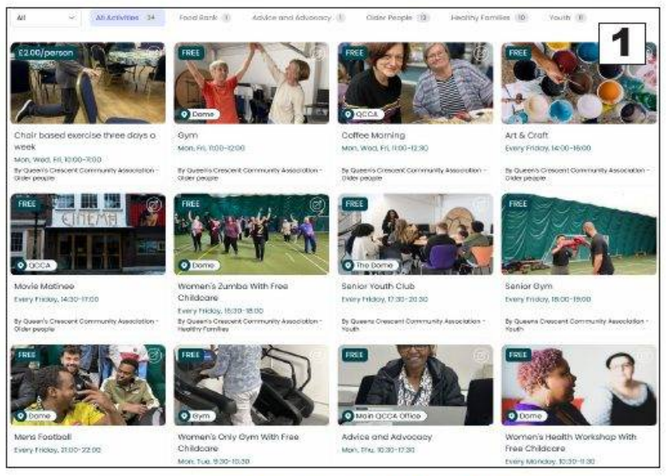
Service evidence: Camden's East Integrated Neighbourhood Team brings adult health and social care staff together at Kentish Town Health Centre. Agar Best Start Family Hub supports parents and young children, while Queen's Crescent Community Association provides activities and advice for older residents.

Map reading: These services sit in different parts of the surrounding neighbourhood. Camden's Gospel Oak and Haverstock vision identifies community facilities and walking routes as linked priorities.

Spatial analysis: For someone travelling with a child or with limited mobility, a short distance on a map may still involve difficult crossings or an indirect route. This is a question for site investigation, not a measured finding.

Initial reflection: New connections through Regis Road should make everyday trips to care services direct, legible and comfortable, with step-free crossings and places to rest.

Initial reflection: Published maps show locations and proposed routes; they do not establish actual journey times or how residents use these services.



3.2 NEIGHBOURHOOD WIDE GUIDANCE

5

1. Resident-led regeneration

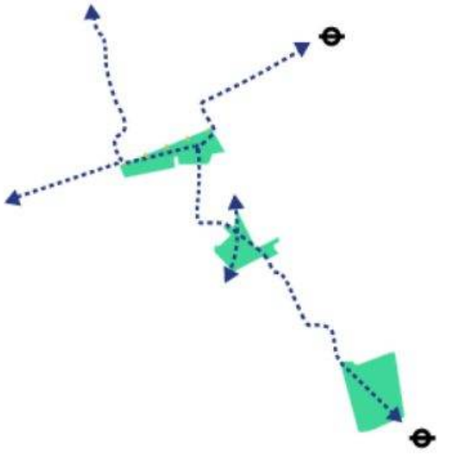
Putting residents at the heart of future and previous plans will ensure that new housing is delivered that also delivers benefits for the entire community such as new play and open spaces. As well as replacing homes that no longer meet modern standards as well as additional, much needed homes, this will help to address issues of fuel poverty and improve safety.

2. Community provision at the heart of the area

Focus investment in new or enhanced facilities in the heart of the neighbourhood alongside new public realm and greening in Queen's Crescent, to revitalise the centre and ensure that it is a safe, enjoyable place to play, socialise, shop or work. New training and infrastructure for the market will also help it to attract traders and make it easier for local people to give it a try themselves. Safeguard and enhance key existing facilities, like the library and QCCA.

3. Knitting together the area's green infrastructure

Investment to enhance the area's local green spaces will ensure that they feel safe, cater for the needs of all ages and genders and help tackle issues of mental health and isolation. Improving walking and cycling routes across the neighbourhood will also help encourage healthier and more sustainable travel and improve air quality.



4. A walkable neighbourhood

6

Improving walking routes across the neighbourhood will help encourage healthier and more sustainable travel and improve air quality. We want to ensure that residents can reach services, public transport, open spaces and Hampstead Heath via accessible, safe and attractive walking routes.

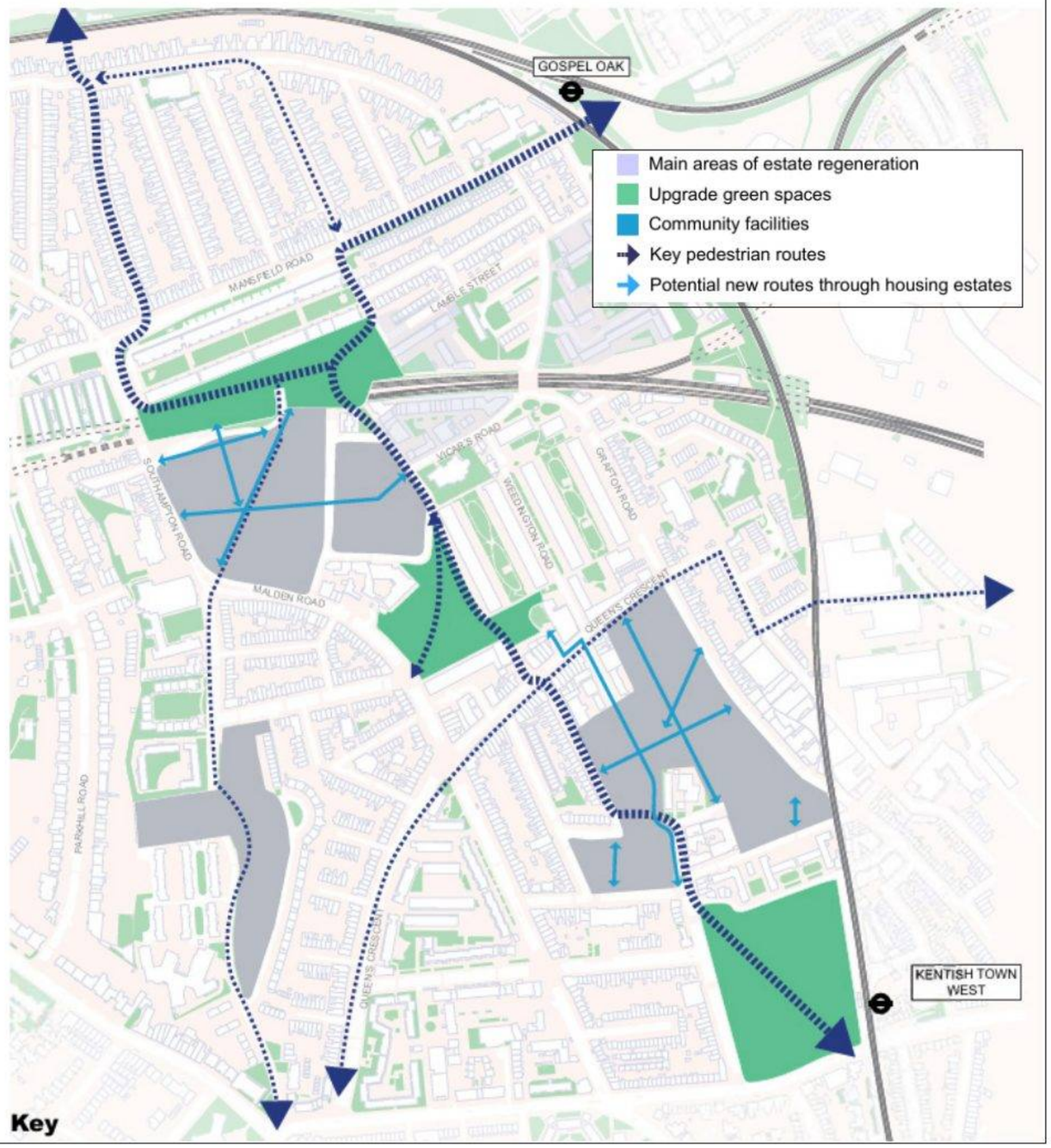


Fig. 1 - QCCA's activities for older residents.
Fig. 2 - Intergenerational gardening activity.
Fig. 3 - Parent and child activity at Agar Family Hub.
Fig. 4 - Sensory room at Agar Family Hub.
Fig. 5 - Camden's neighbourhood-wide guidance for community provision.
Fig. 6 - Proposed walking routes linking homes and local services.

(3)Age-Inclusive Public Space

Research question: What small-scale features help children, older people and disabled residents use public space independently?

Street evidence: Queen's Crescent slopes down towards Prince of Wales Road. A Camden street assessment also identified uneven footways nearby and called for clear walking space and accessible bus stops. Local residents prioritised places to sit, safer crossings and accessible public toilets.

Play evidence: Camden's Gospel Oak and Haverstock guidance proposes play close to homes, with more enclosed spaces for younger children and more open settings for older children.

Spatial analysis: A route is only as usable as its steepest, narrowest or most difficult point. Seating can make a longer walk manageable, while small play spaces let children use the neighbourhood during everyday trips.

Initial reflection: Regis Road's smaller streets should combine even, step-free surfaces, safe crossings, frequent places to rest and play within sight of homes.

Initial reflection: The documents identify concerns and proposals, but a site walk is needed to measure gradients, check surfaces and observe who uses each space.

Feedback summary

1

The size of words in the word-cloud above reflects the popularity of named proposals with respondents in Queen's Crescent

Analysis

In a series of 1:1 interviews, informal conversations and public discussions The Decorators and a team of Camden Community Researchers spoke to businesses, shop owners, market stall holders, customers, residents, local charity workers, parents, children, library staff, youth workers, older people, community group leaders and local educators. The list of interviewees was not exhaustive, but broadly representative of the population of street users.

Methodology

Feedback and ideas were sought and received in 1:1 interviews, survey forms, map notes, emails and informal conversations. There were a total of 179 separate responses, in these varying formats. The majority of this data was qualitative and difficult to quantify and compare objectively. However, it was possible to count the positive and negative references made by participants to recurring options and ideas (left) and to order proposals by popularity. This data needs to be treated with caution, due to being open to interpretation, but it has provided a useful tool to check against conclusions being drawn by the design team about priorities for the street. The more personal and emotional audio narratives that arose out of the research were recorded in the podcast.

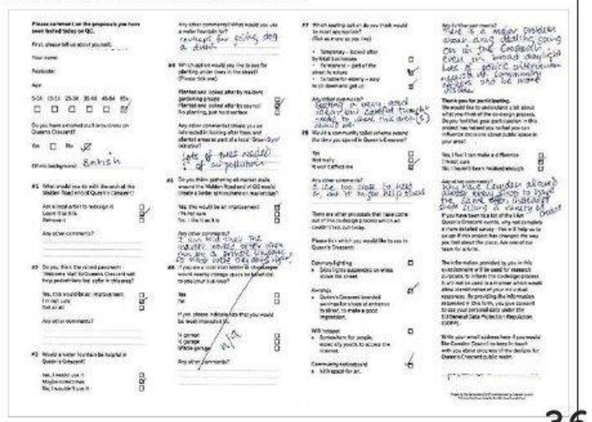
Top community priorities for capital spending (in order of popularity)

- Planting & trees
- Improved lighting
- Meeting places with permanent seating & seating designed for older people
- Community noticeboard
- Awnings for shops
- Trader's storage
- Water fountain
- Wifi hotspot
- A spruce up/tidy up
- Community planting areas
- A blended crossing
- Provide public toilets - remove 'pod'
- Consolidated market
- Space for art & entertainment
- Slower traffic
- De-clutter
- Reduce/restrict parking
- Visibly celebrate local culture
- Reduce traffic congestion

Top community priorities for revenue spending

- Invest in market management & trader support
- Curation of shop/stall types
- Better youth provision
- More regular street cleaning & rubbish clearance
- Greater police presence
- Support for key community orgs & hubs
- Street festivals

A survey form designed for the On-street testing day, returned by a resident



Healthy Streets check

2

Source: Lucy Saunders

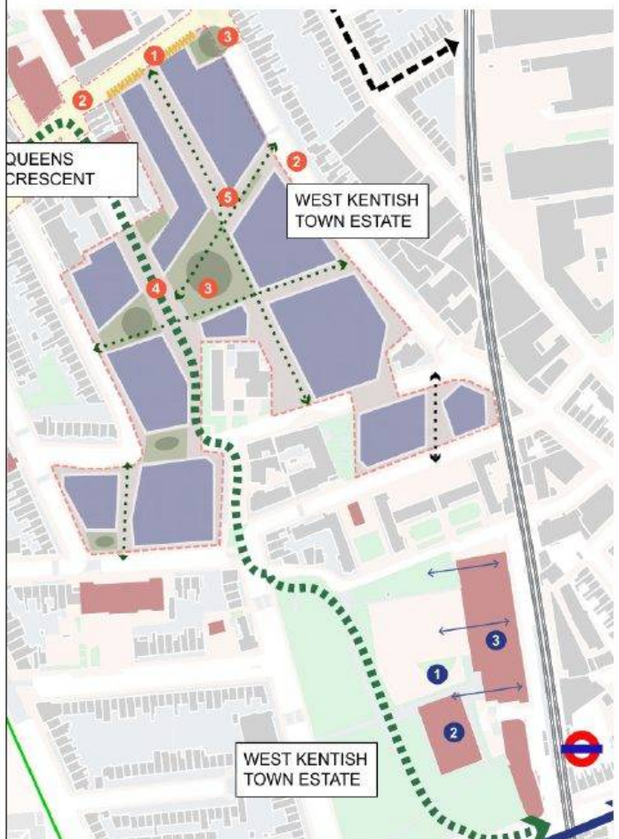
Healthy Streets Indicators' scores (%)

(Results will only display once all metrics have been scored)

	Existing layout	Proposed layout
Pedestrians from all walks of life	45	51
Easy to cross	53	60
Shade and shelter	67	67
Places to stop and rest	53	53
Not too noisy	53	53
People choose to walk, cycle and use public transport	45	51
People feel safe	44	52
Things to see and do	61	61
People feel relaxed	46	51
Clean Air	50	50
Overall Healthy Streets Check score	47	52
Number of 'zero' scores	4	3

3.8 SPECIFIC AREA GUIDANCE - AREA C

3



WEST KENTISH TOWN ESTATE

1. Use development of West Kentish Town Estate to create a strong and more active frontage to Queens Crescent with space for health, community and/or commercial uses
2. Improvements to adjoining streets
3. Play and green spaces for the whole community
4. Improve north/south route for pedestrians to better link Queens Crescent with Talacre Town Green, Gospel Oak station and Lismore circus
5. New pedestrian routes linking into wider street network to make walking and cycling easier and safer

TALACRE TOWN GREEN

1. Refurbish playground to improve facilities for a range of ages
2. Explore opportunities to improve free youth offer, with potential to repurpose concrete court and surrounding space for wheel park and multi-sports area
3. Invest in sports centre to improve offer and better integrate centre facilities with the park and its routes through.

Key

- Illustrative zones where potential new housing might be located
- Local services and community facilities
- Potential areas for upgraded and new green and open spaces
- Queens Crescent
- Introduce more active frontages
- New and improved pedestrian green links

Green and play streets

A network of new public spaces centred around the existing trees of highest value should form the basis for a masterplan of the new estate. New play spaces should be provided for a mix of ages, with younger children in more enclosed space and older children in more public settings to encourage

Reimagining the estate

New housing should actively improve the public realm for the whole community through planting of trees, seating, doorstep access to nature and a play street, catering for a diverse range of people

Linking back into the neighbourhood

Improve local walking routes by providing a clear, safe and accessible routes connecting Talacre Town Green with Queens Crescent as well as making it easier to travel across the estate

Images: (top) Play Street, Hackney by MUF architects (bottom) Forbes Lane, Hackney.

PARKS AND OPEN SPACES

The planning framework area sits adjacent to one of London's most well known and loved parks, Hampstead Heath. Hampstead Heath is an ancient London Park that covers 320 hectares and managed by the City of London Corporation.

Although the framework area is adjacent to Hampstead Heath, in the immediate area there is a lack of public open spaces and parks around Kentish Town. The majority of open spaces and parks are located to the west in Gospel Oak. These include Kentish Town City Farm, Lismore Circus and Gospel Oak Open Space, however they all suffer from poor connectivity to Kentish Town because of the severence caused by the Overground rail lines.

4

H TOWN: OPEN SPACES AND PARKS

PARKS AND OPEN SPACES

5

HAMPSTEAD HEATH

TALACRE GARDENS

GOSPEL OAK OPEN SPACE

LISMORE CIRCUS COMMUNITY WOODLANDS

Fig. 1 - Residents' priorities for Queen's Crescent public space.
Fig. 2 - Healthy Streets assessment: existing and proposed scores.
Fig. 3 - Proposed play spaces and walking links at West Kentish Town Estate.
Fig. 4 - Open spaces around Kentish Town and Gospel Oak.
Fig. 5 - Local play areas and places to sit.